COMMUNICATION SKILLS

CPA

FOUNDATION LEVEL

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STUDY TEXT

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GENERAL OBJECTIVE

This paper is intended to equip the candidate with the knowledge, skills and attitudes that will enable him/her to communicate effectively in an organisation.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- A candidate who passes this paper should be able to:
- Develop strategies for effective communication in an organisation
- Demonstrate skills in preparing and presenting skills
- Demonstrate effective communication skills
- Apply information technology in communication

CONTENT

1. Introduction to communication

- Definition of communication
- Objectives of communication
- Principles of effective communication
- Barriers to effective communication
- Methods of communication
- Formal and informal communication
- Communication systems
- Communication devices

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2. Written communication

- Effective writing skills
- Business transaction documents: catalogue, invoices, purchase orders, others
- Memorandum
- Form design and questionnaires
- Circulars and newsletters
- Notices and advertisements
- Publicity materials
- Graphic communication

3. Business correspondence

- Handling mail
- Incoming mail
- Outgoing mail
- Sorting and classification of mail
- Storage and retrieval, retention of records
- Filing systems
- Postal and courier services
- Mail handling equipment

4. Oral communication

- Meaning of oral communication
- Effective listening

- Interviews
- Pervasion process
- Assertiveness

5. Non-verbal communication
- Meaning and importance of non-verbal communication
- Forms of non-verbal communication
- Effective non-verbal communication

6. Public speaking and presentations
- Effective presentation skills
- Presentation aids
- Selection and preparation
- Language and style
- Context in public speaking
- Writing and delivery of public speeches
- Public discussion format: public discussion and symposium

7. Group team communication
- Group communication skills
- Communication networks
- Team communication
- Interpersonal relationship
- Principles of interpersonal communication
- Meetings

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8. Report writing
- Types of reports
- Effective report writing
- Uses of reports
- Preparation of formal reports

9. Proposal writing
- Types of proposals
- Uses of proposals
- Contents of proposals
- Preparation of formal proposals

10. Information communication and technology
- Communication networks: internet, intranet and extranet
- Teleconferencing and videoconferencing
- Wireless technologies
- Social media
- Skype

11. Ethics in communication

- Ethical issues in communication
- Significance of ethical communication
- Factors influencing ethical communication
- Ethical dilemmas in communication
- Guidelines to handle ethical dilemmas in communication

12. Emerging issues and trends

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TOPIC 1

INTRODUCTION TO COMMUNICATION

DEFINITION OF COMMUNICATION

- ✓ **Communication** Refers to the transmission or exchange of information between two or more persons .The information emanates from the **source** to **the destination** and eventually back to the source in the form of **a feed back**. The information being exchanged is referred to as **a massage** and the process develops to a communication process.

- ✓ Communication is all about sending and receiving information. It is in its simplest sense a human relationship involving people who come together to share, to dialogue and to continue**. Peter Little defines communication** in his words " **communication is the process by which information is transmitted between individuals and or, organizations so that an understanding response results**"

- ✓ William Scott in his organization theory defines communication" **Administrative communication is a process which involves the transmission and accurate replication of ideas ensured by feedback for the purpose of eliciting action which will accomplish the organizational goals"**

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THE OBJECTIVES OF COMMUNICATION

1. **Information**
   - One of the most important objectives of communication is passing and receiving information together with keeping records of information.
   - The information on the following aspects is vital for efficient operations of a business organization

Information about the product or service as to understand

- the customers satisfaction
- the customer's needs response
- meeting latest trends
- information about availability of credit
- information about availability of raw materials
- information about government rules and regulation
- information about technology development
- information about changing market trends
- Information about the competitors and changing trends in competition.

2) For planning purposes on;

i) job assignments and procedures governing production
ii) decision making
iii) development and growth of the organization
iv) environmental development
v) marketing strategies
vi) Countering competition.

3) To meet the organization goals such as;

i) profitability
ii) sourcing for investment capital
iii) social responsibility
iv) the organization structure
v) Customer satisfaction.

4) For internal operations

The internal information includes:-

i) Production
ii) Sales and marketing
iii) Staff members on recruitment promotions and other appraisals
iv) The efficiency and reliability of operations.

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5) **Competitive information**.

Involves understanding the

i) rival companies, operations and weakness
ii) the strategies, strengths and weaknesses
iii) technological and marketing strengths

6) **Environmental information** such as – political, social, economic, culture, climatic and geographical information.

The sources of information

i) old files – provide a great deal of internal information
ii) observations
iii) mass media
iv) chambers of commerce
v) meeting seminars and conferences
vi) personal interviews
vii) questionnaires
viii) trade fairs and exhibitions
ix) The interne

Effects of poor communication

- Confusion
- Mistakes
- Wastage
- Accidents
- Frustrations
- Low morale and lack of motivation
- Strikes and unrest
- Poor transfer of information
- Feeling of dissatisfactions

The purpose of communication in business

1. Inform others and being informed
2. Evaluating an organizations input & output
3. Directing others and being directed
4. Influencing others and being influenced
5. Integrating management functions.
6. Facilitating internal and external communications.

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The importance of communication

1. Better performance
2. efficiency and timely delivery
3. improved customers relations
4. creation of better business prospective
5. better management
6. harmony among employment
7. coordination
8. proper resource utilization
9. Building of business reputation

Areas of emphasis when defining communication

i) The process of communication involves communication of ideas.
ii) The ideas should be accurately replicated ie .reproduced in the receiver's mind.
iii) The transmitter is assured of the accurate replication of ideas by feedback.
iv) The purpose of any communication is to elicit action.

Note:

✓ The above definition covers almost all aspects of communication but should also include two important aspects
   i) The concept of idea should be adequately enlarged to include.
   ii) Even in the administrative communication the purpose may not always be to elicit action but to

- Seeking information
- Persuading others etc.

✓ All communication has to be originated produced, transmitted, received and understood.
✓ The main aspects of communication which need to be considered are;
- The source of communication i.e... the message – (sender)
- The contents of communication is produced eg dictation – (Message)
- The method of transmission e.g... faxing (channel)
- The process involved in receiving e.g... mail handling
- The destination of the communication i.e..recipient. (receiver)
- The understanding of the communication (feedback)

✓ We can therefore conclude that communication exists when,
i) there is a person (a sender or transmitter) desirous of passing on some information
ii) There is another person (receiver) to whom the information is to be passed on.
iii) The receiver partly or wholly understands the message passed on to him (message)
iv) The receiver responds to the message (feedback)

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Forms of communication in a business venture

a. With Customers

✓ Most of the communication with customers is one way i.e... through;
i) advertisements
ii) direct mail
iii) sales promotions etc

✓ one can experience a two way communication with customers when;
i. there is physical contact with customers
ii. telesales
iii. questionnaires
iv. taking orders or deliveries
v. dealing with complaints

b. With Staff

✓ communicating with staff occurs when
i. delegating tasks
ii. appraising performances
iii. Resolving grievances EST
.

c) **Communicating with supplier**
i. placing orders
ii. dealing with returns outwards/ or replacements
iii. dealing with payments
iv. accounts reconciliation (creditors)

d) **Communicating with owners**
   i) Annual reports –AGM
   ii) Monthly or weekly returns for small organization.

e) Communicating with the community
   i. Involvement in various projects i.e... community projects
   ii. environmental issues
   iii. marketing activities
   iv. Employment issues.

The importance of effective communication in business

I. Set up and establishment of a business

✓ Communication maybe described as the lifeblood of business. No business can develop in the absence of effective internal and external communication.

II. Management

✓ Communication is a vital tool of management the potentials of communication as a management too are so great and include.

- Favorable dealing with outside companies
- Effective relationships within an organization
- Conducting effectively the functions of the organization
- Controlling and coordination in order to meet the organizational goals and objectives
- Maintaining external relationships with customers and suppliers

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III. Organization Structure

The structure of the organization and delegation/ consultancy

- The leadership style of management adopted by the organization will have significant impact on the amount and effectiveness of the communication.
- A democratic style of leadership involves junior people in the organizational decision making process to varying degrees, this requires a two-way communication for the structure to be effective
- Organizations with autocratic leaders are likely to have less communication and much of it one way I.e...Downward communication.

IV. Motivation

- Motivation techniques have changed in the recent years. Although money is still perceived as a chief motivator, non financial methods have taken over and relate to communications & job design
- Effective communication is currently the chief motivator and generates excellent relationship between employers and employees.

V. Decision making

- Communication in an organization not only receives records and processes information but also communicates this information to management to enable the management make

effective and timely decisions with regard to, directing controlling and coordinating the activities of the organization.

VI. Implementation of change

- Effective communication is an essential element of business success. It enables change implementation encourages and develops commitment to the business from employees at all levels within the organization.

VII. Appointment and promotion of employees

- Through communication the right staff can be solicited for and facilitate development of promotional policies in an organization.

VIII. Communication to the outside.

- Effective communication enables the organization creates good link with stake holders, the media &suppliers generating related benefits.
- Access to relevant information is possible to allow proper planning, prioritizations, co-ordination and controlling.

The benefits of effective communication with stake holders

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a. The suppliers

i. Through communication prompt supply can be achieved increasing profitability in production.
ii. Good communication increases efficiency and effective delivery of support services e.g... Credit facilities and good will.
iii. Any differences or misunderstanding can be sorted effectively and satisfactory on each party.

b. The customers

- Communication facilitates understanding of;
- Customers needs and satisfaction level
- Product quality based on feed backs
- Distribution channels which meet requirements
- Pricing decisions
- Packaging requirements
- Segmentation requirements.

c. Employees

i. Good communication facilitates
ii. motivation in the working environment
iii. high level performance
iv. minimization of wastage
v. Meeting targets and organization goals.

d. General public

i. good communication creates
ii. awareness of social changes
iii. environment of recruiting quality staff
iv. achieving profitable sales
v. creating good will of the business through community project participation

e. Other stake holders

- communication enhances other relationships of other stakeholders such as;
  i. competitors
  ii. Other business companies e.g... insurance companies
  iii. the government departmental
  iv. financial institution

THE COMMUNICATION PROCESS

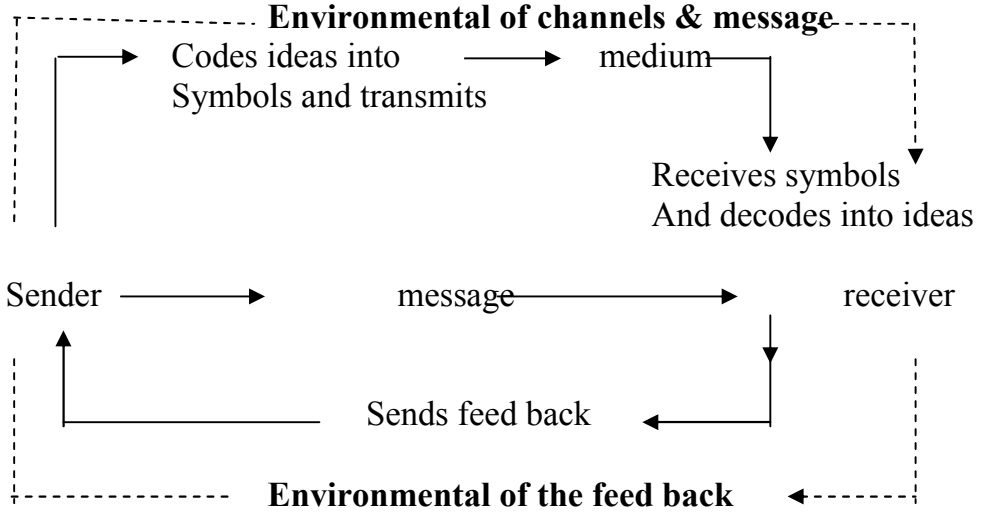
Definition:
A communication process refers to the transmission mechanism of transferring information from the sender via a medium to the receiver and obtaining feedback to confirm understanding of the message communicated.

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The communication process constitutes the following element

i) The sender
ii) The message.
iii) The medium
iv) The receiver and
v) The feedback

The process can be illustrated as below.



1. Sender

✓ The sender has certain functions to perform when the communication process is to work smoothly. The receiver role include:

i. Clarify the message (information) being sent.
ii. Choose a language that will be understood by the receiver
iii. Code the idea/ information into the language or symbol he intends to use bearing in mind clarity
iv. Appreciate the receiver and his circumstances
v. The message must be pitched to the level of understanding of the receiver not so high that would render the receiver failing to group meaning and not too low as to insult the receiver.
vi. The sender must decide on the symbols he is going to use – in communication the most commonly used symbols are words figures, body movement or signs.
vii. Close contacts, tones of voice or facial expressions convey certain attitudes of the sender or message and he/she should decide.
viii. The sender has to decide on the medium to use (means of transmitting) e.g... Telephone writing EST.
ix. The sender must decide on the channel he will use (the channel is the route which the message will reach the receiver – delivered by hand written members.
x. The sender has a responsibility for the quality of the transmission of the message e.g... Speaking clearly or writing clearly or announcing clearly.

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2. The message

- ✓ Having been coded from the ideas of the sender into symbols (words, figures est.) the message is taken up by the medium and passed along its selected route.
- ✓ The route of a message involves a particular environment e.g...
  - The oral message follows the route of sound words, noise EST...
  - Written memos go through the physical environment of the organization as it moves.
  - Wireless medium are now accessible to many

3. The receiver

- ✓ This is the person that the sender wishes to reach with his message. He/She receives the message and decodes the symbols back into ideas. Once the message has been correctly received and understood, the receiver will perceive the idea or image of the sender's.

- ✓ Normally the receiver will send back a message to the sender to confirm through feedback. For this feedback the sender will usually be able to determine how his message was understood.

- ✓ Where the understanding is poor he will have to;

- Retransmit
- Alter the level of the pitch (to facilitate understanding)
- Change the medium
- Change the channel in case there were problems.

✓ Only when the sender receives a positive feedback can it be measured that the transmission of the message was effective.

4. The medium/Channel

✓ Refers to how the message is passed they include:-

i. Verbal or oral medium
ii. Written medium
iii. Non-verbal
iv. Visual
v. Audio visual

5. Feedback

✓ Refers to the response from the receiver that the message has been understood.

The Problems in the Communication Process

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✓ Any problems in the communication process means ineffective communication – or no communication

✓ Any obstacles in the communication process may lie on.

1. **Networks**– a communication network embrace only those who need the information and feedback to achieve their objectives
    - It is important to update the membership to avoid any breakdown in the communication process

    - **Load-** the concept of load is related to the speed and nature of information it should be simplein nature without the problem of; overload/under i.e...A situation where the receiver is loaded with greater quantities and complex information the system cannot handle and under – load – a situation where the receiver could handle a higher quality and quantity of information.

2. **Medium and content**
    - It is crucial that management select the appropriate medium eg Written oral or visual.

    - A wrong selection can impede on effective communication and the content of a message be in adequate and in appropriate. This can be achieved though.

i. Not using long words where short words can do

ii. Use the right English word appropriately instead of jargon

iii. Where a word ought to be left out do so

iv. Never use the passive tense where you can use active – passive language is more direct and honest e.g...

- "Action was taken this morning" (passive)
- I' took action this morning" (active)

3. Inter personal problems

✓ some of the most serious problems experienced in the communication process arises from the attitudes

- Lack of willingness to communicate especially secretive people and those who use information as a tool of power.
- Or fear especially where communication involves junior people to senior staff (upward communication)
- Preconception on the part of the transmitter or receiver especially in situations where people have different backgrounds and experience, who tend see and interpret things differently.

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Guidelines of effective communication

1. the message sender must clarify in their mind what they want to communicate and make a plan to achieve the intended result
2. Effective communication requires that encoding and decoding be done with symbols that are familiar to the sender and the receiver of the message- avoiding unnecessary technical jargon.
3. The planning of the communication should not be done in vacuum – involve all concerned persons and do extensive consultation.
4. It is important to consider the needs of the receiver of the message and any communication is of value in the short and long run.
5. In communication the tone of voice, the choice of language is important and must be compatible with the message re-laid.
6. There should be a two way communication. The receiver should not only send feedback but also request for clarifications or ask questions
7. Develop sensitivity to the needs and feelings of others when communicating especially where the gap is wide.
8. effective communication is a responsibility not only to the sender but also to the receiver of the information thus developing effective listening adds effectiveness to communication
9. Solve the problem of load either by redesigning the organization so as to reduce load at heavily committed points or arranging queering system as to deal with messages sequencing.

10. One should be brief in the message sent and allow simplicity and a direct style of communication.
11. Accuracy and precision, facilitates selective message transmission by sending what is needed to be communicated.

Important examination questions

1 a) Define communication (3mks)
b) Discuss the main aspects of communication (6mks)
c) Discuss the importance of a good communication (11mks)

2 a) "The single most significant characteristics of the human race is the ability to communicate"
Discuss (20mks)

3 a) "Communication is the sum of all things one person does when he wants to create understanding in the mind of another. It is a bridge of meaning
. It involves a systematic and continuous process of telling, listening and understanding" Discuss (20mks)

4 a) Describe briefly the main objectives of communication (11mks)

b) Write short notes on the following

i. Information for planning (3mks)
ii. Internal information (3mks)
iii . Environmental information(3mks)

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Business Communication

- ✓ Def. Refers to the communication within an organization (internal) & to the outside world (.External communication)
- ✓ Business communication is affected by factors such as
  - Globalization of business
  - Increase in workforce diversity
  - Increased value of information
  - Persuasiveness of technology
  - Reliance on teamwork
  - Evolution of organizational structure
  - Barriers to effective communication

- ✓ Success in business today one needs ability to communicate with people both inside and outside the organization.
- ✓ Effective communication occurs when others understand the message correctly and the feedback is that which is expected.

- ✓ E**ffective communication helps manage**

  - Workflow
  - Improve business relationship

- Enhances professional image good will
- Connects the company with all stakeholders and groups affected e.g... Customers, employee's etc.
- Facilitates quicker problem solving
- Stronger decision making
- Increased productivity
- Steadier work force
- Stronger business relationships
- Meeting the organizations goals

Forms of Business Communication

✓ Business communication takes three main forms namely:

i. Internal communication
ii. External Communication
iii. Communication networks

The increasing value of business information. –

✓ the value of information is competitive in business world on

- Competition for skilled workforce, raw materials and control of markets shares
- Competitive insights such as competitor's strengths and weakness.
- Customers needs so as to maintain customs royalty and increase sales
- Regulations and guidelines which cover government requirements on employment production, market requirements etc.

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Questions

1 a) Discuss the role of business communication
b) What are the benefits of effective communication?
c) Outline the increasing value of business information.

Media of communication.

Definition -Refers to the ways or path through which information is passed. They include:-

- Oral communication or verbal communication
- Non-verbal communication
- Written communication (non- verbal communication)
- Visual communication
- Audio – visual communication
- Electronic communication.

1. Oral or verbal communication

- ✓ It includes face to face conversations, telephone conversation, radio broadcasts, interviews, group discussions, meetings, conferences and seminars, announcements over public addresses system, speeches est.
- ✓ It refers to the exchange of information the use of words in a language understood by the both the sender and receiver of the message.

The merits of oral communication

1. Oral communication saves on time facilitating quick action.
2. oral communication saves on costs of printing sending e.tc
3. speech is a more powerful means of persuading and controlling
4. Conveys various shades of meaning through variations in tone, pitch and intensity of voice (efficacy) which written communication cannot achieve.
5. feedback in immediate
6. Clarification is obtainable and generates good relationship between senior staff and junior staff.

The limitations of oral communication

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1. Distance and lack of mechanical devices may limit oral communication
2. Oral communication may not be suitable in conveying lengthy messages
3. Oral messages cannot be retained for a long time
4. Oral messages do not have legal validity unless taped as part of a permanent record.
5. Easily miss-understood especially when dealing with a large audience.
6. In oral messages responsibilities for mistakes in any cannot be specifically assigned.

Essential of effective oral communication

1. Clear pronunciation i.e. clear pronunciation of words and correct use of words.
2. Brevity i.e... the message should be brief and concise
3. Conviction i.e...The person must be convinced of what he/she is saying lack of it will cause lack of confidence.
4. Precision makes oral communication very effective.
5. logically sequence reduces any confusion that may arise
6. appropriate word choice
7. avoiding hackneyed phrases such as " what I mean" "do you follow" "I see" isn't it"
8. Natural voice should be used at all times.

Important guidelines of giving oral instructions

1. Do not assume that the listener has prior knowledge about the subject
2. Select a suitable time of giving instruction.
3. organize the instruction so that they make sense to the listener
4. use simple clear, concise and accurate language
5. do not give any irrelevant or un important details
6. carefully watch the listener expressions to assess success
7. allow questions from your listeners
8. Repeat complicated instructions.

Charnels of oral communication

1 Face to face communication

- **Refers** to the process of exchanging information when both the receiver and sender are in a physically close to each other

  ✓ Appears identical with oral communication. However it is possible to identify situations in which the two may be distinguished.

  ✓ Telephonic conversation is oral but cannot be called face-to-face communication. Face to face communication brings the two parties together with facial expressions, shaking of lands and other contract features prevail.

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Merits of face to face communication

- facial expression and gestures facilitate better communication
- discussions results are best when oral discussion is used
- facilitates prompt feedback and action
- Provides the two parties a situation to adjust for better or clarify issues promptly.

Limitationsof face to face communication.

- Difficult to be practiced in large organizations especially where departmental locations are at a distance.
- In effective when communicating parties have pre-formed attitudes.
- In effective where the listener is not attentive.

i. Telephone conversation – refers to use of telephone call to convey messages
ii. Radio broadcasts – the passing of information
iii. Interviews
iv. Group discussions
v. meetings
vi. Conferences
vii. Seminars

2. Non-verbal Communication

- ✓ Refers to the process of passing information without the use of words.
- ✓ Typical examples include ,
- ✓ Silence, written communication and body language.

- **Silence**

- ✓ Silence is the most eloquent way of non verbal communication
- ✓ Silence can express
  - i) acceptance
  - ii) meeting of strangers
  - iii) refusal
  - iv) disapproval
  - v) anger
  - vi) resentment
  - vii) Lack of interest.

3. Written Communication

- ✓ Refers to the process of passing information through writing and the receiver has to read the message in order to understand. The most common means of written communication include:-

i. Letters
ii. Memos
iii. Minutes
iv. Reports
v. Notice etc

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Advantages/Merits of written communication

i. It is accurate and precise
ii. It can repeatedly be referred to
iii. It is a permanent record
iv. It is a legal document
v. It facilitates assigning responsibilities
vi. It has a wide access

Disadvantages/ Limitations of written communication

i. It is time consuming
ii. It is costly
iii. Immediate clarification is not possible
iv. Communication is only to those who are educated i.e. read and write

Essential of effective communication

- Clarity

- Completeness
- Conciseness
- Considerations
- Courtesy
- Correctness

4. Body Movement e.g... facial expressions

✓ A facial expression is non- verbal communication element also referred to as the body language by George Terry – it includes.

i. Rolling
ii. Shrinking
iii. Winking
iv. Twinkling
v. Frowning
vi. Twisting the lips
vii. Wobbling the head
viii. Movement of the hands etc

5. Visual Communication

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- Includes gestures and facial expressions, tables and charts, diagrams, posters, slides film etc.
- Mime is an old art in which ideas and emotions are communicated through facial expressions and gestures.
- Road signs are typical examples of the use of visual communication
- Visual communication can be used to transmit simple ideas, orders, warnings etc
- ✓ It is more effective when used with other media, example when one combines a diagram with written communication .

6. Audio Visual Communication

- Makes use of
  - telecasts
  - Short films on cinema screens
  - Video tapes and discs
  - Power point.
- Combines sound and sight and with latest use of written information
- Explanations, narrations and interpretations make visual communication more effective.
- The information passed normally would stay in the mind longer.
- It is suitable for mass publicity and education
- The production must be of greater equity.

7. Electronic Communication

- ✓ Is communication by use of electronic equipments such as computers and televisions? Electronic communication has greatly facilitated.
  - i) electronic banking
  - ii) electronic publishing
  - iii) electronic ticketing

- ✓ the use of satellite communication via television and cables has transformed the world into a global village
- ✓ By use of a computer one can communicate directly with other person using a computer too. The computer uses tiny pulses of electricity along cable representing digital code which code and decode the pulses to communicate information insecond's .

- ✓ the information will be in the form of.
  - words
  - symbols
  - photograph
  - diagrams
  - moving pictures
  - speech or music
- ✓ computers can also communicate directly with other electronic devices that use digital technology such as;
  - digital telephones
  - digital cameras
  - image scanners

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- ✓ The internet is an international network of computers and similar electronic machines, linked by the wires, cables, radio-Waves and satellites of telecommunication systems.

- ✓ The system converts and carries signals between computers in the same way that it carries the sounds of telephone calls.
  Information exchanged in the net can be in the form of words, pictures, and diagrams sounds moving, images etc

- ✓ Other parts such as the World Wide Web (www) provide millions of pages of information available to millions of people.
  The World Wide Web(www or the net) is part of the internet. It is made up of a huge number of inter-linked documents containing pages of information.

- ✓ Visitors or clients access the web using a piece of software called **web browser.** The internet service provider provides (ISP) may provide browser software, but it is also widely available elsewhere .With a browser the client can go directly to a known page, address- identified by its URL (i.e... the unique resource location.)

Electronic Mail

- ✓ Electronic mail (e-mail) is a process by which one person can exchange messages with other people entirely on computers
- ✓ Actually E-mails do much the same as ordinary mails except for the fact that email only uses electronic communication i.e...Computers.
- ✓ The most basic form of email is where one computer is connected to another via a telephone

Types of E-email

a) Internal e-mail

- Operates within an organization. It is usually on a local area network (LAN) based mail system.
- Messages may be passed amongst network computer user's e.g. Replacement of internal memos etc. – it is normally suitable for large organizations.

b) External E-mail

- Enables individuals or organizations to communicate with other individuals or organization anywhere in the world.
- This is achieved using one of the external e-mail networks such as CompuServe, MCI mail six and the internet. The internet is the most popular and commonly used network
- The advantage of a commercially run online e-mail service is that you don't need your own network so the amount of management time required to look after it is minimized.

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Equipments (hardware and software) required.

- ✓ All e-mails require some sort of communication software, depending upon what it is required to do. .Arrange of software is available, each has its own standard ways of working, but a basic e-mail system should provide the key services of;

  i) identifying the recipient of the message
  ii) locating the receiver
  iii) finding a route along which the message can be sent

- ✓ The basis of internal mail system is usually a LAN – where the users long to access the mail software. Using external e-mail via a network such as the internet requires the use of a pc, a modem and an account with the service provider.

Addressing E-Mail

- ✓ In e-mail each user has a unique mailing address all e-mail addresses should be typed entirely in lower case letters (no capitals)
  - Each address identifies the user and their " domain"
  - The user's name comes before and @ symbol.

Advantages of E-mail

1. E-mail messages can be sent to the recipient's mailbox at any time and at the sender's convenience.
2. e-mails are quick to deliver information
3. Confirmation of receipt is possible
4. Provide evidence of communication and can be used as evidence
5. Can transfer large sums of information.
6. Cheaper to send information
7. E-mails are more flexible than fixed information.
8. Efficient in disbursing information to many people
9. Use of E-mail requires minimal training.

Disadvantages

1. expensive to install
2. busy offices may not fully utilize its use
3. companies tend to over look training on its use
4. tends to exclude others (personalized)
5. use of E-mail may result to time wasting by staff on non-official use of PC
6. mail server may crash
7. System error may affect the entire delivery of important mail.

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Video Conferencing

- ✓ Describes a range of activities made possible by development in telecommunication technology.
- ✓ The basic idea is that users can see each other and share information in various forms without having to be on the same location i.e... meeting or traveling
- ✓ It provides a person- to person contact at a distance which is essence is

A reduction in travel costs

- A reduction in travel costs
- A saving of time
- Facilitates meeting of people at different locations
- Access to expertise in remote areas
- Increases availability of personnel
- Increases efficiency and productivity

Communication Policy

Definition of Policy

- ✓ A policy is a concise formal statement of principles which indicate how an organization will act in particular area of its operations e.g. communication

- ✓ These principals are derived from and shaped by the law and regulations that govern that organization, the national standards & the community expectations together with the values, vision and mission of the organization.
- ✓ It is the role of any policy to;
  - **i)** Translate values into operations
  - **ii)** Ensure compliance with legal and statutory responsibilities
  - **iii)** Guide the organization towards achieving its strategic plan
  - **iv)** Set the standards
  - **v)** Improve management of risks

- ✓ **A communication policy** therefore refers to the laid down principals and regulations which relate to the systematic flow or path through which information (messages) is transmitted or passed through patterns of interaction among people
  - **i)** With the organization
  - **ii)** Outside the organization
  - **iii)** With the organization networks
- ✓ The policy will clearly define communication patterns by structuring internal communication system into
  - **a)** Formal communication
  - **b)** Informal communication

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The formal lines of communication

- **i)** Downward communication
- **ii)** Upward communication
- **iii)** Lateral communication
- **iv)** Diagonal communication will be clearly defined

- ✓ The policy will highlight on the validity and us of grapevine in the organization.

- ✓ **The communication policy w**ill also detail regulations on the external communication in all its forms i.e.

  - **i)** Telephone verbal
  - **ii)** Written communication
  - **iii)** E-communication
  - **iv)** Fax mile e.t.c

- ✓ In order to protect its image and establish good will among its customers and the rest of stake holder's.A policy will clearly define the scope of **any networks** that may

exist in the organization. communication networks are classified groups of people who handle information that may be

- Secret in nature
- Confidential or
- Classified

✓ A communication policy establishes those included in the network and the extent to which such matters may be disclosed.

Effects of a good communication policy

✓ A communication policy will detail the functions and effectiveness of an organization's

a) Internal communication system
b) External communication system
c) The networks system

1 .Effects of a good policy on the internal communication system

✓ An internal communication policy lays down principals of ;

- Formal communication and
- Informal communication

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a) Formal communication system

✓ Formal communication refers to the officially laid down procedures of communication
✓ A good internal policy will clearly define the following lines of communication

i) Downwards communication(the flow of information from the top of the subordinate staff.)

- The policy will facilitate good relationship between the top officers reducing autocratic leadership
- Open door policy operations to reduce gap between top and subordinates
- Effective orders being given and executed
- Efficiency in operations between the subordinates and the management.

ii) Upward communication (the flow of information from junior staff (subordinate) to the management)

- A good policy will remove fear and create openness between the subordinates and management
- New ideas can easily be shares among employee facilitating creativity., through implementation of suggestion scheme

iii) **Diagonal communication**. refers to communication between a senior manager in one department eg finance to a person of a lower rank in another department eg H/R

- A good policy will create departmental harmony and operations increasing efficiency and timely processing of information

iv) **Lateral communication** – (communication between two manager of similar ranks but of different departments)

- A good policy will enhance co-ordination and efficient system of processing information on time. The relationship will be of support to each other without delays but full of consultation.

2. Informal communication

- ✓ A good communication policy will facilitate utilization of informal channels of communication .The flow of unplanned information among employees such that ;
  - Any alerts or warnings can easily be communicated on time.
  - Any remedies required can be put in place on time
  - Feeling of subordinates can be expressed freely in areas of correction

a) **External communication** – i.e. communication from the organization to the outside world of

i) Making phone calls outside the organization with minimum supervision and costs

ii) Replies are prompt and professional phone handling officers are not present after messages are taken

iii) Written message are made professionally in order to boost the organization image out there

iv) Procedures of mail collection processing and sending are effectively put in place.

b) **Communication networks**. refers to the classified information that is exchanged within an organization

- ✓ A good communication policy will enhance
  - The composition and types of networks that will exist in the organization
  - The type of information to be considered as classified
  - The various secretes to be shares and the members to own it
  - The information to be considered confidential and those to handle the information.

✓ A good policy will therefore be a significant tool in any organization if the overall goals and objectives are to be achieved.

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REVISION QUESTIONS

Question 1

a) Define communication and clearly state five areas of emphasis in your definition (10mks)

b) Explain the main aspects of communication in the communication process of originating, producing, transmitting, receiving and understanding information. (10mk)

Question 2

Explain five ways of communicating to each of the following stakeholders

I) Customers (4mks)
ii) Staff (4mks)
iii) Suppliers (4mks)
iv Owners or share holders (4mks)
v) Community (4mks)

Question 3

a) Explain the importance of effective communication in business (10mks) Explain the importance of effective communication to the following stake holders

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i) Suppliers (4mks)
ii) Customers (4mks)
iii) Employees (4mks)
iv) Generalpublic (4mks)
v) Other stakeholders (4mks)

Question 4

a) Define using a well illustrated (6mks)

b) What are the objectives of communication (14mks)

Question 5

"The single most significant characteristic of the human race is the ability to communicate "

Explain the role of the following in the communication process

i. The receiver
ii. The sender
iii. The medium (20mks)

Question 6

"Communication is the sum of all things one person does when he wants to create understanding in the mind of another. It is a bridge of meaning. It involves a systematic and continuous process of telling, listening and understanding" discuss (20mks)

Question 7

a) Describe briefly the main objectives of communication (10mks)

b) Write explanatory notes of the following

i) Information for planning

ii) Internal information

iii) Environmental information.

Question 8

a) Define business communication

b) Explain the factors which may affect business communication

c) What are the benefits of effective business communication

Question 9

a) Highlight 7 methods of business communication

b) Outline the increasing value of business information.

Question 10

a) What is a channel of communication

b) Define oral communication and explain the essentials of effective oral communication

c) What are the advantages and disadvantages of oral communication?

d) Explain the guidelines of giving oral instructions.

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Question 11

a) Define face to face communication

b) What are the merits and demerits of face to face communication?

Question 12

a) Explain the role of the following aspects in communication

i) Communication by silence (4mks)

ii) Facial communication (4mks)

iii) Visual communication (4mks)

iv) Audio –visual communication (4mks)

Question 13

a) Explain the significance of oral communication

b) Discuss the relative merits and demerits of oral communication

c) Explain the different forms of oral communication

d) How oral communication be made effective.

Question 14

a) Compare and contrast written with oral communication
b) How can the process of giving oral instructions to workers are made effective.

Question 15

a) Distinguish between oral communication and face to face communication
b) What are the advantages of face to face communication

Question 16

a) Why is it necessary for entrepreneurs to make use of a combination of the various media of communication
b) What is video Conferencing
c) Explain the advantages of video conferencing

Question 17

a) What is electronic communication
b) What are the advantages and disadvantages of E-mail.

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Types of communication

- ✓ There are basically three types of communication. These are
  i. Internal communication
  ii. External communication
  iii. Communication net works
- ✓ Each type of communication is further classified into different types on the basis of direction of flow, relationships, means of communication and the method or equipments.

Internal Communication

- ✓ Refers to the communications within an organization. It is the flow of information among employees inter-departments and between the management and the subordinates

a) Internal channels of communication

- ✓ The internal channels of communication refers to the paths through which information or messages between employees and departments of the same organization flow e.g...
  - The communication between the employee and employees, and the communication between a company and its shareholders.

The Importance of Internal Communication

i) generates better understanding between the employer and employees
ii) facilitates better efficiency enabling management to give instruction on the organization policy

iii) facilitates effective co-ordination in the achievement of the organization goals
iv) Minimizes losses and facilitates timely actions.

The Classification of Internal Communication

✓ Internal Communication can be classified on the basis of;
- direction flow
- relationship
- means adopted
- methods used

a. On the basis of direction of flow

✓ internal communication flows into different directions according to the organization structure and the need of the enterprise
✓ Basically there are three directions of flow identified when communication is classified on the basis of flow i.e...

i. Downward Flow
✓ is the flow of communication moves downwards from superiors to subordinates of different levels of the organization
✓ Through this flow management plans, decisions and directives are communicated to lower levels for implementation.

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ii) Upward flow
✓ denotes to a flow of information upwards, from the lowest level to the highest level of the organization i.e. from subordinates to higher levels in the form of;
i. reports
ii. suggestions
iii. complaints.

iii) Horizontal flow
✓ this type of flow may be
i. lateral or
ii. diagonal
✓ Communication may take place laterally between persons of the same level of organizational hierarchy e.g..manager to manager in another department.
✓ It may also take place diagonally between managers or supervisors of separate department i.e. cutting across.

b) On the basis of relationships of communication
✓ On the basis of relationship communication is classified into two;

i) Formal communication – Refers to the sending of messages or information through

- ✓ Channels of formal relationships of authority and responsibility in the organization structure.
- ✓ Communication is strictly according to the formal organizational relationships established by management.

ii) Informal communication (grape vine)

- ✓ This is quite often described as grape vine.
- ✓ It takes place between persons or groups of the same or different levels of hierarchy on the basis of informal relationships.
- ✓ Information passes informally between persons or groups as they come into contact with each other in the course of performing their jobs.
- ✓ Although not officially recognized by management it is useful in increasing the effectiveness of formal communication in an organization once given its place.

c.) On the basis of means adopted

✓ On the basis of means adopted communication may be of two types; oral and written.

i. Oral communication

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✓ Is the easier and most commonly used means of communication? The use of words may take place through face to face conversations, telephone discussions, meetings.

ii. Written communication

✓ Here messages (information) are communicated both internally and externally through written media like letters, reports, memos...

d) On the basis of the method used

✓ The methods used to communicate on this basis can be broadly classified into two;

i. Direct communication

✓ Oral communication can take a direct form especially on
  - o A face to face communication
  - o Interviews
  - o Meetings EST.

✓ While manual delivery of reports or mail by messages or postal services

ii. Mechanical transmission

✓ Oral communication can be conducted with the help of various devices like telephones, mobiles EST...

- ✓ The mechanical transmission of written communication includes faxing, television email, telephones

Types of Internal Communication

✓ Internal communication takes two main forms in any organization i.e. formal communication and informal communication.

a) Formal communication

- ✓ Formal communication follows laid down procedures of communication in the organization structure of an enterprise.
- ✓ The employees of the enterprise are supposed to communicate with each other strictly as per the channels laid down in the structure.
- ✓ Formal communication may take any of the following forms or combinations.

I)Downward communication.

- ✓ Is the flow of information from superiors to subordinates
- ✓ This method of formal communication is suited in organization in which the lines of authority run directly downwards with each rank clearly below another.

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The main objectives of downward communication

i) to give specific directives about a job entrusted subordinates
ii) to explain policies and organizational procedures
iii) To motivate or pass credit to subordinates.
iv) To explain the policies of the organizational and organizational procedures.
v) To clarify or set goals
vi) Bring understanding and a sense of mission.

The media of downward communication

- ✓ Downward communication may be both oral and written
- ✓ Important directives to initiate actions may be communicated through;
  i. Letters
  ii. Memos
  iii. E-mails
- ✓ Policies and procedures may be announced through
  i. Circulars
  ii. Manuals
  iii. Bulletins
  iv. Meetings

- ✓ Annual reports may be found suitable when acquiring from the lower staff the activities or achievements of the organization are completed or in progress.

Limitations of downward communication

1. under-communication or over-communication i.e. too little message is passed or sometimes too much of a message
2. delays due to long-lines of transmitting messages
3. Loss of information especially where it is not written but being transmitted verbally.
4. Distortion due to long lines of communication.
5. Built –in resistance caused by a few individuals using authoritarian leadership style.
6. misunderstanding and misinterpretations

Essentials of effective downwards communication

1. Managers should keep themselves well informed of the objectives activities and goals of the organization.
2. Managers must work according to communication plan and make decisions beforehand.
3. There should not be over-concentration of authority at the highest level. This will eliminate delays and facilitate harmony.
4. The information must be passed on to the correct person in the hierarchy to facilitate smooth flow of information.

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ii. Upward Communication (Vertical Communication)

- ✓ Occurs when information is carried from sub-ordinates to superiors and the messages that flow upwards are not orders or instructions but consist of
  i. Information on the progress being made
  ii. Details of requirements for success
  iii. Problems being experienced
  iv. Pressure on management on areas of interest

The importance of upwards communication

1. Provides feedback which ascertain that directives issued were well executed
2. Out-let for pent-up emotions, problems or grievances
3. A source of constructive suggestions
4. new procedures schemes can be easily introduced
5. Facilitates greater harmony and cohesion.

The methods of upward communication

1. Open –door policy – where employee is given a feeling that the manager's doors are always open to them.
2. complaints and suggestions boxes (schemes)
3. social gathering and sharing between managers and subordinates
4. direct correspondences
5. counsel ling

The Limitations of upward communication.

1. employees are usually reluctant to initiate upward communication
2. fear of adverse effect on their jobs if they reported their problems to the managers
3. upward flow of communication is more prone to distortion
4. Workers may become too bold, too used to their seniors as to start ignoring instructions.

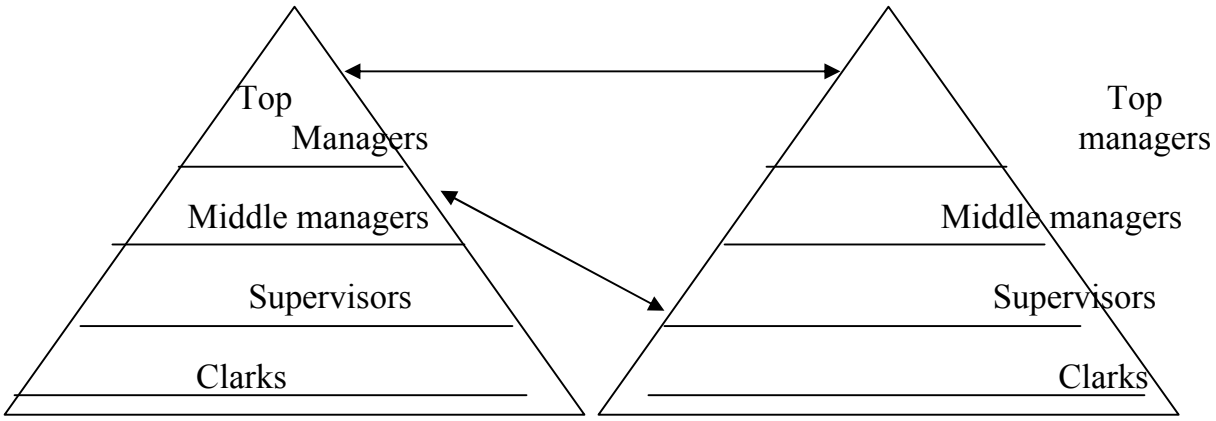
The essentials of effective upward communication

1. managers should encourage employees to be free and overcome the awe of authority
2. keep information lines as short as possible to deal with distortions of information
3. Genuine grievances deserve immediate resolution.

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iii. The horizontal line of communication

- ✓ Another important internal formal comm. Channel is horizontal communication. This is the flow of information between individuals in different department or regions within the same organization. These formal communications may cut across all levels of authority. Horizontal communication may flow laterally or diagonally.



a)Direct horizontal communication (lateral)

- ✓ Refers to the flow of information between individual or similar rank or position in different department as illustrated.

b) Indirect horizontal communication (diagonal)

- ✓ Communication between one level in one department and a different level of another department

The benefit of a horizontal communication

i) fully informed management team will prevail in an organization
ii) Adequate co-operation and joint action is achieved more easily.
iii) The risk of damaging intersection or interdepartmental are reduced
iv) Genuine difficulties or problems or differences of opinion are resolved more quickly and in good spirit.
v) Changes in system or procedures involving more than one department can be discussed or agreed more easily or successfully.

Barriers of horizontal communication

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i. Lack of incentive to communicate with other departments
ii. increased specialization leading to the reduction of the extent to which members share common interest
iii. People in different departments holding different goals and viewpoints leading to misunderstanding and conflicts.

Ways of improving horizontal communication

- Developing more employee awareness on the overall organizational goals and co-ordination among departments though training programs.
- Introducing interactive devices in the organizational structure such as interdepartmental task force.

NOTE

i) Lateral communication

- ✓ Lateral communication is also referred to **as direct horizontal communication**. .It takes place among departments or people on the same level of the hierarchy. Such an interchange of information often serves to co-ordinate activities.

- ✓ Lateral communication also serves or occurs between line and staff organizational structure for the purpose of transmitting technical information necessary to carry out some particular function.

The benefits of lateral communication

i) Facilitates coordination and co-operation among different departments.
ii) Facilitates quick processing of information in different departments.

ii)Diagonal communication

- ✓ Diagonal communication involves the flow of information among departments or individual on different levels of the organizational hierarchy – it is also known as **indirect horizontal communication**.

- ✓ This often occurs in the case of line and staff organizational structure in which the staff has functional authority. It is also common to find diagonal communication among line departments in which one of them has a functional authority.

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Revision Examinations questions

Question 1

a) Explain the various channels of communication (10mks)
b) Write a detailed notes on the;
   I) Importance
   ii) Advantages
   iii) Limitations of any of the two channels names above (10mks)

Question 2

a) Explain the main objectives of downward communication (6mks)
b) How can downward communication be made more effective (6mks)
c) Explain the merits and demerits of downward communication(8mks)

Question 3

"Downward channels of communication may be the most commonly used but it is also the most inadequate and
Unsatisfactory channel of internal communication" Discuss 20mks)

Question 4

a) What are the essentials of effective downward communication (10mks)
b) Briefly discuss the importance upward communication. (10mks)

Question 5

a) Write brief notes on the following
   i. open door policy
   ii. complaints and suggestion boxes
   iii. counseling (6mks)
b) Upward communication is very useful but very difficult. Could you suggest the methods that you could
   Use to effectively increase its efficiency? (14mks)

Question 6

a) Discuss the relative merits and importance of Horizontal and vertical channels of communication (14mks)
b) Explain the main causes of poor communication in an organizati(8mks)

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Question 7

a) What do you understand by grapevine (4mks)
b) Explain its importance to an organization (8mks)
c) How does grapevine work in an organization (8mks)

Question 8

a) How the harmful effects of grapevine be controlled in an organization (10mks)
b) One should feed, water and cultivate the grapevine rather than try to curb its growth"discuss (10mks)

Question 9

a) Briefly discuss the working and utility of consensus process for a commercial organization
(10 mks)
b) Distinguish between formal and informal channels of communication .(10mks)

Question 10

a) Why is it necessary for an organization to have the following channels of communication?
   i. Informal channels

ii. Communication networks (10mks)

Question 11

a) what kind of communication policy would you recommend for an organization suffering from poor communication (12mks)
b) Why does an organization need multiple channels of communication?.(8mks)

Question 12

a) Define consensus line of communication (4mks)
b) What are the advantages and disadvantages of consensus line of communication(16mks)

Lines of formal communication:

✓ Refer to the direction in which information is transmitted from one person to another in an organization. This direction is determined by the ranks of the people involved and the type of organization structure in place.. Information mainly flows in a vertical or horizontal or downward manner.

a) **Downward communication**. This type of communication is carried out where the rank of one of the parties is junior to the other. Lines of authority and responsibility are clearly spelt out in such as way that directive, instructions and policies from top decision – makers flow down to the people who will then implement them.

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b) **Vertical communication** .(**upward communication**) occurs when ideas, suggestions, criticisms, complaints, grievances and queries flow from the employees to their superiors vertical communication is also called upward communication

c) Horizontal communication – this type of communication is carried out between people of the same rank, eg.Between two departmental heads.When two departmental heads communicate a **direct horizontal communication** takes place. This is also referred to **as lateral communication.**

-
- When the communication involves senior manager with junior workers but of different department then the communication is referred to **as indirect horizontal or diagonal communication**

✓ One of the main characteristics of this type of communication is that there are fewer inhibitions. The people involved are more open and freer with each other than when they are communicating with the other lines of communication.

✓ An example where this type of communication could take place is when the marketing manager communicates with the distribution strategy head. Horizontal communication facilitates co-ordination in the activities of a business.

d) Consensus line of communication

- ✓ This line of communication is common in the political spheres and in the commercial fields where unanimous decisions help reach agreement or decisions. Consensus does not imply unanimity for perfect unanimity is just but impossible.

- ✓ It simply means that majority of the people subscribe to a particular view which all members are willing to accept in the large interest of the organization.

The consensus process

- ✓ the process follows the following steps
  i. Involves consultations either of different individuals or a meeting of many.
  ii. Members' views are carefully listened to in the light of discussions.
  iii. The solutions most acceptable are put forward to facilitate decision making
  iv. The manager gives directions on arriving at the best decisions.

Advantages of consensus

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6. Decisions are easily acceptable because they are arrived at by many.
7. Consensus project an image of unity and harmony in the organization.
8. Employee morale is raised facilitating confidence with superiors.
9. Unnecessary and undesirable conflicts or splits are avoided.

Disadvantages of consensus

1. some members are forced to subscribe to a view they may not hold
2. dissents, discontent may still exist among few members
3. the consensus process often becomes an accommodation of minority interests
4. Subordinates may sometimes develop the feeling that the management is incapable of making decisions and lose confidence on them.

b) Informal channels of communication (grape –vine communication)

- ✓ Since formal communication channels represent only a portion of the channels that exist within the structure, or the internal communication, much or the remaining communication is informal in nature .**Informal communication is the unplanned for communication. It is also referred to as grape- vine communication.**

Def. informal communication

- ✓ Informal communication refers to the communication between people who get together and discuss a subject of common interest without having any formal arrangements or subject.

- ✓ Such discussions may well be within the authority of the participants but the actual circumstances may not be as officially prescribed and to that extent the communication is informal.
- ✓ some members of a committee may meet together before the official committee meetings to have an (informal) discussion on the matters to be discussed and perhaps even to agree on;
    - how the subject will be handled
    - Who speaks
- ✓ As members of the committee authorized to discuss a given subjects, it is in order to hold informal discussions to prepare the way for an official meeting without minutes of the meeting.
- ✓ A member of staff may wish to have a private informal discussion with his/her manager about future prospects. Such informal communications are usually oral, the subject and the line of communication may be within the authority of the people concerned.

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The informal channels of communication

a. The grape-vine
b. Outside services e.g... radio, newspapers
c. Contracts through friends and relatives
d. Informal consultants.

The grape vine

- ✓ **.**Refers to the flow of unplanned for information in an organization. The grape-vine can be a source of factual data, though the term has the connection of inaccurate information

- ✓ Grape-vine provides people with an outlet for their imagination and apprehensions. There is a logical pattern in which grape-vine works.

- ✓ There are key positions in the grapevine structure and many of these are held by people in relatively low organizational positions eg . secretaries (who tend to have great deal of written materials).

Importance of Grape vine

1. As a safety value – apprehensive feelings experienced by workers e.g...promotions , refreshments etc are discussed offering emotional relief
2. promote organizations solidarity and cohesion
3. complement to other channels of communication
4. offers quick transmission of information
5. Provides feedback to management.
6. It enables them to know what the subordinate think about the organization and its various activities.

Demerits of grapevine

i) distortion – giving incorrect information
ii) incomplete information
iii) Caused damage at a short time.

How to use grapevine effectively

1. the manager should try to spot the leaders
2. the grapevine should be used to tell the feelings of the employees
3. If there is any false rumor, the management should immediately use the official channels to contradict and dispel the fears of employees.
4. If the workers are associated with decision making, the rumor will be automatically frustrated.

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How to avoid grapevine

1. tell people what is going on before they start off grapevine
2. talk to people in groups not individually so that they all get the same message
3. use proper official channels of communication.
4. hold brief meetings regularly, while the meetings are on, and encourage questions
5. give information in writing
6. consult workers

The disadvantages of informal communication

a) Informal executive agreements on a problem promotes rapid and effective actions at top management level.
b) Facilitate resolving disputes without having to involve higher management.
c) informal decisions prompt rapid actions as opposed to the cumbersome processes of formal procedures
d) Points can be made that would be too delicate or controversial when made officially.
e) It gives early warnings of a pending or potential problem.
f) Tends to put forward good ideas.

c) External Communication Channels

- ✓ Organizations have communication links with their input sources and output connections i.e. the suppliers and raw materials, spare parts services est. and the customers to whom these goods or services are sold egWholesalers, agents, retailers etc.
- ✓ As an organization grows the number of communication links with outside environment grows,it is important that external communication channels (system) be integrated with the internal communication system (channels) in order to effectively facilitate good communication.
- ✓ For examples , an order received from a customer (external communication) has to be processed and executed within the organization (internal communication) then the documents of sale such as a sales invoice or receipts be sent to or communicated to the customer (external communication)

The Importance of External Communication

1. To meet statutory requirements

- ✓ Registration now compels organizations to disclose certain information by
  - The recognized trade unions the employment protect Act 1975 requires employees to disclose such information to the representatives of recognized trade unions for good industrial relations practice.
  - The public – i.e. the publication of financial and trading positions to protect potential investors and suppliers.
  - The government department, agencies and other official bodies- for especially tax purposes.

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2. To increased and improve business

- ✓ For sustained and efficient supply of materials and any other deliveries to be distributed by wholesalers.

3. To improve the organizations image

- ✓ The people with whom the organization deals or with whom it comes into contact with will have an image of the organization. In order to improve the organization's image.

  - Telephone calls must be answered promptly.
  - Correspondence is handled efficiently.
  - Letters be neat and well written
  - Accurate information which is updated on catalogues prices EST.

d) Communication Networks

- ✓ Another channel of communication is known as the communication net works.
- ✓ The communication networks are the patterns of individuals or groups who are transmitters and receivers of information in a given organization.
- ✓ Most of his patterns of communication are **restricted** or **classified** e.g. **Confidential** financial information made available to very few individuals.
- ✓ In establishing such channels of communication an organization draws the **" need to know**" concept **– this view argues that a network should only contain those individuals or groups of people who need to access a given type of information in order to achieve a given objective.**

Factors to consider when choosing the most appropriate method of communication.

a. The urgency of the message to be delivered i.e. faxing, telephones, emails est.is some of the fastest means.
b. the funds available for the business to spend e.g. is expensive to buy hardware for video conferencing while email are much cheaper or memos
c. The degree of formality or informality in the organization – informal environments will require letters, emails meeting rooms
d. How confidential or personal the message may b**e -** some communication guarantee confidentiality e.g..Email or faxes.
e. The number of people to receive the communication
f. Chance to combine different methods to allow effective delivery- use of Audio – Visual means.

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Barriers of Communication

- ✓ Communication is most effective when it moves speedily and smoothly in an uninterrupted flow. Through frequently the free flow of communication breaks down due to barriers.
- ✓ The barriers to communication may be
  i. Physical barriers
  ii. Mechanical barriers
  iii. Psychological barriers.
  iv. Cultural or linguistic barriers.
- ✓ In business communication for instance the major obstacles of communication arises because of the set-up of the organization (organizational barriers) i.e.

  i. The size of the organization
  ii. The physical distance between employees and the organization
  iii. The specialization of jobs and activities
  iv. Power and status relationships

The main barriers of communication

1. **Information overload** – or under loads that it makes it difficult to get the important aspects of the message.
2. **Poor presentation** – oral medium when used effectively requires a good language choice, precision EST. while poor handwriting that is illegible may kill delivery
3. **wrong choice of medium**
   - ✓ The various media of communication I, e oral written, visual and audio – visual have their merits and limitations and there any wrong move may affect delivery.
4. **Physical barriers such as**
   i. Noise especially in factories EST.
   ii. Time and distance affect transmissions especially areas not well serviced with telecommunications
   iii. Environmental stress- such as high temperature humidity, poor ventilation, vibrations EST.
   iv. Subjective stress e.g...Illness, sleeplessness, drugs, mood variation may result to understanding difficulty and ability to interpret.
   v. Ignorance of the medium – tying to use a medium you are not family with e.g. power point (audio- visual means)
5. **Semantic barriers**
   - ✓ Refer to meanings of language used. A language is the expression of the thoughts and experiences of people in terms of their cultural environment.
   - ✓ Language facilitates understanding though these are times when it can be a barrier to communication such as;

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i) **Interpretations of words**where different meanings may be adduced to a given word...the word value may mean - utility
- Price
- Perception

ii) **By passed instruction** – occurs when a sender and the receiver of a message attributes different meanings to the same word eg . 'Burn this cd'

iv) Denotations and connotations

- ✓ Words have two types of meaning i.e...Denotative- the literal meaning of a word is called its denotative meaning.
- ✓ It informs and names objects without indicating any positive or negative qualities e.g...Table, book EST.
- ✓ In contrast connotative meanings arouse qualitative judgments and personal reactions e.g...Honest, sincere est.has favorable connotations; cheap, slow give unfavorable connotations.

v) Different comprehensions of reality

- ✓ The reality of an object or event is different to different to people
- ✓ On account of different abstractions, inferences and evaluations miscommunications, may result through-
  - **i) abstracting**
    - ➢ Is the process of focusing attention on some details and omitting others?
  - **ii) slanting**
    - ➢ occurs when one gives particular bias or slant to the reality .
    - ➢ In slating we are aware of the existence of other aspects but deliberately select a few and make them representative of the whole.
  - iii) **Inferring** – i.e. what we directly see, feel, taste, smell or can immediately verify and confirm constitutes a fact.
- ✓ But the statement that go beyond facts and t he conclusions based on facts are called inferences e.g..when rains fail, we can infer that prices will go up.

6. Mechanical barriers

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- ✓ These barriers are raised by the channels employed in communication at various levels such as
  - i) interpersonal
  - ii) groups or
  - iii) mass communication
- ✓ the channels may become barriers when the message is interfered with by some disturbances which may
  - o increase the difficulty of presentation
  - o increase the difficulty of reception
  - o prevent some elements of the message from reaching the destination
  - o absence of communication facilities
  - o technical difficulties
  - o Interfaces with the fidelity of the physical transmissions.

7. **Psychological barriers**- are caused by social or physiological problems which tend to interfere with the frame of reference i.e. a kind of window through which we look out the world , at people and events or situations; they include;

  - i) attitudes, opinions or self image
  - ii) emotions
  - iii) resistance to change
  - iv) defensiveness and fear
  - v) closed mind- prevents reconsiderations
  - vi) status consciousness may prevent upward or downward communication

vii) The source of communication especially when the receiver is suspicious or prejudice against source.
viii) Inattentiveness
ix) Facility – transmissions
x) Poor retention
xi) Unsolicited communication.

8. **Negative attitude** – the attitude of the sender or the receiver may hinder effective communication from taking place. The sender may be unable to get the information through to the receiver because of his or her attitude towards the message being communicated. For example, most African communities believed in having large families as this was viewed as a sign of wealth. It was therefore difficult to persuade them to have fewer children whom they are could comfortably take care of.

9. **Age difference** – the age difference between the sender and the receiver may hamper effective communication. Young people communicate things thorough their gestures, dress and speech which older people may not understand. It is important for business persons to take into consideration the ages of their customers in order to adopt appropriate selling techniques.

10. **Language** - the language the receivers understand should be used when passing on business information. For example most rural people in Kenya may not understand English. The use of technical or difficult language may also hinder the reception of a message.

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11. **Poor listening of media** – one of the parties in the communication process may be a poor listener. Listening is important as it enables a person to first understand the message and then respond appropriately. Effective sales persons are good listeners

12. **Unavailability of media** – the communication channel or medium that is required to pass information may not be available to an individual or it may be faulty. For example, lack of television sets in some rural areas makes it difficult for business people to reach prospective customers through television advertisements.

13. **Geographical barriers-** the physical distance between people who want to communicate may be too great for communication to take place at all. If the people manage to communicate, the information may get distorted.

14. **Bad weather** – weather conditions may make it difficult to communicate, especially where telephone lines are involved and particularly during rainy seasons.

15. **Lack of infrastructure** – the necessary infrastructure may not be available in a given locality. For example, most rural areas in Kenya are not served with telephone line, making communications very slow or almost impossible. Where there is no electricity, computers cannot be used meaning the people in such areas may not be able to communicate through e-mail or the internet.

16. **Distortion of the transmitted messa**ge
This may be caused by noise or by the sender of the message using the wrong choice of words.
Use of abstract phrases may prevent the receiver from getting the intended meaning of the message.

17. **Social status-** the social status of the parties involved may affect the efficacy of. People in the lower ranks of the organization often tend to fear their superiors. This creates a communication gap, which affects how information is received by the subordinates.

18. **Policies and procedures –** inappropriate policies and procedures governing the communication process can also be a barrier to effective communication. For example, due to bureaucracy in government institutions, information takes a long time to get to the intended recipients as it has to follow the laid-down procedures.

19. **Emotional problems** – emotional problems may also affect the effectiveness of communication. If the receiver of the information is emotionally disturbed or unwell, he or she may fail to understand the message.

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20. **Physical impairment -** if the sender or receiver has a speech, hearing or is visually impaired, the exchange of messages may be hindered.

Measures to overcome the barriers

1. Make straight forward organizational structures with clear lines of communication that are simple and direct.
2. create a climate of trust and confidence throughout the organization in place of formal and rigid relationships
3. communication must be well planned and well considered addressing the questions of;
   a. why
   b. when and
   c. whom
4. Choose carefully the medium and method of communication to suit each type of communication.
5. the flow of communication should be carefully regulated to maintain the optimum flow
6. All efforts should be made to improve human relations within the organization.

Factors to consider when choosing appropriate means of communication

- ✓ The following factors that influence the means of communication in an organization

1. **Urgency of the message**- any chosen means should be fast enough where the message is urgent.

2. **Affordability of the means**- the cost of the means chosen should be reasonable to the sender of the message. The sender should not choose a means that he or she can barely afford. . For example, a business person may decide to put up posters to advertise his or her products instead of using television or radio advisements which are more expensive.

3. **Accuracy-** the means chosen should be able to deliver the message in its original form. Written and face to face communication tends to score highly where accuracy is of utmost importance.

4. **Immediate feedback –** the means chosen should allow for immediate feedback where required.

5. **Cost-effectiveness-** the benefits accruing from the delivery of the messages should be worth the cost of using the means chosen. Very expensive means which do not contribute to the profitability of the business shouldnot be chosen.

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6. **Degree of complexity of the message-** complex messages may require a combination of media to effectively pass on the information. For example, if an organization is holding a training seminar for its employees, then verbal, nonverbal and written communication may be adopted.

7. **Capacity of the means-** this refers to the volume of data that a medium can allow to pass through and the speed at which this data can be sent. If the message to be delivered is detailed, then a method that accommodates the volume of data should be used.

8. **Future reference-** if the information sent is likely to be used for future reference or as evidence, the means should allow forstorage. Written information is useful for the purpose of record keeping. Information of this type includes contracts, minutes of meetings and orders.

9. **Reliability of the means-** the chosen should be capable of delivering the message to the intended receivers expected.

Critical thinking and problem solving

Definition.. Critical thinking is the intellectual disciplined process of actively and skillfully conceptualizing, applying, analyzing synthesizing and or evaluating information gathered from or generated by observation, experience, reflection, reasoning or communication as a guide to belief and action.

- ✓ Critical thinking is the intentional application of rational high order thinking skills such as
  - i. Analysis
  - ii. Problem recognition
  - iii. Problem solving
  - iv. Inference and
  - v. Inference.
- ✓ It results to making reasonable judgment and judgment of quality in disciplined manner.

The characteristics of critical thinking

- ✓ There are eight characteristics of critical thinking and it involves

  i. Asking questions
  ii. Defining a problem
  iii. Examining evidence
  iv. Analyzing assumptions or biases
  v. Avoiding emotional reasoning
  vi. Avoiding over simplification
  vii. Considering other interpretations
  viii. Tolerating ambiguity.

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The essential aspects of critical thinking

1. **Dispositions –** critical thinkers are skeptical, open-minded value fair – mindedness, respect, clarity and precision
   Look at different points of views and will change positions when reason leads them to do so.

2. **Criteria** - to think critically one must apply criteria i.e...Need to have conditions that must be met for something to be judged as believable.

3. **Argument** – is a statement or proposition with supporting evidence. thinking involves identifying evaluating and contracting arguments

4. **Reasoning** – the ability to infer a conclusion from one or multiple premises. To do so requires examining logical relationships among statements or data.

5. **Point of view** – the way one views the world which shapes one's construction of meaning.
   In search for understanding critical thinkers view phenomena from many different points of view.

6. **Procedures of applying criteria** – critical thinking makes use of many procedures.
   - ✓ These procedures include asking questions making judgments and identifying assumptions.

Importance of critical thinking

1. To avoid being passive in receiving information which often times is massive and therefore requires weeding
2. To help solve complex problem which face us in our day to day living
3. Facilitates learning through questions
4. In order to live successfully in a world of pursuing democracy and fairness
5. To make sound decisions about personal and any other affecting activities
6. To acquire good thinking as a guide to live a better life.

Examination questions

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Question 1

a) Explain the main barriers of organizational communication (10mks)
b) Discuss the following barriers to effective communication
   I) Semantic barriers (5mks)
   ii) Psychological barriers (5mks)

Question 2

a)"Communicators with similar mental fitters are more likely are more likely to communicate effectively" Discuss (20mks)

Question 3

a)How do the personal opinions and prejudices of various individuals act as barriers to effective communication?
Illustrate your answer with suitable examples (10mks)

b) What is meant by status – consciousness? How does it impede the smooth flow of communication?(10mks)

Question 4

A)Explain how wrong choice of the channels of communication act as a barrier to effective communication (10mks)

b)How does language act as a barrier to effective communication?(10mks)

Question 5

"Most barriers to effective communication are purely psychological" discuss (20mks)

Question 6

a) "Fear acts as a barrier to effective communication"

Required

Comment critically on the above statement (10mks)

c) Write short notes on the following

I) Closed mind (4mks)

ii) Distrust or the communicator (4mks)

iii) Facts and inferences (4mks)

v) Attitudes and opinions (4mks)

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Question 7

a) Explain the factors to consider when choosing the most appropriate method of communication (10mks)

b) What measures would you put in place to overcome the barriers?(10mks)

Question 8

a) Define the term critical thinking (4mks)

b) What are the characteristics of critical thinking (8mks?)

Question 9

a) Explain the essential aspects of critical thinking (4mks)

b) Explain the importance of critical thinking (8mks)

The Principals of Communication/Essential of effective communications

- ✓ The principals of communication refer to the scientific aspects which must be taken into account in all media of communication i.e...
  - The oral or verbal communication
  - The written communication
  - The visual communication
  - The audio –visual communication.
- ✓ These aspects are; **Clarity completeness, conciseness consideration, courtesy and correctness** (the 6c's principals of communications)

- ✓ These principles help make various forms of communication more effective. They are as explained

1. **Clarity** – refers to the way thoughts and expressions are eloquently expressed. There are five aspects of clarity ie.

   i. **Clarity of thoughts** – the communication cycle begins with the generation of an idea in the mind of the transmitter
      - A great deal of clarity is needed at this stage to package the message ready for the next stage.

   ii) **Clarity of expression** – receivers of messages communicated should be able to decode the message. If the message encoding is faulty, the message may be misinterpreted. Choice of wording deserve attention i.e.
      - Use of simple words
      - Use correct and concrete expressions- these expressions register in the mind and give definite facts.
      - Prefer active constructions for easier understanding eg.
        a. Your efforts are appreciated by all of us" passive.
        b. all of us appreciate your efforts" Active (elegant)

   iii) **Avoid excessive use of the infinitive** e.g..."It is the duty of the cashier to disburse salaries" is infinitive.
      - The cashier disburses salaries" is direct and the better way to express.

   iv) **Avoid jargon** I.e. special language of a trader, profession or field of study e.g. attached hereto------ instead of simply saying attached or enclosed.

   v) **Avoid ambiguity** e.g... " Go slow work in progress"

2. **Completeness**

   - ✓ Completeness of facts is absolutely necessary as incomplete communication irritates. Complete communication includes;
     - Relevant facts
     - Size of message

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- Color or language
- Addresses the 5w's i.e. who what where, when and why.

3. Conciseness

✓ Reduces the feeling of time wasting as the message is being passed. To achieve conciseness the following be taken into account.

- Include all relevant facts
- Avoid repetition
- Avoid wordy expressions e.g... " in a considerate number of cases" instead of often
- Organize your message well.

4. Consideration

✓ the sender must consider the receiver's circumstances by

- Adopting the you-attitude i.e. use you as much as you cab than 1'or we
- Emphasize positive pleasant facts- by avoiding a negative beginning or connotations which irritate e.g...Thankyou for your letter dated 15th requesting for a vacancy. You were among the best qualified but unfortunately
  - Impact integrity to your messages i.e. by observing ethical principles, sincerity and fair treatment.

5. **Courtesy-** calls for friendliness with those we communicate through giving
   - prompt answers
   - omitting irritating expressions
   - Apologizing sincerely for any omissions and thank generously for favor.

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6. **Correctness** – calls for
   - giving correct facts
   - sending messages at the correct time
   - Sending the messages in the correct style.

Examination questions

Question 1

a) discuss the general principals of effective communication (10mks)
b) write brief notes on the importance of
   a. clarity of thoughts and
   b. clarity of expressions in communication (10mks)

Question 2

a) What is meant by integrity as a principal of communication (3mks)
b) Show why it is important to adapt the message to needs of the receiver. (6mks)
c) Explain the importance of
   I) Completeness

ii) Conciseness
iii) Consideration (11mks)

Question 3

a) In business communication courtesy and clarity are as important as conciseness and completeness.Discuss (12mks)

b) "The writer of a business letter must place his correspondent first and see things from his point of view"
Discuss (8mks)

Question 4

a) "No one quality in a business letter is more important to good human relations than consideration of the customer"
Explain the above statement using illustrations.(10mks)

Question 5

a) Explain the principals of effective communication (14mks)

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Human Communication

- ✓ We have classified communication into several types i.e.
  - In terms of the verbal and non-verbal com.
  - Technological and non technological com.
  - The medicated and non- mediated com.
  - The participatory and non-participatory com. Est.
- ✓ Practically though there is much overlapping and mixing of the various types. The typologies must be seen as an attempt of coming to grips with the apparently simple but creaky complex phenomenon of communication.
- ✓ One common typology relates to the size of a social group or the number of people involved in the communication process
- ✓ Such a typology relates to the size of a social group or the number of people involved in the experience of communication..

Types of human communication

- ✓ Human communication takes six broad classifications which include;
  - intrapersonal
  - interpersonal
  - groups
  - mass
  - Transpersonal

- Body Language

a. The Intrapersonal Communication

- ✓ Refers to **the individual** reflections, contemplations and meditation thattake place within person.
- ✓ **Trans-scendentalmeditation** for instance is an example of such communication. Conversing with the divine, with the spirits and ancestors may be termed as transpersonal communication. This is a vital experience in the religious and monastic life and place of prayers.

b. Interpersonal Communication

- Interpersonal communication is direct face to face communication **between two people**.
- It is a dialogue or conversation without the intervention of a third party or a machine like telephones or radio
- Interpersonal communication **is direct and intimate** allowing for maximum interaction and exchange of words and gestures- it is the highest most perfect form of communication.
- It is more persuasive and influential than any other type of communication
- Other complements apart from wordsused in interpersonal communication include.
  - Facial expressions
  - Body movements
  - Physical features such as cloths.

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Types of interpersonal communication

i) Unfocused communication

- ✓ Interpersonal communication is conducted on the basis of focused and unfocused interactions

  - In his book – Behavior in public places' **– Goffman argues** that most interpersonal communication is of **unfocused** nature.
  - **Unfocused communication** takes place whenever we observed or listen to personal with whom we are not conversing for instance.
  - It is the kind of activity we indulge in when we are a people watching without being aware that we are doing so.
  - The inferences from such actions may not all be meaningful.

ii) focused interactions or communications

- **Focused interactions** on the other hand results from an actual encounter between two people.
- The people involved are fully aware that they are communicating with each other.

- Sitting or standing, face to face or at a distance. They are aware that they are exchanging both verbal and non-verbal messages, though they may not know how the message is being interpreted.
- Also they are generally not conscious of the meaning of their body language – an unfocused interaction usually is set off by eye contact. The meetings of the eyes indicate that both parties are willing to have an interpersonal exchange.

The Three Stages of Interpersonal Communication

✓ There are three phases of interpersonal communication namely.

i. **the phatic stage**- is the initial stage of exploration communication will take
   - It's a stage that starts with greetings accompanied by gestures, smile est.
   - It is a warming up time.

ii. **the personal stage**- introduces a more personal element into the conversation
   - The stage is marked by lowering social guard and risk taking in exposing one's self and feeling.
   - Talks of personal matters, professions family e.t.c.
   - Most business communication takes place at this level and does not extend beyond this level.

iii. **The intimate stage**
   - Is received for friends and relatives and the degree of intimately depending upon the closeness of the relationships.
   - Social barriers fall. Thoughts are revealed and feelings, joy weakness ad strengths est.

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c) Group Communication.

✓ Group communication shares all the above qualities though in a much lesser measure
✓ The larger the group the less personal and intimate is the possibility of exchange and as the group grows in size communication tends to become more and more of a monologue and participation becomes more difficult.

✓ The degree of directness and intimacy would depend on the size of the group.
✓ The level of mutual participation and understanding among members suffers as a result.

Comparison between Interpersonal Communication and Group Communication.

a. Under interpersonal communication, understanding and participation may not be complete especially if the non-verbal cues and the social cultural details are not paid attention to – however the possibility of checking up and correcting misunderstanding is much quicker and easier in interpersonal communication than group.
b. Feed back is instantaneous in interpersonal communication since it allows instant response unlike group communication where feedback is more difficult to measure and respond to.
c. Group discussion take a one way line of communication I.e. top down that interpersonal communication
d. Face to face communication nevertheless is more persuasive and influential than group even with advertisements people still depend on door to door sales.

d) Mass communication

✓ Group communication has now been extended by tools of mass communication such as;

a. books
b. the press
c. cinemas
d. radio
e. television
f. The internet EST.

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✓ the concept of **mass communication refers to the process** of transmitting information to a large population .Exaggerated claims have been made over the power of mass media. **Daniel Lerner** terms it" the mobility multiplier"

e) Transpersonal Communication

✓ Transpersonal also referred to as self –transcendent in communication where by a person deals with spiritual aspects of the human experience.

✓ It explains human rates highest potential with recognition, understanding realization of spiritual aspects of self –development and mystical experiences.

f) Body Language

✓ Definition - Refers to the movement of the various parts of the body. The information communicated requires interpretation.

The importance of body language in communication

- ✓ Understanding body language can tell on more about the person with whom you are communicating .Similarly you want to ensure that your own body language reinforces your message rather than contract it.

- ✓ They include
    a. **Signals at first sight** present appearance and signals such as cleanliness and tidiness speak volumes about a person.
    b. **Unconscious signals** such how the brain may respond to the surrounding situations e.g... fear, joy, anger etch
    c. **Postures** such as - a forward looking posture demonstrate them warmth of personality.
    d. **Withdrawal** – seen by turning away or holding back
    e. **Expansion** – seen as a military bearing by standing straight and tall- confidence.
    f. **Constructions** – dejected and submissive can indicate despair or disappointments.

Some of the parts of the body include

1. Eye-contact

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- ✓ **Minimum eye contact** suggests you may be disinterested shiftily or afraid .It is used to stop someone from holding the other person gazing overlong durations.

- ✓ Eye contact can also be used to **regulate conversations**.

- ✓ It can also to make the other person uncomfortable oras are assuming sign change small or large in pupil size the eyes express interest, honesty openness or lack of interest - distrust .

2. Smile

- ✓ Are unique to human beings and the act of smiling makes one feel better .Smiles are infectious and normally trigger a smile in response.

- ✓ It should be genuine – there is nothing more irritating than a fixed professional smile .Bad smiles cause discomfort.

3. Shaking of hands

- ✓ many greetings and farewells include tough, a hand on the should, apart on the forearm, though handshakes are perhaps the most revealing of all touch rituals .the purpose of a handshake is to say hallo of goodbye or it signifies greetings

- ✓ Weak limp grips put off people and run the positive impression.

4. Territory

- ✓ On **a crowded environment** e.g... Bus train, lifts est. some people prefer to stare at the roof or floor or out of the window.In such a situation people are put in a position where they physical are uncomfortable too close to people. So they erect invisible barriers around them.

- ✓ **Restlessness, foot-tapping** and **re-crossing ,folded arms**etc ...Are defensive mechanics. When sitting on table it is confrontational to sit directly in front of the person sit across the corner.

- ✓ **Round tables present** a more democratic environment and no one is dominating a situation.

5. Shoulders and head

- ✓ People will **raise their shoulders** when tense and lower them when relaxed . .A raised head indicate interest openness and control whereas allowed head indicates doubt fear and dissatisfaction.

- ✓ **A sideway tilt** of the head can show interest or curiosity .The positions of the head and shoulders explain a person's tension, reluctance, satisfaction and a degree of control.

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6Little white lies

- ✓ There are a number of reasons why people the politicians may suppress their true feelings in order to toe the party lines, people or expectations of the society.

- ✓ Lying produces **stress signals** such as becoming uneven, **mouth becomes dry** and people **clear their threatsor lost of words.**

- ✓ **Give away gestures** include **hands in the pockets** clasping them tightly or **covering the mouth rubbing the nose**- most people avoid **looking straight** to your eyes while lying and briefly glance then look down.

Examination questions.

1. A) Discuss the interpersonal communication [10mks]
   b) Explain the three stages of interpersonal communication. [10mks]
2. a) Explain the meaning of group discussions [6mks]
   b) Explain the main weakness of this form of communication [4mks]
   c) State and explain the following body languages and their importance in communication [10mks]
      i) Territory
      ii) Eye contact
      iii) Postures

3. State and explain the importance of body language in communication [20mks]

Question4

a) Define the following forms of communication
   i) Downward communication (2mks)
   ii) Upward communication (2mks)
   iii) Lateral communication (2mks)

b) Explain the benefit that accrues to a business enterprise that uses upward form of communication (14mks)

Question 5

a)Effective communication is the key element in running as a method o f communication (10mks)

b)Highlight the advantages of using visual presentation as a method of communication (10mks)

Question 6

a) In relation to communication list six sources of noise in an organization (6mks)

b) Define the term feed forward communication (2mks)

ii) Argue the case for and against feed forward communication (6mks)

c) Enumerate six ways by which a business enhances communication skills towards an employees (6mks)

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Question 7

Distinguish between means of communication and forms of communication (20mks)

Question 8

Discuss barriers to effective communication (20mks)

Question 9

Enumerate ways in which good communication skills can be achieved in an organization (20mks)

Question 10

Under what circumstance would one prefer oral to written communication (6mks)

Question 11

Highlight 5 causes of breakdown (10mks)

Question 12

The latest revolution in communication has changes the world into a global village . Discuss (10mks)

Question 13

When would it most appropriate to use signs in communication. (6mks)

Question 14
State the necessary factors required when choosing a mean of communication (20mks)
Question 15
i) Explain some of the services that boost communication process in a business organization.
ii) Define communication (14mks)

Question 16
Communication has been faced by current trends and emerging issues.
Highlight some of the emerging issues in a communication process (14mks)

Question 17
What are disadvantages of using telephone as a mean of communication (8mks)

Question 18
a) Define what meeting is (3mks)
b) Explain how minutes are taken (12mks)
c) What are the roles of chairman in a meeting (4mks)

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Examination questions
Question 1
a) Define communication
b) Explain the effects of poor communication in an organization
c) What is the purpose of communication an organization?

Question 2
a) Explain the importance of communication to a business enterprise
b) Explain the concept communication process
c) State and explain five components of a communication process

Question 3
a) State and explain three types of business communication
b) Define a formal channel of communication
c) State and explain five forms of formal communication.

Question 4
a) Define downward communication and explain the purpose of downward communication
b) What are the main drawbacks of downward communication?

Question 5
i. Explain the meaning of upward communication.
ii. What are the methods of upward communication
iii. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of upward communication.

Question 6

a) Explain the ways of improving upward communication
b) What are the causes of poor upward communication?

Question 7

a) Define horizontal communication distinguishing between
    i) Lateral communication
    ii) Diagonal communication
b) Explain the benefits of each of I & II above

Question 8

a) Define a line of communication
b) Explain four lines of communication

Question 9

a) Define grapevine
b) What is the importance of grapevine
c) Explain the merits and demerits of grapevine communication
d) How can grapevine be used effectively in an organization.

Question 10

a) What are the advantages of informal communication
b) Explain the importance of external communication in an organization

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Question 11

a) Explain the problems that may be encountered in the communication process.
b) What are the guidelines of effective communication?

Question 12

a) Explain the essential of effective communication
b) Explain the importance of listening skills.

Question 13

a) Explain briefly three forms of communication
b) Explain the advantages of verbal communication.
c) What are the disadvantages of verbal communication.

Question 14

a) Write explanatory notes the following channels of written communication
    i. Letters
    ii. Memorandum
    iii. Minutes
b) Explain how minutes are taken highlighting on the contents of a minute
c) Explain the advantages of written communication.
d) What are the advantages of written communication?

Question 15

a) Define non-verbal communication
b) State and explain five channels of non-verbal communication.
c) Explain the advantages and disadvantages of non-verbal communication.

Question 16

a) Explain the barriers of communication
b) Explain the measures an organization may take to overcome these barriers

Question 17

a) Explain the factors that influence choice of means of communication

Question 18

a) Define critical thinking
b) What are the essential aspects of critical thinking
c) Explain the importance of critical thinking to the organization.

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TOPIC 2

WRITTEN COMMUNICATION

Definition of Written Communication

- ✓ Refers to the innovative activity of the mind which involves a careful choice of written words organized in a correct order of sentences in order to pass information from one person to another.
- ✓ Written communication involves any type of interaction which makes use of written words, organized in a correct order of sentences in order to pass information from one person to another.
- ✓ Written communication is very common in business situations facilitating both internal and external communication in the form of memos reports letters etc.

Advantages of written communication

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1. Written communication helps in laying down apparent principal policies and rules for an organization.
2. It is a permanent means of communication and therefore useful where records have to be maintained.
3. Assists in establishing accountable delegation of responsibilities
4. Written communication is more precise and explicit in passing information (messages)
5. It provides records for future references
6. Legal defense can depend upon written communication.

Disadvantages of written communication

1. Written communication does not save on costs and tends to be bulky.
2. Slow response and may lack spontaneous clarification especially where distance is involved
3. Written communication is time consuming as feedback is not immediate due to the encoding and decoding procedures
4. Written communication may be unsuitable for illiterate receivers or senders
5. Effective written communication requires greater skills and competencies in language and use of vocabulary.
6. Too much paper work and e-mail burden is involved.

Rules of effective writing

- ✓ Writing skills are an important part of communication. Effective writing allows for efficient communication of any information with a lot of clarity and ease to all audience.

- ✓ Poor writing skills create first impression and many readers will have an immediate negative reaction where they spot mistakes such as grammatical mistakes or spelling mistakes. A well written article attracts attention and desire to read the information.

The following are the main guidelines of effective witting skills

1. The writer should use correct grammar and make sure that corrections on all grammar errors are done. Use short clear sentences when writing
2. Avoid of wrong words and spellings mistakes- check for poor writing spellings & mistakes in order to avoid any misinterpretations or understanding by the reader.
3. The wording should be polite and simple to understand.
4. Display should be pleasant and in accordance with accepted procedures.

Channels/ forms of written communication

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- ✓ Written communication may flow or take any of the following forms
  i) Correspondence (letters)
  ii) Internal memorandum (memo)
  iii) Reports
  iv) Circulars
  v) Minutes
  vi) Bulletins, notices or house journals
  vii) Suggestions schemes etc

- ✓ Witten communication once fully prepared and is ready to be sent the following are the main ways of conveying written communication

  - **Messengerial –services is**the oldest type of service, where evidence is desired of the sending process. They use messengers who use delivery book.
  - **Postal services / courier services** Are service providers who facilitate delivery of letters or any other correspondence
  - **Mechanical transmitters**There are several types of transmitters which include
    i) Tele printers
    ii) Telegraphs
    iii) Telexes
    iv) Fax miles
    v) E-mails

Office Memorandum

Introduction

- ✓ A memo is the short form for the term memorandum T he word is derived from a Latin term "**memo**" which means – a reminder.
- ✓ A memo is the most convenient method of conveying a simple message or idea to a big or large groups of people, in the quickest period of time in an organization. Organizations in dealing with various matters internally may;
  - Send reminders for a particular events
  - Make requests or proposals
  - Notify employees on any changes or decisions
  - Send caution or instructions or directives themes.

Def: Memo

✓ Is the short form of memorandum? The literal meaning of the word is " a note to assist the memory" .Memorandum is singular in number while memorandums or a memorandum is plural.

- ✓ A memo is used for internal communication between executives and subordinates or between officers of the same level
  - It is never sent outside the organization.

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The channels for a memo

- To issue instructions to the staff
- To communicate policy changes to the staff
- To give/ seek suggestions
- To request help information
- To confirm decisions armed at on telephones etc.

✓ Memo's are not appropriate for matters that are complex or serious in nature

The format of a memo

- ✓ A memo format is different from that of a letter since a memo moves from one department to another or one person to another. It is essential to write the name of the person sending the memo and the name of the recipient together with the designation or department of both.
- ✓ It should also have a reference number. The word from and to are invariably used in a memo. There are no salutations and the writer's signature is put without writing any complementary clause or subscription.
- ✓ The memo should be properly dated and written in a direct style and as brief as possible. The tone of a memo need not be formal nor should it be so informal that is losses all seriousness. When choosing tone consider.

  - The reader of the memo
  - The subject matter
  - The company house style

Inter. Office memo

Ref:

From _____ To_____ Date _____

Subject _____

_____

Initials……

Factors that could affect the style of language used in writing a memo

i) The receiver of the memo
ii) The nature of the content
iii) The timing of the memo
iv) Source or sender of the memo
v) The purpose of the memo.

Office Forms

- ✓ Office forms are special reports used when similar information is required from different parties or individuals
- ✓ Forms are useful because
  - i) they help collect data in standardized procedures
  - ii) they ensure that all information needed is received
  - iii) they sequence data in a presented priority
  - iv) they provide handy source of reference
  - v) they ensure uniformity and consistency e.g banks
  - vi) vetting of information is standardized and made easy
  - vii) Revision of forms is easy to suit new policies.
- **Form letters or form messages** are used when an identical message is to be sent to a large number of people

i) **Form letters**
- ✓ Are for external communication while

ii) **Form memos**
- ✓ Are for internal communication.

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Channels of form letters

i. answer often recurring enquires
ii. acknowledge orders, payments
iii. make simple adjustments
iv. invite candidates for interviews
v. make appointments
vi. give news to customers, supplies

The channels of form memos

i. give news to employees
ii. deal with disciplinary matters
iii. deal with leave and other service conditions of employees
iv. simply office procedures etc

Advantages of form messages

a) they save on time especially when sending similar message to many
b) cost saving especially when production is bulk
c) they tend to be a better quality
d) they simply office procedures
e) They help fix responsibility.

Types of office forms

✓ There are four kinds of forms

a) Complete forms

✓ In a complete form the messages are identical in every word. If it is a form letter, the general salutation is;

i) Dear student
ii) Dear customer
iii) Dear subscriber etc

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b) Fill –in –forms

✓ Here the messages are pre-pared in advance to meet specific kinds of situation with blank spaces left for filling in variable information.

c) Guide forms

✓ Here, model letters or memos are prepared in advance to meet various kinds of situations
✓ Whenever one has to write a similar message he/she can adopt the model to meet the specific situation.

d) Paragraph forms

✓ A letter containing a number of paragraphs or a booklet of paragraph to respond to different situations may be kept ready e.g.. Invitation letters for interview may have standard paragraphs.

e) Design of forms

✓ Guidelines of good form design

i) The function and reference number of the form should be clearly shown at t he top (e.g application form
ii) The name of the organization should appear at the top if it is to be used externally.
iii) The overall design should be uncomplicated and functional convenient for retrieval

iv) The wordings should be clear and concise
v) Sufficient space should be allowed for inserting information requested.
vi) Instructions should be clear and near the top e,g (complete in yellow ink only)
vii) T he form should be allow for a minimum of information that is straight and simple e.g Yes /|No
viii) T he information should be presented logically
ix) Important information should be highlighted
x) Where copies are required, different colors be coded
xi) Separate any parts not intended for completion e.g (for official use only)

Questions and answers on forms

Question 1

a) Define the term office forms

- ✓ An office form is a printed sheet of paper or card with marked headings for entries to be made in hand or by typing
- ✓ Forms are the basic tools for all types of office work through which essential information required for efficient conduct of business can be received, recorded, arranged, and transmitted in a systematic manner.
- ✓ Use of forms saves on time and energy that may be used in written all the information together with their costs
- ✓ Forms facilitate the routine office function more efficiently.

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ii) Advantages of using office forms

i.) They simply office methods and procedures
ii.) They reduce costs of office operations
iii.) They help fix responsibilities of work done by specific people
iv.) They help receive, collect, record process and transmit the information in a systematic and efficient way.

iii) Explain a proper management's obligation for a good forms control in an organization.

- ✓ Forms are linked with efficiency in an office work and are an important element of office work and are and important element of office routine and system.
- ✓ Very often too much stress is placed on the use of forms, with the number of forms becoming too much and unnecessary.
- ✓ Instead of cost reduction an efficiency increase in office operations, unplanned and uncontrolled use of forms needlessly increase the volume of paper, work and up losing the advantages of use of forms
- ✓ Hence a good management should set in place proper control and use of forms ensuring that they are effective and economical in designing.

✓ This can be done by providing a system of forms control under direct responsibility of a responsible executive with specialized knowledge on forms design and control.

Question 2

a) What are the objectives of forms control

ii) To introduce forms which are really necessary and ensure that clerical work does not become confusing on account of too many forms
iii) To ensure that forms are so designed as to render the best possible use at minimum costs
iv) To produce forms by the most appropriate and economical method.
v) To supply copies of forms only to those who are to use them.
vi) To study whether introduction of new forms proposed or revision of old forms is essential
vii) To review all forms periodically so as to determine their utility in accordance with the current requirements.
viii) To evaluate forms design on the basis of the time required to use the form.

Question 2 ii

What are the essential of a good office form.

a) the writing surface, the surface, the style of print, proper sequence of information and method of entry should be easy for rapid completion of the form
b) good appearance and balanced arrangement of information of office form
c) Adequate space should be provided for the expected information.
d) Every form must have a title and logical sequence in managing or seeking information
e) Space for filling, perforation or use of window envelopes where necessary
f) Cost of forms must be low and benefits from their use must be more
g) The method of re-production, quality of paper and colour must be appropriate.

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i) Explain the advantages of forms control

a) it economizes time, paper costs e.t.c by using the correct forms
b) work is simplified as only the required information is provided
c) they help reduce error
d) limit frustration on workers as they will be knowing what is required
e) improve overall efficiency of the office work
f) Facilitates faster processing of information since only relevant information is obtained.

Question 3

What are the common faults in forms

✓ the following are some of the common faults found in forms

i) insufficient horizontal space for inserting information
ii) too much printed information such publicity slogans on the forms
iii) inadequate margins for filling purposes and enough top and bottom space
iv) signature space placed too near the bottom or missing

v) Poor alignments with space not directly corresponding to relevant information.

Question 4

Management must ensure that office forms are properly designed

- ✓ The designing of the office form is an important aspects of office management
- ✓ This is because, the main purpose of the form is to;
  a) Introduce office work
  b) Simplify office methods of working
  c) Expedite work
  d) Eliminate mistakes in work and
  e) Reduce costs of office operations
- ✓ The form must therefore be as perfect as possible making it's designing an important aspect.
- ✓ A sound principal of form designing is that efficiency in office work should be maximized through the use of minimum number of forms.
- ✓ A good well designed form should be of low costs not just paper & printing but also its labour input in their use.
- ✓ Badly designed forms induce mistakes in clerical work affecting office systems and routines and the flow of work.
- ✓ Badly designed forms have harmful effects on the goodwill and prestige of an organization.

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What are the principles of form designing?

- ✓ **The following five principals sound be kept in mind when designing forms**

i) Ease of entering data that is;
 a) They should be of smooth surface
 b) Easily readable prints
 c) Headings be arranged in proper sequence

ii) Should provide a proper facility of using entered data
 - ✓ Printing should be easily readable
 - ✓ Data is entered in such a sequence that necessary information can easily be extracted.

iii) Should eliminate chances of errors
 - ✓ Means that alignment of lines and columns
 - ✓ A certain number of copies to be produced (interleave) if possible.
 - ✓ Method of copying and nature of data should be such that errors are minimal

iv) Economy in cost through which;
 - ✓ The size of the form, the quality of paper the quality of forms and the method of reproduction should be such that maximum satisfaction is delivered at most minimal costs.

v) Easy of identification and handling so that;
 - ✓ Colouring of paper, colour of ink used numbering, title should be such that each form can easily be identified, handled and located.

What are the main guidelines in form design?

- ✓ Forms must be designed according to the purpose of their use
- ✓ Forms must be easy to use

- ✓ Design of the form should be simple
- ✓ Each type of form should bear title and number
- ✓ The form size should be proper
- ✓ The type of face for printing forms should be clear and distinct for purposes of reading
- ✓ The right type of paper should be selected for every form
- ✓ Adequate provision should be made for punching, scoring and perforations.

Explain the term reprographic office services

- ✓ The term reprographic services refers to the process of producing copies from an original documents, so that many documents of an office copy can be obtained in many copies.

The main ways of reprographic services include

a) photocopying services
b) duplicating services
c) printing services

5. Questionnaires

Definition

Refers to a form that contains questions especially one addressed to a statistically significant number of subjects as a way of gathering information for survey.
Normally given another of people in order to collect statistical and information

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Types of questionnaire.

i) Structured questionnaire

- ✓ Have a definite and concrete questions, normally prepared well in advance
- ✓ They initiate a formal inquiry, supplements and checks data,, previously accumulated.

ii) Unstructured questionnaires

- ✓ Are used at the time of the interview. They act as the guide for the interviewer.
- ✓ They are very flexible exposing personal experiences beliefs etc .

iii) Open ended questions

- ✓ Are used to allow the respondent freedom of expressing personal views and ideas
- ✓ They do not provide any structure for the respondent replies.

iv) Close ended questionnaire

- ✓ Responses are limited to clearly stated alternatives e.g yes, no
- ✓ The respondent does not have a chance to express own operation.

v) Mixed questionnaire

- ✓ Are questionnaires t hat combine the elements of both closed and open ended questionnaires.
- ✓ Very useful in research.

vi) Pictorial questionnaire

- ✓ Use pictures to promote answering the questions .

vii) Probing questionnaire

- ✓ a probing questionnaire has questions which can normally be answered using a simple Yes or No. from a specific piece of information or a selection from multiple choices.

viii) Open ended questionnaire

- ✓ Has a question which cannot be answered with a simple Yes or No or with a specific piece of information – but gives the person answering the question scope to give the information that would seem appropriate

How to design a good questionnaire

- ✓ The key to effective questionnaire design is knowing exactly what you want to find out
- ✓ Base your questionnaire design on your evaluation questions
- ✓ The purposes and structure of the questionnaire are important guides in designing a good questionnaire

1. Purposes

- ✓ Establish the purpose of the information yielded by each questionnaire
- ✓ This will help eliminate what is not required and establish what is required and therefore make the best out of the questionnaire

2. The structure

i) a questionnaire should always start with a brief sentence or two explaining the purpose of the questionnaire and the kind of data to be used.

ii) The questionnaire should have a clear structure and questions dealing with similar aspects

iii) The questions should move from the general to the particular aspects of the programme

iv) Personal information that may put off somebody should be asked at the end e.g age, ethnicity.

v) Determine need for closed or open questionnaire.

vi) Where the design of closed form is not properly designed, skewed date will mis-represent the respondents through opinions.

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3. The wordings

- ✓ Appropriate wordings of questionnaire items help minimize biases in questionnaire
- ✓ This can be achieved through

i) Avoiding jargon or technical terms unlikely to be familiar to your respondents

ii) Avoid ambiguous questions and answers

iii) Avoid combined questions

iv) Avoid double negative e.g I do not trust politicians to tell the truth (yes/no)

v) Do not use leading questions that imply response.

vi) Include a ‘ no opinion” option when seeking people beliefs or attitudes

vii) Avoid loaded questions that contain words which may bias the response.

viii) Simplify responses to express opinion.

The features of a good questionnaire

1. evokes the truth- by creating non-threatening questions
2. ask for an answer on only one dimension
3. can accommodate all possible answers
4. have mutually exclusive options I,e with no ambiguity in the mind of the respondent
5. produces variability of responses to facilitate analysis
6. Does not imply desired answer.
7. Does not use emotionally loaded or vaguely defined words
8. Does not use unfamiliar word or abbreviations
9. It not dependant on responses to previous questions.

The rules of analyzing data from a questionnaire

1. Make copies of your data and store the master copy away then start editing, cutting and pasting
2. Tabulate the information i.e add up the number of rating, ranking the yes and no's for each question.
3. For rating and ranking consider computing a mean or average for each question and rank respondents 1,2,3 et.c.
4. Consider conveying the range of answers e.g 10 people ranked 1 - 30 people ranked 2
5. Keep all commentary for several years after completion incase of any reference.

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6) Circulars and Newsletters

i) Circulars

- ✓ There are publications produced by an organization for both in internal communication and external communication.
- ✓ Circulars may be used to;

i) enhance communication between the firm and its customers
   - The organization may choose to send circular letters to its customers or the entire public on opening a new branch or introducing a new product.

ii) Circulars may be used to enforce addressing code among employees of the organization.

iii) T hey are a means of implementing particular policies within the organization.

iv) They are used to invite employees to meetings or luncheons

v) They may be used as advertising tools.

ix) News letters or bulletins or house organs (publicity)

- ✓ These are internal publication often produced by an organization periodically
- ✓ Large organization may set up a small departments to facilitate their production.

7. House Organs and Bulletins

- ✓ Among the numerous publications issued by organization these days, house organs, bulletins and newsletters occupy a prominent place.

- ✓ All these are means of internal communication although complimentary copies may often be set to outsiders to project the image of the organization among the public at large.
- ✓ The house organs or journals are a periodic publication usually distributed free among employees to usually distributed free among employees to;

  i. Inform them
  ii. Educate them and
  iii. Entertain them
- ✓ The difference between a journal and bulleting is more the form than the content – a journal is bound like a magazine and tends to be more attractive multi-color
- ✓ While a bulletin consists of loose, folded printed sheets inserted to one another like newspapers and a newsletter and bulletins are almost the same.

The main objectives of house organs and bulletins

1. keep employees informed about the product services , activities, achievements of the organization
2. to inform employees about the new development or diversification plans
3. to explain to the employees the financial structure and operations
4. To counter rumor that often spread through grapevine of the organization.
5. to counter any harmful propaganda from anti-business sources
6. to instill a sense of discipline among the employees to prevent wastage, reduce absenteeism and increase production
7. to acquit employees with the achievements of the organization an breed a sense of pride and a sense of involvement
8. Publish employees vies on the organization the policies and other factors affecting them.
9. to improve on the employer – employee relationships
10. To keep high morale and encourage self expression.

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The contents of the house organs and bullets

- Production of any of these publications need to be attractive and organized and the following contents are normally included.

a. company news about

i. the company's product or service activities achievements
ii. any v.i.p visits made to the organization
iii. any awards worn by the organization
iv. perspirations in trade fairs tours etc
v. Especial benefit schemes.

b. **Social news – would include**

i. the employees and their families – births, weddings, deaths, special honors, awards and other achievements
ii. Social activities or gatherings such as sports day, end year parties etc.

c. **Local news**

- when found desirable, a brief account of events in the locality in which the office or the organization is situated
- news on
  - educational activities
  - dispensaries
  - show-room
  - social responsibility

d. **General news** – i.e. important social, economic and political events

e. **General reading**- meant to educate and entertain the employees and their families can produce under this title

f. **Editorial**- May take or be related to social political or economic events

g. **Photographs** on the company or other import photos that may be interesting.

How to make the house organs and bulletins interesting and useful

a) include only fresh information and current news
b) publish the house organs regularly
c) take steps to make sure that everybody receives a copy
d) Include material of interest to various groups e.g..
   - Ladies
   - Children
   - Married couples
   - Non-married
e) the subsequent issues should be different in presentation and content
f) humorous language simple to understand
g) creativity and good photography will add interest

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8. Notices and Advertising

- ✓ Notice message are internally communicated information with minimal confidentiality printed and pinned on an organization notice board
- ✓ The message passed is to several receivers and is clearly displayed on a notice board that must be strategically placed for accessibility and readability.
- ✓ Notices also advertise for the organization especially where the message contained expresses goodwill.

The purposes of notices

a) Are a means of implementing particular policies within an organisation.
b) May be used to invite employees to particular meetings or special occasions
c) They are used as an advertising tool
d) Facilitate communication or responsibilities expectations to all employees
e) They act as a fast means of communicating information to the relevant people.

Guidelines of designing notices

1. Ensure the function and references are clearly shown
2. T he information on notices should be presented logically
3. T he wordings should be clear and concise
4. Important information should be highlighted
5. The overall design should be simple and functional
6. The organization name should be always appear at the top

9. Suggestion Schemes

- ✓ Are important in organization because they promote the upward communication. They allow employees express their feelings, ideas on
  - iii. Issues of economic improvement
  - iv. Issues that relate to efficiency
  - v. Improving the organization product or service
  - vi. Management style, weakness or strengths
  - vii. Important aspects t hat may be grapevines worth management knowledge.

Advantages of suggestion schemes

1. Effective in promoting upward communication
2. Improves the functioning of the organization
3. Draws attention of management on unidentified problems that may be looming
4. Gives employees a sense of participation in decision making
5. Motivates others especially where rewards are given on good suggestions
6. Helps sport talented workers that can be groomed to management.

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How to make suggestion schemes work

1. Make the use of schemes efficient and convincing
2. Give the suggestions schemes enough publicity
3. Offer suitable rewards to brilliant suggestions
4. Minimize resistance by w
5. orkers, unions etc by including them in the schemes.

Press reports and press release or hand outs

<u>Press Reports</u>

- ✓ Press reports are new items solicited for and released by the media houses. The present carefully selected new items and report t hen in the new papers.

The features of a good press report

a) Must have news value (worthy)
b) Should have a faithful representation with liable accuracy and concise
c) Should be effective i.e able to mobilize public attention and opinion on the issue
d) Should be (lucid in style) I,e simple and interesting to the reader
e) It should be factually true and suitable for publication
f) It should be brief with a good attractive heading.

ii) Press Hand –Outs or Releases

- ✓ In modern competition most newspaper devote some space to corporate news .The news items printed under this heading are prepared on the basis of a press-release or hand-outs by various organizations and then forward to the media houses for publication.

- ✓ The press releases do not yield monetary gains to either the issuing organization or the printing newspapers. If property handled through they help boost the image of the organization.

- ✓ It is the responsibility of the public relations department of an organization to issue press releases .They may cover important events like appointment, seminars, conferences, visits of VIP's signing of contracts commencing additional plants, launching, a new product etc.

- ✓ A press release is different from a press reports. A press report is the correspondence by a representative of a given newspaper, or news agency covering a givenevent.While a company sending matters for publication prepared by its own staff is a press report.

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The features of a good press release

1. the paper should identify with the business organization's product or logo
2. the term " press – release" should appear at the top
3. The press – release should contain contacts and name of contact person for any clarification.
4. The press release should always have a title
5. It follows logical sequence not too long and should be clear.
6. The paragraph should be short and precise
7. The content should be objective.

The rules of a good press release

1. Headline should be attractive in order to attract the reader's interest
2. The date for the press release should be indicated at the top of the news form
3. Keep it short and simple and where more pages are required, indicate more and should have sub-headings
4. Knows the audience to facilitate the opening look and the content of the press release
5. Follow the standard format of a press release
6. The content should be interesting in order to compel the reader to read the entire article
7. Consider the audiences interests rather than strictly promoting the product
8. The end of the press-release should be indicated by the word END
9. Indicate the name and telephone of the contact person.

11. Graphic/pictorial presentation

- ✓ Graphic or pictorial presentation conveys diagrammatic messages and aids in the communication process.
- ✓ They facilitate creation production and destruction of written materials or information by incorporating words and images to convey data, concepts and emotions
- ✓ The field encompasses all phases of graphic communication process right from
    a. Origination of ideas
    b. Designing, layout and typography
    c. Production processes
    d. Finishing and distribution processes of two or three dimensional products for electronic transmission.

Definition of graphic communication

- ✓ As the name suggests it refers to communication using graphic elements which include symbols such as graphs and icons, images such as drawings and photographs and can include the passive contributions of substrate, color and surroundings.
- ✓ It is the process of creating, producing and distributing material incorporating words and images to convey data, concepts and emotions.

Channels of graphic communication

- ✓ **Graphics definition**
    - Are visual presentations on some surface, such as a wall, canvas, computer screen, paper or stone etc
    - They are presented inform of;
        i. Graphs
        ii. Diagrams
        iii. Line art
        iv. Charts
        v. Drawings
        vi. Typography
        vii. Numbers
        viii. Geometric designs
        ix. Maps
        x. Photographs etc.
    - Graphic designs are artistic and professional disciplines which focus on visual communication and presentation.
    - Various methods are used to create and combine symbols , images and or words to create a visual presentation of ideas and messages.
    - Graphical representation extract information or messages to
        - Look like or resemble
        - Stand in for something
        - To present a second time in order to support the text or idea being communicated.

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The importance of graphic or pictorial presentation

1. The audience or receiver of a message can quickly visualize the message or contact.
2. They offer a forceful emphasis on the main points being communicated
3. The audience is easily convinced since it tends to prove a point
4. Compact is conveying messages
5. Attracts extra attention and interest than empty talks or written messages
6. The use facilitates developments of expertise in generation of computer aided graphics.

QUESTIONS

1. a. Define office memo (2mrks)

   b. Explain five uses of office memorandum (10mrks)
   c. Explain five factors that could affect language style when writing a memo (8mrks)

2. a. Define the term business report (2mrks)
   b. Argue case for reports in a business enterprise (8mrks)
   c. Explain the parts of a report (10mrks)

3. a. Explain the importance of the following parts of a business report
      i. Executive summary
      ii. TORS
      iii. Acknowledgement
      iv. Background
      v. Bibliography (10mrks)

   b. Explain five false assumptions commonly made regarding an audience (10mrks)

4. i. Explain three types of audience (6mrks)
   ii. Distinguish between the primary and secondary information when writing reports(4mrks)

   b. Explain five factors a report writer must take into consideration before writing a report(10mrks)

5. a. Explain the characteristics of a good report

   b. Distinguish between the following reports
      i. Statutory and non-statutory reports (3mrks)
      ii. Special reports and routine reports (3mrks)
      iii. Progress and examinations reports (3mrks)

6. a. Define the term – terms of reference (7mrks)

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b. Explain the components of the term reference (3mrks)

7. a. Explain the content of progress report (10mrks)
   b. What is the importance of a progress report in business organization (10mrks)

8. a. Explain the term office forms and explain five users of office forms to a business organization (8mrks)
   b. Distinguish between
      i. complete forms and fill in forms
      ii. Guide forms and paragraph forms (6mrks)

   c. What are the essentials of a good office form (6mrks)
9. a. Explain eight common faults in office forms (8mrks)
   b. Explain five principals of designing office forms (12mrks)

10. a. Define questionnaires (3mrks)
    b. Explain the following types of questionnaires
       i. Structured
       ii. Unstructured
       iii. Open ended
       iv. Closed ended
       v. Mixedquestionnaire
       vi. Pictorial questionnaire
       vii. Probing questionnaire (12mrks)

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   c. Explain three factors you would consider when designing a questionnaire (5mrks)

11. a. Explain eight features of a good questionnaire (8mrks)
    b. Explain the rules of analyzing data from a questionnaire (12mrks)

12. a. Explain five uses of circulars in an organization (8mrks)
    b. Explain the importance of bulletins (organs) in an organization (12mrks)
    c. What are the objectives of house organs (bulletins) (10mrks)

13. a. Briefly explain the content of house organs (10mrks)
    b. Explain ways of making house organs effective and interesting in an organization (10mrks)

14. a. Explain the importance of notices to a business set up (8mrks)
    b. Explain the main guidelines of designing notices (12mrks)

15. a. Explain the importance of suggesting schemes (6mrks)

b. What are the advantages of using suggestion schemes to an organization (12mrks)

c. Explain ways of making suggestion schemes more effective (6mrks)

16. a. Define the term press reports (6mrks)

b. What are the features of a good press report (12mrks)

c. i. Define the term press handouts (20mrks)

ii. What are the features of a good press-handout (8mrks)

17. a. Define the term pictorial presentation (5mrks)

b. Explain five channels of pictorial presentation (10mrks)

c. Explain ways of making suggestion schemes more effective (7mrks)

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The main forms of written communication

i) Business Correspondence.

- ✓ Correspondence refers to the written communication between an organization with its stakeholders such as suppliers, customers, government department's financial institutions etc.
- ✓ The use **of letters** is the most common form of correspondence and business letters therefore are very important in communicating ideas, facts, orders etc of an organization. They form the greatest share of formal communication.

Types of letters

- ✓ Broadly speaking letters can be classified **as personal and non-personal letters**
- ✓ **Personal letters** are informal and are written to exchange ideas or seek favors. They include letters to relatives and friends. They arewritten in a friendly and informal style.
- ✓ **Non-personal** letters are written to achieve a specific purpose and often give rise to legal obligations. (Formal communication)

Business letters

- ✓ Business letters are non-personal letters and are classified as official letters. They may take the form of

a) Demi – official (D.O letters)

- ✓ These are letters official in purpose but are addressed to a person by name.
- ✓ D.O letters may be written if.
  - The matter requires personal attention of the addressee
  - The matter is of confidential nature

b) Form – letters

- ✓ Form- letters are used for correspondence **of recurring** or **routine** nature. They are used in cases of acknowledgements, reminders, interviews, notices appointments etc.

- ✓ They have a standard form with blanks left on them to be filled.Sometimes these form letters carry a number of paragraphs which can simply be ticked (√) known as forms of paragraphs usually printed on post cards.

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Classification of Business Letters

1. **Letters of inquiry**
   - ✓ Are simple letters for information, prices product details (literature favors etc).They may be written to order goods and services.
   - ✓ Large organization use purchase orders (LPO'S) while small organization uses letters of inquiry.
2. **Letter of answering requests**
   - ✓ Are letters of replies to any inquiries or requests
3. **Claims and adjustments**
   Are letters sent by customers on any undelivered items or any other claims. The letters express any complains etc
4. **Credit letters**
   - ✓ Request for various types of credit facilities.
5. **Collection letters.**
   - ✓ Are letters addressed to customers who may have enjoyed credit facilities requesting payments for overdue accounts?
6. **Sales letters**
   - ✓ Are letters which encourage people to buy commodities or products of the organization? Otheris promotional on the organization good will and public relations.
7. **Employment letters-**
   - ✓ Deal with employment matters for various positions in an organization. They include inquiries about vacant position interview letters appointment letters,etc.

8. **Social business letters**
   - ✓ Deal with matters of social business matters, that generate friendly relationship with customers and business acquaintances
9. **Memorandums**
   - ✓ Are forms of business letters written for internal operations in an

Planning a Letter

- ✓ Many business organizations have a standard letter used for mail-shorts or responding to customer's complaints. Such letters need to be planned and can be printed as and when they are needed.
- ✓ When planning to write a letter it is important to take into account the following important aspects.

i) Think about the receiver
ii) The message/reasons for writing should be clear
iii) Whether there was previous correspondence
iv) A draft of the main points to be included
v) The mode of delivery of the letter.

The essentials of an effective business letter

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1. **Promptness** – Let the response to a letter received should be prompt
2. **Knowledge of the subject** matter, past correspondences and the organization's policies
3. **Appropriateness** of tone and language to suit the needs of the occasion.
4. **Accuracy**, completeness and clarity of all facts, statements, quotations etc.
5. **Courtesy** on favors sought and expression of gratitude for any favors received
6. **Tact** of handling different issues such as compliments, complaints, credit seeking in order to gain goodwill
7. **Persuasion** in winning people to your point of view
8. **Concisenessi**.e. eliminating irrelevant and unnecessary works
9. **Positive** and pleasant approach keeping in mind the readers point of view.

Writing a business letter

- Where possible address the letter to an individual or department.
- Where a letter begins with a person's name, the closing clause should be " yours sincerely"
- Where the letter begins with Dear Sir or Madam then the ending clause is " Yours Faithfully"
- The opening of the letter should include a summary of the content.
- The body of the letter should explain the purpose of the correspondence.
- The closing of the letter should leave a final impression on the reader i.e. end with action e.g. I will call you in the next few days to discuss the matter"
- The language of business letter should be familiar as used in everyday life peculiar expressions are longer used.

The layout of a Business letter.

- ✓ The lay-out of a business letter refers to a how a business letter,
  - i. Physically appearance
  - ii. Mechanical structure (parts of the letter)
  - iii. Styles of letters and punctuations.

a) Physical appearance

- ✓ The physical elements such as
  - i) Paper stationary used should be of good quality and appealing
  - ii) The paper size should be acceptable
  - iii) The paper color should be pleasant
  - iv) The envelope used should build goowill
  - v) The letter head should contain all details such as
    - i. The full name of the organization
    - ii. The address details
    - iii. The pin code
    - iv. Telephone contacts
    - v. Fax and E-mail address.

b) Mechanical structure

- ✓ Details the appearance and parts of the letter of technical value such as
  - i) Correct spellings
  - ii) Clarity of ideas
  - iii) Organization procedures heading salutation signature etc
  - iv) The writing style and general presentation
  - v) The use of vocabulary and level of formality.

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c) The style of letter and punctuations

- ✓ The style of business letter will detail elements such as;
  - i. Paragraphs and sentences that should have relevant information
  - ii. The tone of the letter should be correct and corresponds to the impression you want to give.
  - iii. The letter presentation layout should be professional, grammatically correct with punctuation etc
  - iv. Correct typing and folding of the letter.

Parts of a business letter

- ✓ The mechanical structure of a business letter constitutes different parts of a letter that should have their customary place in the letter. They include

a) Headings
b) Inside address
c) Salutation
d) Body of the letter
e) Complementary clause
f) Signature
g) Reference initials
h) Enclosure

1. **Heading**
   - ✓ Is also called a letterhead which states the name of the company ,the address, the telephone number, telegraphic address ,fax numbers, a description of the firm's business ''the Our Ref and your Ref etc.

   - ✓ Conventionally they are placed at the top right or at the centre of the letter paper. **The date**-should be put properly on a letter, since it enables quick reference in future and proper filing. While writing the date do not use abbreviation for the month and do not cut short the year .

2. **The reference**

✓ Reference is printed either below the date line or on the same line in which he date is written.The reference serves as an identity of either the department or its sections from which the letter is being sent or the particular file in which the correspondence is to be found.

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✓ The purpose of the reference is to enable replies to be linked with previous correspondence and also to send replies to the proper official or department (for quick future reference)

✓ The usual forms include;
- Reference No.
- Ref. No.
- In reply please quote
- Please quote in future correspondence.

3. **Inside address**

✓ Contains the name and address of the firm or the individual to whom the letter is written. This helps a record on the carbon copy which serves to indentify the letter for filling purposes.

✓ It also helps the outward Clark to write the same address on the cover / envelop.It should be written below the reference line, leaving some space.

a) **For individuals**
   - ✓ The use of Mr. (esq. is the abbreviation of esquire and is considered more courteous) and Mrs., or Miss

b) Partnerships

- ✓ When writing to two or more persons in partnerships the courtesy title is masers. -A French abbreviation of messieurs a plural of Mr.

c) Limited companies

- ✓ Most of the business letters addressed to limited companies have no courtesy prefix, and the phrase "for the attention of "may be used when the letter is addressed to a particular official eg for the attention of Mr. S.M Richard.

4. The salutation

- ✓ Refers to the greetings part of a letters which commences the letter and precedes the message. The usual salutation of a business letter is dear sir, dear madam
- ✓ .The official letters use sir use Sir, Gentleman, Madam, while semi personal (Demi)letters use – Dear Mr. Okumu or Dear Sarah

5. The body of the letter

- ✓ Refers to that part of the letter which contains the message of the information to be communicated
- ✓ It consist of
  - The subject and reference
  - The opening paragraph
  - The main paragraph
  - The closing paragraph

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a) The Subject and Reference

- ✓ A brief mention of the major theme of the letter right at the beginning of the subject is required. It is usually written below the salutation
- ✓ The reference here refers to thereference number of the letter in reply to which this letter is being written.The usual forms of mentioning the subject and Reference are as follows.

Dear Sir,
Sub: Overdraft facilities
Ref: your letter No. JK/B/10-96
Ref: your order dated 10th August

b) The opening paragraph

- ✓ The opening paragraph should draw the reader's attention generating concentration .The letter should open with the expression of pleasure gratitude or acknowledgment.
- ✓ Avoid stereo type openings such as acknowledging your letter dated ……
  Yours dated 24th …..
  We are in receipt of your letter ……..
- ✓ Better opening would be ;

Thank you very much for your letter
We have received your letter

- In brief the opening paragraph should arrest the interest of the reader.

c) The main paragraph

✓ Contains the subject matter of the letter .It should be brief and to the point with all relevant matters.

- It should be clear, simple and correct in words

d) The closing paragraph

✓ The letter ending, must motivate some action from the reader. It must be natural and logical stressing the right writing point of view. It should be gentle friendly but forceful.

6. The complementary clause

✓ The complementary close or **subscription** is merely a polite way of ending a letter.It is conventional to use yours faithfully, yours truly and any similar expressions.

✓ The complementary close is the written equivalent of good-bye. The usual forms include.

Salutation	***Suitable closure***	***Remarks***
Dear Sir Dear Sirs Dear madam Mesdames	Yours faithfully Avoid yours very faithfully	Standard closure for business letters
Dear Sir Dear Sirs Dear Madam Mesdames	Yours truly	Less formal
Dear Sir)e Sir Dear Madam My Dear Madam	Yours Truly	Expresses more feeling than yours Truly
Sir, Gentleman Madam Mesdames	Yours faithfully	Appropriate while addressing supervisors in official correspondence
Dear Mr. Omondi My dear Mr. Oketch Dear Wanjin	Yours sincerely or Yours very sincerely	Very informal Relationship

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Note

- only the first letter of the closure is capital
- at the end of the closure there is no comma
- participle ending like
    - Thanking you
    - Hoping to hear from you etc are wrong since they are incomplete

7. Signature

- ✓ Refers to the assent of the writer to the subject matter of the letter and is a practical necessity.It is usually hand-written and contains the writer name status department firm e.tc

- ✓ The signature is put just below the complementary clause and should be legible.

8. Reference initials

- ✓ These are initials which help fix responsibility of the origin and write of the letter.

9. Enclosure

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- ✓ Some letters carry along enclosures such as
    - price lists
    - catalogues
    - cheques
    - invoice orders etc

- ✓ in such cases a mention should be made of these enclosures at the left side e.g

encl. (I)
(ii)
(iii)

- ✓ This helps the outward clerks to ascertain that they are included.

The purpose of a job application letter and how it uses AIDA

- ✓ **AIDA** is the abbreviated form of A**- attention**, **interest** (I) **Desire** D and (A) **Actio**n – AIDAorganization model.

The purpose of application letters include

i) Indentify interested people who may meet the qualification of a particular job separated from those not interested and do not meet qualification

ii) Gives the HR professional first hand chance to screenout non qualified applicant eg through – poor spellings, ineligible penmanship , documents that do not support qualification etc
iii) Source of gathering vital information about prospective employees.
iv) Application letters facilitate employers evaluate experience, education background and the overall potential of the prospective employees
v) The application letters facilitate screening processing and scheduling for interviews.

AIDA organizational model

A- Attention

✓ The job applicants catch the attention of the hiring person by capturing the reader's attention. This is achieved by expressing intension to secure the job and indentifying the position of work that you he or she is seeking.

I- Interest

✓ The applicant raises the employer's interest by focusing on and demonstrating the advantages and benefits, how suited he or she is, the experiences and qualifications he/she has to the vacant position.

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D- Desire

✓ The application will express desire by demonstration knowledge of the organization and citing its operations or trends in the industry.

A-Action

✓ Leads the potential employer towards taking action to invite you for an interview at the reader's convenience.

Circumstances under which written communication will be preferred to oral communication

- Where the massage requires editing before being sent
- Where the communication is to many people in different locations
- Where the information being communicated needs to be accurate.
- Where one does not want a face to face discussion
- Where there is need for future reference
- Where the information is in huge figures formulas etc that may be difficult to explain verbally.

The functions of a business letter.

- Convey information about the business activities to customers, suppliers, debtors gov. department, financial institutions, etc
- conclude transaction
- Facilitate putting records of businesses.
- Creation of demand
- Circular letters are used to create demand for new products when communicating too many people at the same time.
- Creation of goodwill and a positive image of the business organization.
- Circular letters help open up new markets and establish a new client base
- Establishes new, better and mutual relationship with stakeholders
- Letters provide evidence for futures reference.

The Constituent Parts of a Business Letter

1. **The heading** i.e. return address or letter head bears detailed identity information of the organization sending the letter
2. **Date o**f writing the letter
3. **The inside address**I.e. the receiver address including, name if known to the company, Telephone No. P.O BOX etc
4. **The greeting** also called salutation eg dear sir.
5. **The subject line** (optional) normally preceded with words such as subject or RE:
6. **The body paragraphs** comes with the message to be communicated.
7. **The complementary close** is short polite and the type depends on the letter, type e.g yours faithfully.
8. **Signature** and the writer's identification
9. **Initials of - enclosures** such encl., where appropriate.

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Examination questions

Question 1

a) Describe the main functions of a business letter (5mks)
b) Explain five kinds of business letters (10mks)
c) State the essentials features of an effective business letter (5mks)

Question 2

a) Give a comprehensive view of the layout of a business letter (10mks)
b) Explain the eight parts of a business letter (10mks)

Question 3

a) Write short notes on –planning a business letter"
b) Explain the following
    a. Per pro signature

b. Inside address
c. Reference initials
d. Complementary close.

Question 4
Draft a letter to M/s Kariuki and sons, asking for a copy of their latest catalogue. State that you propose to stock watches for sale. Ask for their best trade terms for the supply of their watches and clocks.

Question 5
Write a letter from S.M Richard Traders, giving quotation for the supply of electrical pump-sets. Emphasize in your letter the installation service and replacement facilities provided to your consumers.

Question 6
You have received a big order for stocks of various sizes and colors, but are unable to execute it in time owing to certain difficulties. You write to the customer asking for extension of time. The customers are willing to grant extension of time up to a certain date. Draft both the letters.

Question 7
You have received a large first order from a customer. Write a letter thanking him and asking him to furnish y for extension of time. The customers are willing to grant extension of time up to a certain date. Draft both the letters.

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Question 8
You have received a large first order from a customer. Write a letter thanking him and asking him to furnish you with the names of his bankers and trade references.

Question 9
You have received a complaint from a valued customer from Nakuru pointing out that steel furniture he had ordered for a special occasion has arrived in a damaged condition. Though the fault is of the transport company, you decide to replace the damaged furniture immediately. Draft a suitable reply to the customer.

Question 10
An old and valued customer of yours whose account has remained unsettled in spite of reminders now writes to you that he neither settled the account nor wrote to you owing to certain domestic worries. He encloses with the letter a cheque in part payment. Write a letter to the customer in a manner which you consider suitable in the circumstances.

Question 11
You are the founder – Manufacturer of a specific remedy for insect stings and skin eruptions with a patent and registered trademark. Having discovered that a competitor has introduced a cheap imitation of your product, draft a circular letter warning the competitor of the

consequences. Send a warning the public against being cheated into buying this duplicate product.

Question 12
Draft a sales letter to promote the sales of some new cosmetics

Question 13
Draft an application letter of the post of the Chief accountant of a large public limited company.

Question 14
Telegraphically inform Mr. S.S Kariuki that he has been appointed works manager in your company. Then write the confirmatory letter giving all the terms and conditions of appointment.

Question 15
Draft a letter to Mr. G. .S Onchieng working as Chief Accountant in your company confirming his service.

Question 16
Draft a letter to be sent to Mr. S.N Komothos, working as an accountant in your company confirming him that he has been promoted to the post of the Junior Accounts officer .

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Question 17
Draft a suitable letter to be sent to a candidate extending the period of his probation in the company.

Question 18
Mr. S.N Ouko an assistant accountant in your company has not been working satisfactorily. Write a letter to him terminating his services.

QUESTIONS

1. Define visual communication (3mrks)
   b. Explain five channels of visual communication (10mrks)
   c. Explain ways posters can be made more effective (7mrks)

2. a. Explain the importance of rehearsals before making a presentation (7mrks)
   b. Explain ways you may employ in order to make audio-visual communication more effective (7mrks)
   c. What are the advantages of using visual aids in presentations (6mrks)

3. a. What are the principals of effective use of visual aid (7mrks)
   b. Explain ways of improving note taking (7mrks)

c. Explain how the following will and effective communication
   i. block diagrams
   ii. flow charts
   iii. comics
   iv. swim lines (7mrks)

4. a. Define mechanical communication (2mrks)
   b. Explain five barriers of mechanical communication (8mrks)
c. i. Define noise (2mrks)
   ii. Explain five types of noise (8mrks)

5. a. Explain four sources of internal noise
(3mrks)
   b. Explain four sources of external noise (10mrks)
   c. Explain five common sources of noise in a wireless communication channel (7mrks)

6. a. Explain five ways of overcoming noise barriers in communication (3mrks)
   b. Define graphic communication and explain the advantages of graphic communication
(10mrks)

7. a. Define the terms business proposal b. Distinguish between solicited for and unsolicited for proposals (10mrks)
   c. Explain ways posters can be made more effective (7mrks)

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8. a. What are the goals of ethical communication (3mrks)
   b. Explain ways of promoting communication ethics (10mrks)
   c. What are the characteristics of communication ethics (7mrks)

TOPICAL EXAMINATION QUESTIONS

Question 1

a) Briefly explain the term mailing as used in business (4mks)
b) Explain the advantages and disadvantages of centralization of mailing services to an organization. (16mks)

Question 2

a) Define the term departmentalization (4mks)
b) What are the advantages and disadvantages of departmentalization of mailing services in an organization? (16mks)

Question 3

a) Explain the procedures of handling incoming mails (20mks)

Question 4

a) Define record management (3mks)
b) What are the objectives of record management (7mks)
c) Explain the essential of a good filing system (10mks)

Question 5

a) Explain the principles of record management (10mks)
b) Explain the steps an office manager should put in place in order to maintain secrecy and confidentiality. (10mks)

Question 6

a) Explain the procedures of mail dispatch (10mks)
b) Explain the role of courier services (10mks)

Question 7

a) Describe two types of manual filing equipments stating their advantages and disadvantages.
b) Suggest the type of documents that may be stored in each type of equipment.

Question 8

a) What is the purpose of printed form?
b) What conditions must be satisfied before an additional form is introduced and approved for use in a office

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Question 9

a) Using suitable examples discuss the advantages and disadvantages of centralization of clerical work in an office.
b) Outline a system of organizing , the ordering, custody and issue of office stationary items in an office

Question 10

State and explain the essential features of a good feeling system.

Question 11

Explain

i) Suspension filing and any advantage associated with this type of filing
ii) Lateral filing and its advantages
iii) Horizontal filing advantages
iv) Vertical filing advantages.

Question 12

Explain the advantages and disadvantages of centralized office services and illustrate these with reference to two examples.

A large amount of information used in business is often collected on forms

a) What are the basic principles of a good form design
b) List and briefly explain two problems that you may encounter in designing forms.

Question 13

a) List the essential features of a well designed form
b) List some common faults that are normally found in forms

c) State the objectives of proper system of controlling forms in an office.

Question 14

a) What is meant by the term filing
b) Explain the advantages and disadvantages of numerical filing
c) List and explain the merits a card index

Question15

a) Explain the general rules of filing
b) What are the advantages and disadvantages of centralized filing

Question 16

a) Describe the following types of manual filing equipment stating their advantages and disadvantages.

i) Vertical filing cabinets
ii) Lateral filing

Question 17

What factors should an office manager consider when deciding the amount of stationary to be held in stock?
List and explain the advantages and disadvantages of using photocopying machines

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Question 16

a) Give a concise definition of a form and using suitable examples indicate the purposes of printed forms in an office.
b) In an office where different types of forms are in use, name the conditions which should be satisfied before an additional form is introduced and approved for use in an office.
c) Explain the following methods of classification of files stating their advantages and disadvantages

i) Alphabetical classification
ii) Numerical classification

Question 17

a) The purchase storage and issues of stationery may be controlled by the office manager

Outline an ideal system of organizing the purchase custody and issue of stationary items in an office.

Question 18

a) For what reasons is centralization of office work desirable?
b) What are the advantages of decentralization of office services?

Question 19

a) Explain the advantages and disadvantages of storing information in microfilms instead of folders and files

Question 20

a) Name three filing system and briefly explain the advantages of each
b) List and explain the essential features of a good filing system

Question 22
Discuss the principles of a good record management and briefly explain purposes of maintaining records in an organization.

Question 23
Describe a system of organizing, purchasing custody and issue of office stationery.

Question 24
a) What do you understand by the term disaster recovery procedures
b) Explain the disaster recovery procedures that the office manager must follow in order to recover the lost data.
c) State and a briefly explain the factors that may influence the duration of retention of documents in an organization.

Question 25
a) What are the advantages of using forms in an organization
b) Explain the factors to be considered in designing office forms

Question 26
a) Describe the features of an efficient filing system in a large organization

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Question 27
a) What factors should be considered before purchasing an office duplicating machine
b) Describe the measures that an office manager should take to ensure that office machines are in good conditions.
c) Using suitable examples discuss the advantages and disadvantages of centralization of the registry services.

Question 28
a) What are the aspects that should be taken into consideration when choosing a filing system
b) Give the main advantages and disadvantages of
   i) Alphabetical filing by subject \
   ii) Alphabetical filing by geographical distribution.

TOPIC 3

BUSINESS CORRESPONDENCE

Correspondence refers to the written communication between an organization with its stakeholders such as suppliers, customers, government department's financial institutions etc.

Handling of Business Correspondence

- Receiving mails
- Mail sorting
- Mail filling Storage and retrieval of mails
- Dispatch of mails
- Postal and courier services
- Topical exam questions.

Mailing (business correspondence)

- ✓ **Mail** refers to the incoming and outgoing written letters. It is the process of receiving and sending of letters in a business organization.
- ✓ Office mails may be divided into three

i) Incoming mail (receiving)
ii) Outgoing mail (sending)
iii) Inter departmental mail

- ✓ The mailing system in an organization is of great importance, hence desire for well organization and efficient mailing system. In large organizations and government department, a separate a section to handle mails is set known **as the registry**.

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Receiving mail (Registry)

- ✓ Files that belong to each department of a company may be kept at a central place. The system established here is called centralized filling system.

Advantages of centralized mailing system

1. Clear responsibility is laid down on receiving filling and retrieval of mail
2. Suitably qualified staff can be appointed and trained to handle mails
3. Related matters from other departments can be consolidated together in a single file
4. Avoids duplication of work
5. File movements can be accountable and efficient
6. Ease of employing suitable equipments
7. Economy of space
8. Uniform system of filling can be established throughout the organization.

Disadvantages of centralized filing

1. Retrieval procedures may be longer than localized systems
2. Filling staff may lack specialized departmental knowledge
3. Not suitable for confidential documents
4. Difficulty of obtaining urgent documents when a file may be in use in another department.

Departmentalization of mail services

- ✓ Departmentalization of mail services refers to an arrangement whereby each office department provides for its own mailing services by establishing its own mail station and staff not shared with other departments

Advantages of departmentalization

1. Speed up work as there is less volumes of work
2. Suitable for certain tasks especially confidential work or records
3. Reduces need for messengers
4. Offers personal contact between workers and executives
5. Reduces lack of co-operation among works.

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Disadvantages of departmentalization

1. No benefit of specialization
2. Wastage of time and space
3. Requires a large capital in order to invest in all departments
4. The system tends to duplicate work.
5. Leads to congestion of work in busy departments and less work to departments that are not busy

Receiving mail (incoming mails)

- ✓ The incoming mail section handles all correspondence coming into the organization.
- ✓ For efficiency purposes there should be clear and carefully designed procedure that must be followed property on;
- Mail collection
- Opening of office mail (mail sorting)
- Recording of office mail
- Mail forwarding
- Filling Storage and retrieval of mails

a) Mail collection

- ✓ Mails are mostly collected by a **designated messager** who collects the key from a designated senior officer. There should be a fixed time of collecting mail (usually in the morning and also once in the afternoon)

- ✓ A collection bag or box should be provided to safely carry the mail to the sorting officer(room) .

b) **Opening of mail (sorting room)**

- ✓ Registered mail, telegrams and special delivery letters must be signed and dealt with immediately
- ✓ A register mail book should be used for letters which contain important documents for accountability and safety.

- ✓ When all received has been sorted, recorded then the following procedures are followed.
    - Mail should opened with at **least two clerks** in the presence of **supervisor** or a senior official.
    - Open all letters except those marked private, or confidential or personal.
    - All cheques money orders, postal orders, bank drafts etc be crossed as account payee and recorded
    - All letters market with enclosure should be rechecked and securely affixed together and recorded
    - Re-check envelopes for contents before discarding to make sure that no enclosure is left inside

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c) Recording of received mail

- ✓ In small organization or departments, a book may be kept to record all income mail.In large organizations where mails are bulk only those letters with enclosures such as cheques will be recorded.

- ✓ When recording mail, the clerk will mark the
    - Ref
    - Date received
    - Your file ref.

d) Forwarding of mail procedures

- ➢ All mail be read and sorted into piles of urgent important and routine mail.
- ➢ Get files for all the relevant or previous correspondence and clip the new letters to the files
- ➢ Distribute mail as quickly as possible once received and sort them out as delays may prove expensive.

- Personal and confidential letters should be forwarded withoutopenning
- When handing over mail to relevant offices, they should be sorted as follows.
    - Telegrams and registered mail on top
    - Personal or confidential letters to follow
    - Letters of material requiring immediate attention
    - Correspondence of general importance
    - Routine mail

1. Letters that may need the attention of more than one department can
    - ✓ List on top of the letters names or initials of the officers to attend to them or;
    - ✓ Rubber stamps or departments that need to attend to them or
    - ✓ Attach a circulation slip or routing slip to them.
2. For very urgent letters or of immediate attention, photo-copies be made and sent to the concerned personnel.

Record management (mail filing procedures)

- ✓ Records are very important in a modern office set up. The office is responsible for maintaining the records for future reference
- ✓ A good filling system provides a systematic protection and maintenance of office records for further reference at future times Filling is the process of arranging and preserving records or copies of records so that they are readily available when required.
- ✓ It aims at enabling the office personnel locate documents needed, easily, conveniently and quickly.

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The objectives of record management

i) In order to keep accounts of progress. eg patient records, that need monitoring progress, give history and past records for further decision making
ii) Provide a proper study of the position of the firm considering past positions.
iii) Provide a basis of comparison of business.
iv) Give evidence in case of a dispute
v) For policy making decisions.
vi) For legal requirements eg final accounts for say ltd companies.
vii) For general reference to enable work flow.

The Essentials of a Good Filing System (Characteristics)

- ✓ A good filling system should have the following characteristics or qualities.

i) It should **be compact** not taking too much space
ii) Documents and files should be arranged that each should be located and removed without having to disturb
iii) others (**accessibility)**
iv) Classification of files should be arranged such that each should be simple and easy to understand **(simplicity)**
v) Documents should be so kept that they have no or have minimum risk of destruction by such perils as fire **(safety)**

vi) The system should allow for files to be removed but such removal should be noted on such things **as out guides** and it should be possible to know as to with whom is the missing file lying **(cross- referencing)**

- Whatever system is chosen it should be appropriate to the needs of the business concerned.For example the filling need of a doctor is quite different from those of a manufacturing company.

vii) The cost both of initial outlay and maintenance of the system should be well within the means o the business **(economy)**

- ✓ There are no hard and fast rules by which the documents are filed .The system and method of filing will generally depend upon the size of the office.
- ✓ The importance of a good filing system in a competitive environment is quick and, efficient, retrieval of filed documents
- ✓ The office may keep several types of records which include.
  - Personnel records
  - Correspondence records
  - Accounting records
  - Legal documents
  - Other business records

Principles of record management

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- **Verification.**Records should be kept such that they can be verified whenever needed.
- **Justification** .Records must be maintained with some justifiable purpose; otherwise it would be a waste of money, space and time.
- **Classification .**Records must be classified according to their use.
- **Flexibility** .The required information must be elastic in capacity so that expanding of the information and contraction is possible.
- **Information**. The record system must be able to avail information at any time of need.
- **Reasonable cost**. The cost of record management must be reasonable.

Filing

Definition of filing

- ✓ Filing is a process of classifying and arranging records so that they can be obtained without delay.

Advantages of filing office documents.

i) Creates ready reference
ii) Time saving and increased efficiency
iii) Safeguards the documents against loses
iv) Old or past records serve as reliable basis for future planning
v) Past records provide evidence

vi) Provide a basis of keeping records as a legal obligation
vii) Provides control system of disposing of unnecessary documents
viii) Facilitates economy of space
ix) Improves appearance of the office considerably.

Definition of centralized filing

- ✓ Centralized filing refers to the filing system where all files of the organization are filed in a single registry office and utilization is by all departments of the organization

Advantages of centralized filing

i) Easy to develop specialized filing staff.
ii) All files are controlled in one room
iii) More supervision and control over files is possible
iv) It ensures that all correspondence about the same subject is files together.
v) A uniform system of filing can be established throughout the organization.

Definition of departmental filing

- ✓ Departmental filling refers to a system of filing where each department does its own filing

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The advantages of departmental filing

i) Files are quickly made available due to the fact that;
  - They are within the department
  - They are few follow little procedures.
ii) The filing system is not too large and therefore easier to handle
iii) May not need specialized staff to handle reducing costs
iv) It is more suitable to handle confidential documents.

Methods of classification of files

- ✓ Classification system refers to the basis of arrangement of documents in folders especially in larger organization.
- For smaller offices it refers to the arrangement of documents in a file which once if filled another is opened.
- Office records can be classified under.

I) Alphabetical classification

- ✓ Under this method documents are filed in the alphabetical order of the fist name of either the sender or the subject.

✓ If a number of files are kept each file is given a title

ii) Geographical

- ✓ Under this system papers or files are divided according to geographical locations, for example by country or by provinces in a country or by districts in a province depending upon the nature of the company's activities.

✓ This method of classification is useful for companies that have several braches spread over different parts of the country eg commercial banks

Advantages

- Suitable for companies with several branches spread over different parts of the country.
- Convenience of reference where the location is known
- Direct access for filling purposes.

Disadvantages of geographical filing

- Possibility of error where knowledge of geography is weak
- Geographical location must be know in addition to the correspondence name
- Index is necessary for occasional reference.

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iv) Chronological filing

- ✓ Under this system all documents are filed in date order . It is particularly useful to file documents in a file in date order. The system is rarely used absolutely by itself but is the usual method of dealing with individual files.

Advantages

- Useful where dates are known
- It provides unlimited scope of expansion.

Disadvantages

- It is not always suitable
- Incoming letters might become separated from outgoing ones.

v) Subjectclassification

- ✓ Files are classified according to subject headings or topics
- ✓ Main headings and subsidiary items arein alphabetical order.

Advantages

- All documents referring to a particular subject matter are kept in the same place.

- File are easily expanded or contracted by adding and subtracting

Disadvantages

- Determining the list of divisions is difficult and requires someone with knowledge of the business and its files.
- Determining under which subject headings a document should be filed requires a trained and careful employee.

Factors influencing choice of a filing system

- The number of files and documents that need to be retained.
- Simple in use and easy to explain to a new employee
- It should be one which one could take up after a brief induction eg alphabetical filing system.
- There must be room for expansion and capacity to accommodate new files without the need to change the existing documents I,e their sequence order.
- There must be ease of reference and minimum possibility of miss-filing.
- A document need not have more than one file or be filed under different subjects.
- The cost of keeping files must be minimum
- Each filing classification should have different equipments and maintenance costs of keeping them.

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Filing Equipment

- ✓ There is a wide range of equipment available for the storage of information in an organization.
- ✓ Filing equipment consists of covers, folders, filing cabinets etc

Purpose of filing equipment

- Protection of documents against losses though careless handling, damage by fire or water and deterioration through dust.
- Prevention from theft or unauthorized use
- Minimize time taken on retrieval
- Facilitate confidentiality of documents.
- Easy retrieval of files and the filing process.

a) Files

- ✓ Def. A file is a collection of paper or documents dealing with one person or topic and the equipment in which they are kept is known as a **file cover or binder.**
- ✓ There are different types of file covers.

i) Box file

- ✓ These have a solid box- like construction and spring loaded compression pad which holds down the field material firmly.
- ✓ Box files may be used to keep letters, leaflets , catalogues etc

ii) Concertina files

- ✓ These are made up of a number of succession pockets into which similar documents can be collected readily for processing
- ✓ They are suitable for temporary documents and processing like petty cash vouchers and such documents which do not need to be punched.

iii) Ring binders

- ✓ These are made of hard covers and two or more rings which open to allow the insertion and retrieval of documents.

Filling methods and cabinets

- ✓ The following are the commonly used filing methods.

i) Vertical filing or suspension filing

- ✓ The cabinets used here are made to suite the suspension filing system. This is when the keeping of files within the drawers, racks or shelves is done by keeping the files standing up-right, north to south.
- ✓ The titles normally placed at the top edge of the files which are normally visible. Files are normally safe and secure as they are in the filing cabinets.

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Note

- That vertical filling is at times referred to as **suspicion filling** where files are suspended on two metal bars with pockets that carry folders .

The main advantages

- papers are kept upright and tidy
- easy to locate due to strips of paper indicating location
- saves time of locating and refilling

Disadvantages

- Easy to miss-file and secondary strips wear off.

ii) Horizontal filing

- ✓ The horizontal filing cabinet houses number of shallow drawers in which contents are laid horizontally.These are more useful for storing stationary, photographs, maps, stencils, drawings etc than for files,

Comparison of horizontal and vertical filing

Advantages of horizontal filing

i) Letters are carefully fastened
ii) Security of papers against pilfering and creasing
iii) Order of filing does not change even when drawer falls

Disadvantages of horizontal filing

i) Inconveniencing when filing or retrieving since it has no strips instead one has to reshuffle looking for documents.
ii) May not handle large volumes of large files but cheap for small filing.
iii) Paper must be punched
iv) Can handle different clients in one filing system
v) Requires smaller space
vi) May not adopt to increased filing

Advantages of Vertical filing

i) Papers are loose under vertical
ii) Does not have paper security
iii) Any fall will spoil order
iv) Not inconveniencing when filing or removing since there are indicating strips
v) Can handle large volumes of larger files
vi) Papers may not need punching
vii) Each individual is kept separate
viii) Larger space is required
ix) More adoptable to expansion due to increased filing.

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Lateral filling

- ✓ The cabinets used hold files in suspended filing packed in a vertical position. . They differ from vertical cabinets in only one respect.Filing packets are held laterally along the shelves of the cabinet rather than the drawers.
- ✓ The files are stored on the shelve or pockets suspended . The method saves the space because of the great high utilizing space fully
- ✓ The term lateral is used to mean that they are arranged side by side.

Circular filing or rotary filing

- ✓ Perhaps the least common of all cabinets, circular cabinets are a variation of lateral cabinets with files being kept in packets held in circular rather than lateral shelves.This enables a great many records to be filed in wallets or packets around a central vertical pillar.

- ✓ They economize on space and are very accessible and can be used by several filing clerks at the same time.

- Whatever type of filing is undertaken within an office system i.e.
  - ♦ Manual filing as analyzed above
  - ♦ Electronic filing
  - ♦ Micrographic filing
- Sound procedures will enable their efficient use.

The Procedure of Keeping Documents

1. The first rule is to keep all documents to be filed in a folder or file.
2. Arrange the documents in a specific manner.
3. Classify the documents under headings like orders, invoices, correspondence e.tc
4. Then each set is filed in the respective files on the basis of the classification followed by the organization.
5. The documents must be kept for a specific period say 5 years
6. After the period, they are sorted to those
   i) That need destruction
   ii) That may been permanent storage.

Indexing

✓ An index is a device for finding the position of document or file in a system quickly and easily. In other words an index means to guide something. It is an indicator, indicating the location of a document.

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✓ It provides quick reference for example if files are kept numerically an index may be maintained listing the file title alphabetically, giving the specified number of file among many files.

The importance of indexing

- Guides to facilitate a good filing system.
- Provides a ready reference
- Facilitates easy location of files
- Saves time speeding up location of documents
- Possesses minimum information.

Types of indexing

a) Page index

✓ This is when the contents of a particular folder or cabinet are summarized on a piece of paper together with their positions and placed at either the front or back of the folder. It is like one found in the back of a book.

b) Loose card indexes

- ✓ This is a small card showing the names of all correspondence and the files where their information is filed .The cards are kept together and whenever a file or document is required, reference is first made to the card which guides where it is located.

c) Visible card index

- ✓ The cards are filed with the documents and overlap so that one line of entry on each card projects and is visible thus forming a one line index.

d) Strip indexes

- ✓ It is the method of recording information on a strip of paper for quick reference. The strips are bound together one on top of the other with a portion of each one being visible
- ✓ It is a quick and neat method of and locating information.

e) Vertical card index

- ✓ Under this method, the card stands upright in cabinet drawer boxes. The name and other indentifying features are exposed to view.The cards are sub- divided into sections using letters or alphabet with projecting guide cards.

- ✓ This system is useful where correspondences are removed frequently for references.Classification may be used using colored cards.

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f) Punched card index

- ✓ A series of holes are punched in the edge of each card. Each hole represents an item of information such as department. Age, sex etc.

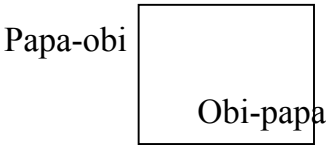
- ✓ To obtain card bearing of the same information the operator uses a steel needle which is passed though the position on the card recording the information and those cards which have been slotted in the potion fall away from the rest of the cards.

- ✓ The indexing card may be used to compile a system of records cards from which selected cards can be moved from the cabinet quickly when they are required for reference.

Cross – Reference

- ✓ It is possible for a correspondence to be filed in three different files. A good cross reference system must be to be maintained in such a situation.It is a form of a card or folder directing a person where a document which can be filed under more than one file is found.

- ✓ Example " papa – obi" might be filed under Papa obi file or in Obi-papa file. Here across reference may be then used where a letter is filed under obi-papa to direct where it is located.



- ✓ In big firms where photo –copying machine is available several copies are made and files each bearing the information where the original is

Importance of cross reference

- When more than one name is used in correspondence it facilitates location
- Re-directs where reference can be on initials of names
- Important where names change
- Assist in circumstances of foreign names that may be difficult to decide the indexing unit.

- ✓ Cross reference differs from indexing in that indexing is away of classifying and illustrating on how files and information in it can be located.

- ✓ While cross reference is an illustration of the location of a particular file from the alternative position where it can be found.

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Marking absent files (dealing with absent files) (out cards)

- ✓ If a file is likely to be removed for a couple of days, marked folders should be inserted in the place with reference as to where it can be located.At times it is referred to as an out card.

- ✓ A loan registry book should be used to note down when files are taken out and date or time expected back..
  - The names of persons who have taken the file, number of files and the date anticipated in.
  - When returned a signature be entered to cancel the entry.

Released filing

- ✓ Before letters can be filed they must have been replied to . Any person responsible for replying to letters will usually mark on the corner of the letter with an agreed upon release symbol or letter eg letter F .

- ✓ Alternatively he will place it in a basket that is labeled for filling.

Retention of records and archiving

- ✓ Documents and records are not all expected to be kept permanently in the filing cabinets.When the records become in active they should be either destroyed or transferred to reserve storage

- ✓ Because of the small storage space available unnecessary records should never be held for unduly long periods.Any records that may be needed later should therefore be separated.
- ✓ Most organizations have adopted a retention period bearing in mind costs, space, future needs and the nature of the documents.

Micro-Filming

- ✓ Is a method of retaining or keeping information by photographic records to reproduce them when need may arise.The records are micro-photographed and kept either on **roll film, micro-fitches,anaperture-card or jackets.**

- ✓ When needed for reference, the negative is shown on a screen or a copy can be made.Micro-filming is only important when a great magnitude of permanent records must be kept e.g registration of births or deaths e.tc

Advantages of micro-filming

- Saves space and weight – bulky files are replaced by compact –cartons of films
- Documents can be sent abroad – micro- filming reduces cost of postage if information has to be sent by say air mail.
- There is little risk of misplacing by filing as would be in loose paper form
- A film is more durable than paper and provides a much more permanent record. (its wear resistant)
- A film can be enlarged on to paper, thus providing quick and accurate duplicate copies of the original document.
- There is saving in filing equipment as well as floor space.

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Disadvantages of micro-filming

- Relatively slow because the film has to be viewed though the reader machine
- No indexing is possible and thus location of a particular frame may be difficult and may cause delays and frustrations.
- Micro-filmed information cannot be altered which is a disadvantage because sometimes it is necessary to make corrections of information stored.
- May cause big losses incase one film is destroyed or lost
- Poor processing may lead to destructionor rendering data not readable.

Factors that influence length of retention period

a) Cost of holding records
b) Availability of space
c) Volume of records to be retained
d) Legal requirements for example 5 years normal records 12 years for special contract documents.
e) Frequency of reference

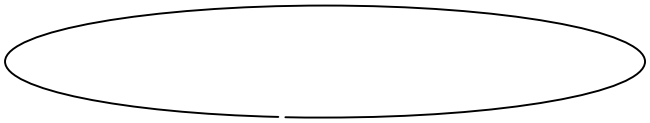
f) Nature of the documents to be retained.

Archiving

The record cycle

- ✓ Records whatever their form passes through a cycle and sound procedures and methods are required at each stage of the cycle.
- ✓ For example it is in the creation stage "that decisions need to be made with regard to the length of time records need to be stored before they can be destroyed.

creation utilization storage



Destruction retrieval

i) At the utilization stage

- ✓ it is important that records are kept is such a way that information can be retrieved quickly and efficiently by whoever may need it .Efficient procedures should exist to ensure good work flow.

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- ✓ Much of this will depend upon the appropriateness of classification, the quality of the initial indexing and the existence of an adequate cross – referencing systems which should be incorporated into filing procedures at the creation stage.

- ✓ The utilization stage is concerned with the selection of suitable equipment and the utilization of space together with convenience and accessibility for those who need the information.

- ✓ It is at this point in the cycle that the desirability of introducing some form of centralized record management will be considered.

- ✓ The physical safety of documents in storage and security aspects such as confidentiality and authorized access need to be taken into account also

ii) The retrieval stage

- ✓ Is largely concerned with the speed and ease with which documents can be located on request.
- ✓ This will depend on aspects such as the suitability of classification, equipment and authorized access will also involve the setting up of appropriate lending system or signing out.

iii) The archiving/destruction stage

- ✓ Determines the format in which records should be stored e.g the original hard copy or in some type of microfilm storage translate in computerized storage or transferred to archival storage
- ✓ A decision will also be made to be taken into relation to methods of destruction e.g (shredding) when destroying some documents

Note: the Archive

- ✓ An archive stores a collection of historically valuable records, ranging from files, papers documents to photographs, films, video tapes and sound recording e.t.c
- ✓ Some documents especially government documents may be kept between 30 years to even 100 years.
- ✓ The term archive therefore has reference to a place where historical records and other important documents are preserved
- ✓ In modern times the term also refers to the back-up storage of computer data

Secrecy and confidentiality

- ✓ Some correspondence stored in records though not strictly confidential would be of great interest to competitors.
- ✓ Personal records of each employ especially as regards terms of employment are important aspects that must be carefully considered and therefore secrecy, confidentiality and record security cannot just be ignored in an organisation.

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Steps of maintaining secrecy and confidentiality

- ✓ The following steps must be put in place to ensure secrecy and confidentiality are kept.

- Filing cabinets and the registry must be locked with the keys under the custody of a designated office.
- Important file cabinets with the most confidential files be opened by two officers at designated access time.
- There should be proper supervision and sensible selection of the registry clerks employed
- Very confidential files must be carefully controlled and in most cases kept with relevant managers and not the registry.
- Removal and retention of individual documents from files by users must not be allowed
- Access to file cabinets be restricted to authorized staff only
- Any photocopying of documents be done by authorized personal only
- Very confidential documents be separated from not very confidential ones.

Dispatch of mail

- ✓ It is important that outgoing mail should leave the office as soon as possible so as to realize the desired results of sending them.

- ✓ T he procedures of handling such will depend on specific requirements of individual firms and the volume of mail involved.

There are three main aspects of mail dispatch. They include.

a) Delivery of mail from various departments to the mail room

i) The organization should clearly spell out as to whose responsibility it is to pick outgoing mail from various departments to the mailroom
ii) There should be fixed timing for delivery of mail collection
iii) Collection points should be clearly defined i.e. "out-trays"
iv) All mail should be sent to the mailroom unsealed except for confidential ones .The aim is to safeguard against sending personal mail
v) Any mail to be sent must be registered indicating department of source or office concerned – special stickers can be used at the office of origin.

b) Preparing mail for disport received in mail room.

i) All letters received in the mail office should be checked by the mail staff to ensure that they are duly signed and that all enclosures if any are included.
ii) Letters should be matched to their corresponding envelops
iii) Letter should be folded and then put in envelops then sealed (bulk letters may require the use of a folding ad sealing machine.
iv) Use of window envelops for outgoing mail to ensure sending of the correct letters to the correct address.
v) Weigh the letters for correct postage amount.
vi) Stamp the letters normally a franking machine is used in.

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c) Recording of outgoing (dispatched) mail

i. All letters should now be sorted & those to be delivered within the locality be registered in the delivery book.
ii. Where a franking machine is used for stamping the franked letters should be adopted in the post office immediately.
iii. Registered and express mail should be taken to their respective postage and courier stations.
iv. Records of stamps costs must be property kept.

The mail room equipment

- Stapling machine- used for affixing letters and enclosures
- Letter opener- is a hand device like knife which trims along the edge of an envelope.
- Price scales to assist in weighing correspondence
- Stamp moistening device
- A date stamp , records the date of receiving
- Shredding machines- destroys paper
- Paper punch – puts holes on paper ready for filing
- Addressing machine – used to address the outside of envelopes.

- Franking machine – used to print postal stamps
- Guillotine – used for cutting and trimming papers to the required size
- Composite machine- used for folding documents insert then in envelopes and seal them.

The postal franking machines

- ✓ This machine prints postage stamps on the envelopes. The machine can be bought from any manufacturer licensed or be rented by the post office.
- ✓ A lump sum amount is then paid to the post office in advance to facilitate setting the machine for the use of the amount paid.
- ✓ Each time a postage stamp is printed on an envelope the value is deducted from the present amount and once fully utilized the machine locks itself and can be reset only by the postal authorities on another advance payment.
- ✓ The machine has a meter which shows the number of stamps used and those remaining in the machine.

Advantages of franking machines

1. Compared to hand stamping or manual stamping the franking machine can speed work in the shortest time possible.
2. It provides a safety measure of dealing with stamps rather than holding a large stock stamps
3. Provides an easier accounting control
4. Provides convenience to staff since affixing and accounting are combined when using the machine
5. Dispatch of mail is a lot quicker since they go directly to the post office.
6. Provides advertising slogans on the envelopes

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Disadvantages

1. Wastage of stamps can easily occur when in use by inexperienced staff
2. Franked mail must be checked first by the postal staff before postage hence time wasting
3. Miss-use may occur where controls are poor.
4. Stamps have to be stocked for emergency purpose even with a franking machine.

Postal and courier services

- ✓ Postal and courier services are non-core activities that can be outsourced in scales that depend on the nature and business needs of the organization.
- ✓ Business communication with people outside the organization will more often than not be of formal natures since it has a lot of impact on the way the organization presents itself to the outside environment.
- ✓ Letters and parcels to be delivered to customers or suppliers will have to be sent through the channels the organization may deem appropriate.
- ✓ The choice of channel of delivery will depend on the organization.

- ✓ Modern – businesses correspondence are carried out over the internet, E- commerce, Email video conferencing etc are all technology that have come up in recent years to relieve courier service organizations of the hustles of passing messages.

The uses of postal and courier services

i) Responding to invitations to tenders
ii) Sending cheque payments to suppliers
iii) Delivering goods to customer
iv) Sending business documents to customers
v) Responding to customer queries
vi) Application for credit/ loan facilities.

Postal services

- ✓ For a long period, postal services were produced for by the government or state controlled postal services- today private institutions have taken advantages of the liberalization of the service sector creating competition in service delivering and variety choices.
- ✓ One of the important challenges to postal and courier services , both the public and private is competition from other communication services provides such as;
  i) Facsimile
  ii) Electronic – mail
  iii) Electronic money transfer
  iv) Data networks

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- ✓ Traditionally postal services have been used in the following ways or areas.
  i) Postal services related to letters, newspapers , journals, periodicals, brochures etc use pick -ups vans transport for local deliveries and Air transport..
  ii) Postage services related toparcels,luggageand bulk items use rail road and even air transport.
  iii) Post office counter services are rendered at post office counters eg sale of stamps.
  iv) Mail box rental rental service " poste restante" services, and public postal services.

The courier services

- ✓ Courier services are equally important in business since they facilitate delivery of letters parcels goods and services. etc
- ✓ Courier service provider may operate locally and internationally and therefore may help anorganization willing to use their services on.
  i) Urgent deliveries
  ii) Deliveries that need efficient handling
  iii) Delivery of fragile goods
  iv) Security of items while required.

- ✓ Competition among providers has facilitated to delivery of quality services.
- ✓ Most service providers require the sender to physical.
  i) Provide details of the sender

ii) Provide physical details of the receiver
iii) The item be wrapped to the specification of the service provide
iv) Subscribe to the right measurements
v) Pay for the item appropriate
vi) Disclose content especially where the sent items may be fragile.

Graphic communication

- ✓ Refers to the sending and receiving messages or information through graphics and graphical aids.It is the process of creating, producing and distributing materials or information or messages by incorporating words and images to convey data concepts and emotions
- ✓ The fields of graphic communication encompasses all phases of graphic communication processes from origination of the idea (design, layout and typography) though reproduction, finishing and distribution of two to three dimensional products or electronic transmissions

The advantages of graphic communication

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i. Quick way for the audience to visualize the message
ii. Offers a forceful emphasis on the main points
iii. Convincing because it tends to prove a point by seeing and hearing
iv. Compact in conveying messages
v. Attracts an extension and interest than an empty talk
vi. Uses develop expertise in computer aided graphics

TOPIC 4

ORAL COMMUNICATION

Oral communication

Definition

- ✓ Refers to the sending and receiving of messages/information by use of spoken words
- ✓ Oral communication requires that the sender and receiver (s) communicate with each other by that use of words of mouth.
- ✓ It may be carried out through, face to face interactions, interviews and meetings etc.

Advantage of oral communication

i. There is physical proximity
ii. Allow for instant exchange of ideas
iii. Feedback is immediate
iv. Easter to persuade

Disadvantages of oral communication

i. Difficult to control when large numbers are involved
ii. Lack of time to think through
iii. Lacks reference for records keeping

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The channels of oral communication

1. Telephone/mobile conversations

- ✓ Telephones are the most common and effective mechanical device for verbal (oral) communication
- ✓ With modern switch boards, more extensions have facilitated communication both internally and externally to levels of teleconferencing
- ✓ Telephones have some unique advantage as means of communication. It is immediate two way and cost effective.

Advantages of telephone

1. Saves on time facilitating instantaneous communications
2. Facilitates receiving immediate feedback
3. Telephone communication may be as effective as face to face communication effective through voice modulation.
4. Telephone communication becomes more effective than personal visits especially where people are of different ranks.
5. provides a variety of services including trunk calls, personal calls, intercom e.t.c.
6. Cost saving as opposed to travels.

Disadvantages of the telephone

i) Communication depends each other voices limiting the enhancing features such as facial expressions, gestures ,etc
ii) Easy to assume that attention is there whereas the may lack attention interest or good reception.
iii) Easily misused especially in office environments
iv) Requires instant response without giving the response without giving the receiver chance to think through
v) When calling, one may not get chance to study the mood of the receiver
vi) A telephone message does not provide a permanent record for legal purposes.

How to use the telephone effectively

1. Speak politely, confident and in a positive friendly tone
2. Always have a message pad telephone directory and appointment book near by
3. While taking hold the mouthpiece property
4. Avoid murmuring i.e. taking through the nose or teeth.
5. Don't shout into the phone or speak so low- try being neutral
6. Do not waste time with useless talks in order to save on costs.

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Guidelines of receiving/ answering the phone calls

1. Always be prepared to receive a call – to give and receive information with note pad and pen.
2. first introduce the company, the department and your self
3. say a present good morning – afternoon etc
4. be polite on any clarifications
5. use an official note pad for official messages
6. take down the name and telephone number of caller
7. note the time of call and suitable times to be contacted
8. relay the message to the person/ department the message was meant for
9. Call back if such promises were made.
10. listen carefully without interrupting the caller

Guidelines when making calls

1. Prepare mentally before dialing i.e. be clear with the message to be passed – jointing down such messages is important
2. verify that the number is correct before dialing
3. when phone is received wait for introduction of the receiver before you speak
4. speak clearly and precisely
5. ascertain clarity where a pardon is pardon is requested for
6. deliver all the details of the message and make sure it is understood
7. Return receiver gently in order not to be offensive.

The Art general conversation

- ✓ Conversations provide us opportunities for self – expression. Or pooling information or simply sharing interest
- ✓ Conversations are a two way thing involving two parties at least – it is a give and take action and reaction
- ✓ The attitude in conversations is the ability to see things from other fellow's point of view

- ✓ For effective conversations.
  - be interested in the conversations and friendly
  - be cheerful and relaxed
  - be flexible and tactful

2. Charts on –line by the use of the internet may be verbal where using visual mechanist oral communication can take place.

Face to face communication

✓ Is the most natural means of oral communication . it is one of the means of securing co-operation and resolving problems effectively . In face to face communication the ideas can be conveyed by words and gestures or expressions.

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✓ The obvious difficulty is that persona; have to move back and forth to communicate with each other.

✓ The face to face communication may take several forms such;

4. Interviews

✓ the word interview means – view between or sight between

✓ It suggests a meeting between two persons for the purpose of getting a view of each other or for knowing each other.

Types of interviews

- ✓ The selection interviews are only one kind of interviews – though it is the major one.
- ✓ Others are appraisal interviews – where one's assessment of performance is conducted.
- ✓ Grievance interview – is done to learn about the persons grievances or complaints
- ✓ Exit interviews – occurs when one is leaving or being dismissed.

Interview techniques

1. Screening – is the process of reducing the large number of applicants though selecting a few applicants. Some candidates are eliminated through preliminary interviews
2. Random appearance – occurs when all applicants are called for interviews without a screening process-on the believe that papers say a fraction. It's expensive and time consuming

3. tests – may be written or oral tests designed to judge the candidates intelligence, general knowledge proficiency in language etc
4. experience – some people believe that practical experience is more important that paper qualification
   - The main aim of this system is to eliminate fresher some who may be more brilliant enthusiastic and committed, Not the best any way.
5. under –stress- interviews – is carried out to establish how the candidate will acquit himself under exceptional stress and strain
   - he is exposed to embarrassing questions and is provoked
   - it measures temperament

The interviews preparations for an interview

The following are the main objectives;

1. Find out the most suitable candidate
2. give the candidate sufficient information about the job and the company in order to make the right decision
3. To create a sense of confidence and understanding in the selected candidate
4. To promote the goodwill of the company by giving the right kind of impression to all the candidates whether or not they are selected.

The preparation

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1. Have a clear picture of the company profile and the nature of the job for which the interview is being held.
2. Know the type of personality, character or temperament required for the job.
3. Send the interview letters well in advance to allow candidates adequate preparation.
4. Make proper sitting arrangements for the candidate in a place with minimal interruptions.
5. where interview is by committee then the bio-data of the of the candidate be pre-made available to each member of the committee
6. The committee members attending must be pre- identified and notified.

How to conduct interviews

1. welcome the candidate – with smile and friendly talk
2. contents of the interview
   a. the required information
   b. technical qualification
   c. social effectiveness
   d. emotional balance on the physical vigor and energy
   e. personal interests
   f. flexibility especially on relocations
   g. experience and previous duties
   h. remuneration
3. Parting
   - thank the candidate for attending the interviews

- promise of feedback
- important to give a specific date for feedback

How to become an effective interviewer

1. let the applicant do most talking
2. use brief verbal responses that will keep the applicant talking
3. Give entire attention to the interviewer and encourage through facial expressions, head-nods etc.
4. allow pauses to facilitate revelation of important information
5. try and understand the applicant
6. respect the feelings of the applicant wrong as they may be
7. At all times accept everything the applicant says even if they are wrong
8. avoid the impulse to cut the applicant off or change subject
9. never argue with the applicant
10. The language should be more informal.

Interviews preparations and conduct

1. know your self- i.e. brief background, inner fulfillment position in the society etc
2. Know the company you are seeking a job.
3. prepare for questions
4. prepare the questions that you would like to ask
5. dress appropriately
6. carry all papers and testimonials
7. accrue on time
8. do not be nervous or agitated while entering the interview room
9. be polite during interview
10. do not sit down until you are asked to
11. always pay attention and do not interrupt
12. give relevant answers to questions asked
13. do not make exhibitions of your knowledge
14. give your view different as they may be- they are expected
15. be positive in your attitude and be frank and sincere
16. Thank the interviews and if the job is offered to you – accepts or request for time to think about it.

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The Qualities Employers look for during a job interview

1. **Emotional Maturity**
   Employers need to have employees who are emotionally mature and who take responsibility for the quality of their work. Emotionally employees can cause problems between co-workers and are usually not team players.

2. **Dedication**
   Employers know that those employees who only take a job for the money are not usually as productive as they could be. Employers want employees who actually are interested in the jobs they have and who want to succeed.

3. **Loyalty**
   Companies look for employees who are loyal to the goals and mission of the company. This includes supporting the company and co-workers both verbally and through actions.

4. **Cooperation**
   Team players are valuable assets for any company. Employers look for employees who are cooperative, open-minded and who can take criticism well. No one wants to work with someone who is touchy and who does not work well with others

5. **High Energy**
   Employer's want to know that their employees bring energy and enthusiasm to their work place. Your attitude and energy are often reflected in the way you walk when you enter the room and how well you make eye contact.

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Reasons why you might send a thank you message to the interviewer

i. Even if you do not think you will get the job, a thank you message could keep the door
ii. Open to future opportunities within that organization.
iii. Conveys your continued interest in the job,
iv. Show appreciation for the employer's interest in you.
v. If you thought of something you forgot to mention in the interview you can mention it $_{f}$, in the thank you letter
vi. Demonstrate that you have good manners and courtesy.

How to determine the communication medium to be used for thethank you message.

- If employer seems to favor a casual, personal style a phone call might be appropriate.
- If you do not want to get into conversation and possibly have to answer more questions use e-mail.
- If employer's sty le is more formal send a short letter.

Circumstances under which an interviewee would write a letter of inquiry following job interview:

i. When the time promised by the interviewer to communicate has elapsed and you have not received any communication.
ii. If you are advised of the interview's decision by the promised date
iii. Where you have received another job offer from a-different firm,
iv. You do not want to accept the new job before you have an answer from the first.

Basic techniques of conducting an interview~

- ✓ A job interview is an employer's chance to find out not only the qualifications of a candidate, but also how's the candidate solves problems and answers questions.
- ✓ Below are the different techniques for conducting an interview that can help the employer to get specific information he needs during the interview' process.

1. Get prepared

The interviewer should review a job candidate's resume prior to the interview and make notes on the questions to ask. The questions should be written out in advance. The interviewer should also be prepared on how to react the answers to be given.

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2 Seek for *clarity*

The interviewer should ask the candidate to either repeat something important they said or clarify a point if it is unclear to him.

3 Maintain Control

The interviewer should allow the candidate to give as much information as is needed, but always maintain control of the interview. If the candidate is taking the interview in a direction he does not want to go in then he should use statements and questions to bring it back to
Where he wants it to be.

Open ended questions during an interview

Advantages

- Allows more spontaneity
- Makes phrasing easier for the interviewer
- Useful if the interviewer is unprepared
- Open-ended questions allow interviewees to give more information, including feelings, attitudes and understanding of the field they are interviewing for. This allows interviewers to better assess the respondents' true understanding on an issue/ field.

- Open ended questions help in interview flow: Closed question's that require just a ‘’yes" or ''no” response contribute little to the flow of the interview and provide minimal information.
- Open ended questions help interviewers assess candidates' initiative on researching about the organization. Candidates who have done their ’homework*' come across as resourceful candidates who are able to gather enough information to make well-informed decisions, an essential job competency.
- Open ended questions ask for a detailed answer and the interviewee has to come up with his own ideas and thoughts. This tests the critical thinking skills of the interviewee.
- Open end questions allow employer to test candidate's ability to articulate their’ previous w^{o}rk experience.

Disadvantages

- Depending upon schedule, employer may run out of time and possibly be unable to ask all job interview questions.
- Can be harder to record responses and compare different candidates.
- Candidates may take up a significant amount of time in answering open ended questions,
- Candidate may answer the questions based upon what they think the employer wants to hear instead of how they really feel.
- Possibly losing control of the interview'

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<u>Conducting</u> exit interviews

Exit interviews are interviews conducted with departing employees, just before they leave.

Advantages

- Exit interviews accelerate participating managers' understanding and experience of managing people and organizations. Hearing and handling feedback is a powerful development process.
- Exit interviews are seen by existing employees as a sign of positive, culture. They are regarded as caring and compassionate - a sign that the organization is big enough to expose itself to criticism.
- Exit interviews provide direct indications as to how to improve staff retention.
- Sometimes an exit interview provides chance to retain a valuable employee who would otherwise have left because sometimes organizations often accept resignations far too readily
- Without testing the firmness of feeling of the employee [a] Exit interviews provide valuable information as to how to improve recruitment and induction of new employees.

Disadvantages

Lack of trust:

- ✓ Even when assurances of anonymity and confidentiality are provided, some departing employees have very little trust in anyone in the agency, including staff from the human resources area.

Costly

- ✓ Exit interviews are relatively expensive to administer e.g. salary cost of the person conducting the interview

Achieving objectivity not easy

- ✓ It is difficult to objectively quantify data, particularly when several interviewers are conducting interviews at different locations.

Types of interviews:

a) **structured**

- ✓ Structured interview are sometimes referred to as a **patterned or standardized** interview . they are very straightforward interview. The interviewer have a standard set of questions that are asked of all candidates

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- ✓ This makes it easier for the interviewer to evaluate and compare candidates fairly.. The main purpose of a structured interview is to pinpoint job skills that are essential to the position.

- ✓ The aim of this approach is to ensure that each interview is presented with exactly the same questions in the same order. This ensures that answers can be reliably aggregated and that comparisons can be made with confidence between interviewees.

b) Panel.

- ✓ In a panel interview the candidate is interviewed by a group of panelists representing the various stakeholders in the hiring process, typically sitting around a conference table.

- ✓ The panel interview is a way for the organization to judge the communication level, interaction with a group arid to assess the skill level of the candidate.

1. Definition of Meetings

- Meeting are proceeding carried out by two or more people over matters of common interest which are discussed over a given period of time or
- It is a gathering of a number of people for transactions of common business or for legal purposes

  Meeting can be principally categorized into
  - Formal
  - Committee meetings
  - Command meetings

✓ Meetings are associated with time wasting but when property handled can be useful means of especially group communication.
✓ Success of a meeting will depend on.

i) A clear definition of the purpose of the meetings
ii) Distributing the agenda among all the members on time
iii) Providing the facts in advance for easy deliberations
iv) Restricting the numbers invited to the meetings

How to chair meetings

1. observe punctuality
2. clearly define the purpose of the meeting
3. begin with a positive appropriate the tone
4. be brief in your remarks
5. remain impartial
6. control emotional build-up
7. draw contribution from all members
8. control the meeting – creatively controlling the oppositions point of view
9. clarity contributions
10. make frequent summaries
11. point out decisions reached
12. point out differences
13. point out course of actions
14. Close meeting on time.

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Attending meetings

✓ Once you are invited to attend meetings make a positive contribution and the following points will assist you in performing well.

1. attend the meeting well prepared by
   a. carefully read the information circulated in advance
   b. prepare properly on written or visual presentations
   c. jot your points to sequentially present your views
2. study the other members attending the meetings
3. control your negative and accommodating
4. be conciliatory and accommodating
5. avoid lecturing, patronizing or condemning

Types of Meetings

- The ultimate control of the actions of a board of directors is vested in the members and shareholders of the company and from time to time they must meet to ratify or express their disapproval of the directors past conduct and to consider their future plans, their will is expected at general meetings by passing resolutions.

1. **Shareholders meetings**
   i. **General meetings which include**
      - Statutory meetings
      - Annual general meetings
      - Extraordinary meetings

      ✓ These meetings are called general meetings of a company because they are meetings for all the members of the company.

   ii. **Class meetings of shareholders-** these are meetings of different classes e.g ordinary shareholders or preference shareholder's meetings

   iii. **Meetings of creditors and debenture holders -**they are meetings help during the
      - life of the company
      - at the time of winding up of the company

   iv. **Directors meetings -**Can be held between the director and his immediate managers or with some other parties.

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Overview of General Meetings

1. **Statutory meetings**
   - This is the first meeting of the shareholders of a public company and is held only once in the life time of a company.
   - The meeting shall be held within a period of not less than one month from the date at which the company is entitles to commerce business.
   - T he board of directors shall at lease in 21 days before the day on which the statutory meeting is held forward a report know as the Statutory report- to every member of the company.
   - The notice of the meeting shall mention that the meeting is a statutory meeting.

The contents of a statutory meetings – report

i. the total shares allotted – distinguishing share allotted as fully or partly paid up
ii. cash received – the total amount of cash received by the company in respect of all shares allotted
iii. abstract of receipts and payments made up to date within 7 days of the report

Note: The abstract shall exhibit under distinctive headings as follows.

- the receipts of the company from shares and debentures and other sources
- the payments made their out
- the balance of cash in hand
- An account or estimate of the preliminary expenses of the company, showing separately any commission or discount paid or to be paid on the issue of shares or debentures.

iv. Directors and auditors- the names , addresses and occupations of the directors, auditors and managers and secretary and the changes which have occurred in such names, addresses and occupations since the date of the incorporation of the company.

v. Contracts – the particulars of any contract which is to be submitted to the meeting for its approval or modification.

vi. Underwriting contract- the extent to which any underwriting contract has not been carried out and the reasons thereof.

vii. Arrears of calls – the arrears due on calls from every director and from the manager.

viii. Commission and brokerage in connection with the issue or sale of shares and debentures to any director or to the manager.

The statutory report shall be certified as correct by not less than two directors of the company one of these directors shall be managing director. After the statutory report has been certified the auditors of the company shall also certified registered office of the company is situated.

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2. **Annual General Meeting**

An annual general meeting of a company may be called by giving not less than 21 days notice in writing. It may be called with a shorter notice if it is agreed to by all the members entitled to vote at a meeting.

- Annual general meeting is statutory
- Requirement it must be called even where the company did not function during the year.
- Canceling or postponing of convened meeting where an annual general meting is convened for a particular date and notice is issued to the member of the directors can cancel or postpone the holding of the meeting on that date provided power is exercised for bon afide and proper reasons. But the more proper course would be for the board of not to arrogate to itself such power, but to hold the convened meeting and then have the matter decided at the meeting.

Importance of annual general meeting

1. it is only at the AGM of a company that the shareholders can exercise any control over the affairs of the company, they can confront the directors, their elected representatives at least once a year and also get the opportunity to discuss the affair and review the working of the company
2. electing directors
3. Appointment of auditors.
4. presentation of annul accounts to the shareholders for consideration
5. declaration of dividends with AGM
6. Discussion of any other business relating to the affairs of the company.

3. Extra Ordinary General Meeting

A statutory meeting and annual general meeting of a company are called ordinary meeting. Any meetings other than these meeting it are called and extraordinary general meeting. It is called for transacting some urgent or special business with cannot be postponed till the next annual general meeting. It may be convened

- by the board of directors on its own or on the requisition of the members or
- by the requestors themselves on the failure of the board of directors to call the meeting.

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Requisites of a Valid Meeting

A meeting can validly transact any business if the following requirements are satisfied.

1. **Proper authority**: the proper authority to convene a general meeting whether statutory, annual general or extra ordinary meeting) of the company is the board of directors the board should pass a resolution to call the general meeting. If the directors do not call the meeting, the members or the company law board may call the meeting.

2. **Notice of meeting**- a proper notice of the meeting should be given to the members and all others who are entitled to attend the meeting. A notice of mot less than 21 days notice. The period of 21 days is computed for the date of receipt of the notice by the members, it exclude the day of service of the notice and the day on which the meeting is to be held. Notice is deemed to have been received by the members at the expiration of 48 hours after the letter containing it is posted.

Notice of every meeting of a company shall be given to;

a) Every member of the company entitled to vote
b) The persons on whom the shares of any deceased or insolvent members may have devoted.
c) The auditor/auditors of the company

- If no notice of a meeting is not given to every person entitled to receive notice any resolution passed at the meeting will of no effect (Young V ladies Imperial Club 1920)

- Deliberate omission to give notice even to a single member may invalidate the meeting (smth V Darley 1849) an accident omission to give notice to or the non- receipt of notice by, any member or other person to whom it should be given, does not invalidate the proceedings at the meeting. Accidental omission, means that the omission must not be deliberate case (West Canadian collieries ltd r e(1962).

Notices of meetings

For a meeting to be carried out there should be a notice to stakeholders (members) and should always state the following.

- The venue for the meeting
- The time for the meeting
- The subject
- The date for the meetings
- The day of the meeting
- The day of the meeting
- The agenda of the meetings

Case Kaye V craydon transways Co. (1898)

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A notice conveying a meeting stated that the objects of the meeting were to adopt an agreement for the sale of the company's undertaking to another company. The notice did not disclose that the directors were interested in the agreement as a substantial part of the sales proceeds was to be paid to the directors as compensation for loss of office. Held, the notice was bad as it did not fairly disclose the purpose for which the meeting was called.

The notice shall contain a statement of the business to be transacted or the meeting; the business may be ordinary or special business. In case of an annual general meeting, the following business is deemed as ordinary business.

i) the consideration of the accounts, balance sheet and the reports of the board of directors and auditors
ii) the declarations of dividends
iii) the appointment of directors in place of those retiring
iv) the appointment of auditors and the fixing of their remuneration

Special business – any business other than the ordinary business in case of an AGM is deemed special, examples of special business

- ✓ removal of rights/ bonus shares
- ✓ Election of a person (other than a retiring director

3. Quorum for meeting

- Quorum is the minimum number of members who must be present in order to constitute a valid meeting and transact business thereafter. The quorum is fixed on the articles. If the articles of a company do not provide for a larger quorum, the following rules apply.

1) 5 members personally present in the case public company (other than deemed public company) and 2 in the case of any other company of any the company for the purposes of quorum for a meeting of the company for the purpose of quorum a person may be counted as 2 or more members if he holds shares in different capacities e,g as a trustee and also in his own right.
2) If within half an hour, quorum is not present in the meeting if called upon requisition of members stand dissolved. In any other case it shall stand adjourned to the same day, place and time in the next week.
   - if at the adjourned meeting also quorum is not present within half an hour, the members present shall be the quorum.

Rulein sharp V Dawes: one person cannot constitute a meeting.

The word meeting Prima facie means a coming together of more than one person. Strictly speaking, therefore one shareholder cannot constitute a meeting. This is known as Rulein sharp V Dawes**. (1876).**

- A general meeting of a company was called for; use purpose for making a call. Only one shareholder attended the meeting. The business of the company was concerned through including a call of the shareholders D was sued for the call he has failed to pay. In his defense D argued that the call has not been validly made at a general meeting held. Once person could not constitute a meeting.

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Exceptions – cases where one person may constitute a meeting

- Where there is a class meeting of shareholders and all the shares of the a class (e.g pref. shares) are held by one person, he alone can constitute a meeting of the class and can pass a class resolution by signing it .
- Where the company law board call or directs the calling of an annual general meeting it has the powers to direct that one member preset in person or by priority shall be deemed to constitute a meeting
- Where the company law board orders a meeting of a company (other than the annul general meeting to be held, it may direct that even one member of the company present in person or by proxy shall be deemed to constitute a meeting.
- Where the board of directors delegates, subject to the provisions of the Act, any of its powers to a committee, the committee may consist any one person in such a case the only member of the committee shall constitute the quorum.
- Where a quorum is not present at a general meeting within half an hour of the meeting the meeting shall stand adjourned meeting also quorum is not present within half an hour at the time of the meeting, the members present are the quorum. In such a case even one member may constitute the meeting.

4. Chairman of the meeting

✓ This is the presiding officer of the meeting. A chairman is necessary to conduct a meeting unless the articles of the company otherwise provide, the members

personality present at provide, the meeting shall elect one of themselves to be the chairman of the meeting of a show of hands.

- ✓ The importance of the chairman lies in the fact that he is responsible for keeping order and conducting the meeting. He is the proper person to put motions to put motions to the meeting count the votes, declare the results and authenticate the minutes by his signature.

Duties of the chairman

- He must act at all times bon afide and in the interest of the company as a whole
- He must ensure that the meeting is property convened and constituted I,e proper notice has been given, the rules as a quorum are observed and his own appointment is in order.
- He must ensure that the proceedings at the meeting are properly and regularly conducted.
- He must ensure that the provision of the articles is observed and the business is taken in the order set out in the Agenda.
- He must ensure that all the business transacted at the meeting is within the scope of the meeting
- He must ascertain the sense of the meeting properly with regard to any question before it. He must do so by putting the motions in their proper form and declare the result of the voting
- He must decide incidental questions arising for decision during the meeting.
- He must exercise his casting vote bona fide the interest of the company.
- He must exercise correctly his powers and of taking a poll. He must see that any disorderly people are removed and when it is impossible to maintain order, he should adjourn the meeting. Even if the relevant rules do not give him the power to adjourn the meeting, he may do so in the event of disorder.
- He must given the members who are present a reasonable and sufficient opportunity to express their views on a notion before the meeting. He must not allow discussion except upon the motion. But at the expiration of a reasonable time he is entitled, if he thanks fit, to put a motion to the meeting that the discussion be terminated and issue decided by voting (Wall V London and Northern Asset Corporation 1898)
- He must take care that the rights of the minority are not ignored.
- Note: the way in which a meeting is to be conducted is a matter for the chairman, with the assent of the persons properly present to be determined in the light of the general law and the company's chemical industries ltd 1937.

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Roles of Secretary

A company secretary is the organization's chief administration officer. The secretary has specific duties laid down by the companies Acts and, for a public limited company. Certain minimum professional qualifications or period of experience requirements are laid down.

The secretary is the driving force of the meeting in respect of keeping records and flow of information. He/ she has duties before, during and after the meeting

a. Before the meeting

It is responsibility of the secretary to:

- Ensure that the minutes of the last meeting have been prepared well in advance for either prior circulation or distribution on the day of the meeting
- Ensure that recommendations are resolutions from the last meeting have been communicated fully or relevant persons so that all necessary follow-up action can take place.
- In consultation with the chairman, prepare the agenda for the meeting by communicating with all committee/ board members and anyone else who has responsibility of bringing matters to the meeting
- Ensure that those preparing working papers for the meeting make these available in good time for preparation and circulation prior to the meeting, or for laying round the table at the meeting itself.
- Prepare an aide-memoire for the chairman setting out detail on agenda items and including information such as who it to lead the discussion on each item.
- Record any pre-meeting comments from committee/ board members on matters arising from the minutes.
- Notify time. Date, venue and proposed duration of the meeting- these details are normally sent out with the agenda
- Prepare the meeting room
- Record apologies for absence received in advance
- Deal with pre-meeting queries from committee/board members.

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b. During the meeting

✓ At the meeting, the secretary should;

- Have all previous minutes and other records available during the meeting .
- Have a formal copy of the minutes ready to be signed by the chairman once the content has been approved by the meeting
- Note whether a quorum (minimum number of members) is present for the meeting to convene
- Make comprehensive notes on all matters discussed so that a true and accurate record for proceedings can be made afterwards.
- Advise the chairman on any constitutional aspects of the meetings.

c. After the meeting

- ♦ As soon as the meeting is finished, the secretary should write up the minutes while they are fresh in his/her mind. On matters which are not absolutely clear, he/she should liase with the chairman to ensure that his/her understanding is correct.
- ♦ In addition to these responsibilities at meetings, a company secretary has additional duties such as registration of company documents and communication with shareholders.

5. Minutes of the meeting

- Minutes are a record of what the company and directors do in the meeting every general meeting and of all proceedings of every meeting of its Board of directors and of every committee of the board. This is done by making within 30 days of the concerned, entries of the proceeding in the books kept for than purpose.

6. **Minutes Book –** this is the book in which the record of the proceedings of a meeting is kept separate minute books are required to be kept for shareholders general meeting of the company and directors meeting and also for committee meetings of the board of directors.

Use minutes

1. This is the book in which the record of the decision of the shareholders and directors at their respective meetings
2. they are available for inspection by interested parties e,g shareholders, directors, secretary, auditors (shareholders are usually allowed to inspect only the general meetings minutes book)
3. They can be purchased as evidence of the proceedings in a court of law.

Contents of minutes of board meetings

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1. the names of the directors present at the meetings
2. in case of each resolution passed at the meeting the names of the directors dissenting from the resolution

Note: the chairman has a right to exclude from the minutes any matter which are defamatory irrelevant immaterial or detrimental to the interests of the company. He has an absolute discretion in this regard.

Evidentially value of minutes

- Minutes of meetings kept in accordance with the provisions shall be evidence of the proceedings recorded therein and shall be conducive of the facts stated therein.

Case: Kerr V John Mottram Ltd. (1940)

- An extraordinary general meeting of a company was summarized in order to offer for sale to the members' shares over which the company had lien. The plaintiff claimed that he was the highest bidder for a block of shares and therefore, there was a contract for the sale of such shares. The minutes of the meeting did not show that any such contracted was entered into held. The minutes were concluded evidence of the facts stated.

Location and inspection of minute books of general meetings.

- The minute books containing the minute of the proceedings of any general meeting of a company shall be;
    - kept at the registered office of the company
    - open during business hours to the inspection of any member without change subject to reasonable restrictions. However at least 2 hours each day are allowed for inspection
    - a member shall be entitled to be furnished within 7 days of this request to the company with copies of minutes on payment of such sum as may be prescribed.

Conferences Meetings

✓ To confer is to converse to consult, to discuss so a conference refers some meetings at which people exchange views and talks together. The conducting of a conference is similar to a committee only that conferences are more informal than meetings

✓ A conference may be held to discuss the problem of a given company and give suggestions – but such suggestions are not binding .Departments may hold conferences to exchange views, educative conferences etc and any views expressed during the conference are then forwarded to top management.

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✓ Conferences may be held to give training to employees on policies, social responsibility etc. Since conferences are similar to committees refer to the advantages and disadvantages of group communication discussed above.

Advantages

a) conferences disseminate information
b) stimulate creativity flow of ideas
c) facilitate pooling ideas and experience
d) help define problems and provide possible solutions
e) they promote public relations
f) They enhance the organization prestige and image
g) The y enhance public attention and the government on particular issues/problems.

Disadvantages

i. They are expensive to conduct such that the results may not justify the costs.
ii. The problems tend to get generalization and specific problems may therefore not be attended to.
iii. A few people may dominate discussions hence presenting their views and not necessarily groups views
iv. The discussions are looked at pleasure than business hence lacks seriousness.

x) Committee meetings

✓ There are different types of committees: namely

a) Executive committees

✓ The executive committee of an organization is generally elected from its members at its annual general meetings
✓ Its powers are specified by its parent body and it is required to give an account of its activities at regular interviews.
✓ The executive committee is empowered to give decisions in day-today matters in the light of broad organizational goals.

b) Advisory committees

✓ These committees consist of experts or people representing different groups or interest. Their sole function is to advice and do not have any say in the implementation decisions nor do they enjoy any right to vote.

c) Standing and ad hoc committee

✓ A standing committee is permanent is nature and is empowered to take management decisions e.g..credit finance committees e.t.c. are examples.
✓ Ad hoc committee – is constituted for either
  i. A specific period
  ii. A specific purpose – upon completion
✓ The committee stands dissolved e.g. re or automation committees

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d) Formal and informal committees

✓ A formal committee is formally formed – in writing and its constitution is formal, their duties and responsibilities are specified and spelt out.
✓ There function formally and in a regular fashion.
✓ Informal committees are formed for the purpose of collective thinking with no fixed agenda nor formal authority.
✓ Their recommendations are not a formal decision and are more in the nature of advice.

e) Line and staff committee

✓ The staff committee is a kind of advisory committee that appraises the management on the views of employees
✓ The line committee has power to take decisions with regard to the employees who are responsible to it.
✓ The line committee isa kind of executive committee.

The advantages of forming committees

- ✓ Offer expert operations
- ✓ Help to generate new ideas
- ✓ Feedback is available
- ✓ Employer – employee relationships are improved
- ✓ The employees interest can be safeguarded
- ✓ Committees draw out latent talents
- ✓ Committees promote co-ordination
- ✓ Committees give valuable training to junior executives
- ✓ Committee achieve consolidation of authority
- ✓ Committees transmit information uniformity.

Disadvantages

i.) delays in decision making
ii.) irrelevant discussions
iii.) expensive to set and maintain
iv.) undesirable compromises
v.) responsibility is split
vi.) minority tyranny

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Why committees fail

1. Poor leadership
2. overbearing leadership
3. lack of compliance with formal procedures
4. inadequate or large membership
5. undesirable or incompetent membership

How to make the committee work effectively

1. properly define the scope or terms of reference
2. choose a competent membership
3. properly select the subject to be delt with
4. chairman be effective and effect play role

Agenda and minutes of the meeting

- ✓ Agenda is a document that outlines the content of a forthcoming meeting. It is usually along a notice of a meeting

- ✓ Minutes are the official records of the proceeding of a meeting. They constitute a permanent record of the decision and actions of a constituent body and serves as reminder of the subjects previously dealt with and the conclusions reached

- Once approved and signed, they are acceptable in a *court* of law as evidence of the proceedings All organizations, whether commercial or social, or a joint stock company must maintain proper records of meetings

- For joint stock companies section 145 of the companies Act makes it compulsory for every company to maintain minutes of the proceedings of every general meeting and meetings of the board and its committee minutes must be precise, and should not offer a vibratation report of the proceedings of the meeting.

- The main objective of writing minutes is to preserve a concise and accurate record of the essential work done at the meeting

✓ For every company to maintain minutes of the proceedings of every general meeting and meetings of the Board and its committees,

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Types of minutes

Minutes are of two type's i.e.

- Minutes of resolution
- Minutes of narration

i**. Minutes of resolutions**

- In this type of minutes only the resolution passed at the meeting are recorded and no reference is made to any discussions preceding the resolution
- There is no mention made even of the movers and the seconder's of the resolution
- Nevertheless the minutes are clear and complete in themselves and contains all the relevant details which are self-explanatory

ii. Minutes of narration

- Minutes of narration are somewhat similar to a report. Here in addition to the resolutions passed a brief account of the discussions and the *voting* pattern is also included.

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Maintenance of minute books

- Every company is required to maintain minutes of the proceedings of every general meeting and every meeting of the Board and its committees
- Separate minute books are maintained for different kinds of company meetings
- Entries are made in the minute books within thirty days of the conclusion of a meeting
- The pages of the minute books are consecutively numbered
- Writing the minutes on a loose piece of paper and then passing it on the minute book is prohibited Indexing of minutes
- For easy location of any particular **decision, minutes are usually** numbered and a subject index maintained at
- the back of the minutes books
- Numbering may be done in two ways. Every ***item on*****the** agenda is assigned a number. Whenever a reference is made to a particular decision, the date of the meeting ***m*****which** that decision was taken is looked up in the agenda book and then the minutes of that meeting are consulted
- Or the minutes are numbered consequently throughout the minute book and an alphabetical index is prepared
- Only special decisions likely to be referred to in future are indexed and not routine items

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Signing of minutes

- Each page of every minute book must be initiated or signed and the last page of the minutes of each meeting must be dated and signed by the chairman
- In case of minutes of Board Meetings and the meetings of their committees the minute book must be signed by the chairman of the same meeting or the chairman of the succeeding meeting
- In case of theminutes of the general meeting, they should be signed by the Chairman of the same meeting within a period of thirty days of the conclusion of the meeting
- In case the chairman may be unable to sign within that period on account of^ death or disability, they may
- be signed by a director on duty authorized by the Board.

- **How to**write**minutes**

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- Minutes of each meeting must have a heading containing the nature of the meeting
- The date, time and place at which the meeting is held should be mentioned
- In the case of general meetings of the company as well as board meetings, it is

usual to give the number of the meeting :-

- The minutes should contain the names of those present and their capacities. Absent with apologies and those absent
- To facilitate reference to any particular item in the minutes a brief appropriate heading or marginal note should be given. Each heading or marginal note should be numbered ***S*** While writing minutes,'n6 reference should be made to the feelings of the person present the tone should always be impersonal. Reported speech should be preferred and as far as possible passive verbs be used
- Dates, figures should be precisely and clearly mentioned. If reference is made to certain letters or reports their numbers and dates should also be mentioned. This eliminates the possibility of ambiguity and misunderstanding
- If a special resolution is to be passed by a given majority this fact should be entered in the minutes. Infact, the minutes should record the number of those in favor and those against the resolution
- The Secretary should go on taking notes when meetings are going on and seek clarifications immediately
- It is advisable for the secretary to show rough draft, of the minutes to the chairman and get his approval.
- The language of the minutes should be kept as simple as possible
- It may range from a short, almost fragmentary, statements of facts on a single page to a more developed presentation taking several pages ***S*** An informal report is usually submitted in the form of a letter or memorandum

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Oral presentation and public speaking skills

- Presentation constitutes an important aspect of doing business in modern times
- An entrepreneur needs to learn how to give good presentations not only to any interested business partners, investors but even to customers.
- Oral presentation has of late found a big boost from computer literacy and has really boosted the presenters engagement, ability to inform, invitation etc
- Developing and delivering oral presentations or business presentations are a learned skill and a person should strive to learn the formula, practice the skill and eventually will gain the competency
- The essence of presentation is to convince and therefore the presenter must borrow heavily from that part of communication known as persuasive communication

Persuasive communication

- Persuasive is a form of social influence and persuasive communication is the process of guiding people towards adopting an idea attitude or action by rational and symbolic (though not only logical)means
- It follows a problem solving strategy and rallies on appeals, logical reasoning rather than force

The main features of persuasive communication

Creditability

- Refers to ones capability of being believed
- A confident speaker or presenter gives an impression of delivering creditable and trustworthy information eg speaking while maintain eye contact with the listener

Logical argument

- Logical argument is more convincing where the speaker emotion eg through raising of voice when disagreeing

Psychological appeal

- When the presenter or speaker seems dull or irrelevant the
- Information is overloaded (too much for the listener)
- Information cannot be understood
- There is noise during presentation
- There will be communication break down

Speeches and Listening skills

- **Speech-**Spoken words with great power. This can stir people and at the same time dis-spirit them. They can turn hostility to friendship

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Characteristics of a good speech

i. A good speech should be clear such that ideas are properly conveyed to the audience with the emotions, facts arguments you need to relay
ii. A good speech should be more informal expressing a friendly tone
iii. It should be vivid and concrete with facts easily to comprehensive and visualize
iv. It should be brief not lasting more than 20 minutes
v. It should be interesting with a torchy of human and a quotation of authorities
vi. It should be i.e.
    - audience oriented
    - degree of specialization
    - the size of the audience
    - the age group
    - the social, religious and political views

A profile of a good speakers

1. A good speaker is lively, interested and enthusiastic with the feeling of the audience
2. A good speaker is earnest i.e. He does not speak for the sake of speaking or show-off
3. A good speaker has a sense of responsibility to his listeners and realizes that time is precious
4. A good speaker has a sense of responsibility to others on the days programme
5. A good speaker has a sense of responsibility to his subject i.e. he does not bite off more than he can chew

6. A good speaker has a sense of leader-ship he stands tall he talks eye to eye and speaks responsibly with authority
7. A good speaker is confident and keeps his head up
8. A good speaker tries to be balanced and with good sense of humour

Planning to speak

i. Research your topic thoroughly clearly spelling out the main points
ii. Plan the speech in three main points
   - Introduction should arouse the interest of the audience
   - The middle should be devoted to the discussions
   - Conclusion should summarize the main points
iii. Time your speech to make sure it's neither too long nor too short
iv. Look for some suitable quotations if possible
v. Arrange your points in such a way that strong points are kept at the beginning
vi. Tailor your speech to the intellectual level and the general taste of the audience
vii. Make sure that your delivery is god and it is desirable to rehearse your speech

The main characteristics of an effective speech

1. **Precision**

- The speech should be simple, precise and to the point
- A good speech does not require a long period of time during presentation

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2. **Confidence**

- Speak like nobody is around, focusing on the idea you are delivering
- Accept the fact that not all will have to listen to you good as you may be

3. **Make eye contact**

- Create connection, and attracts attention with the audience

4. **Let the audience participate**

- This helps the presenter to assimilate with the audience, and the audience warms up to the message

The stages of oral presentation

- When planning any presentation the presenter must consider the following

The preparation stage

- Determine the purpose of oral presentation
- Know exactly what is required and expected when presenting
- Know the period duration the presentation must take
- Know the types of visual aid required
- Analyze the audience in terms of their expectations their education, age, value, gender etc.

The research stage

- Research on the topic and gather enough information regarding the topic
- Prepare a rough draft of the oral presentation based on the information gathered
- Develop any visual aid relevant for the oral presentation and makes sure they are working eg
    - Power point
    - Graphs
    - Vedio clips

- Practice the presentation, timing ones self in order to adjust to the time available

Delivery stage

- The presenter should check to ensure that all notes visual aids are in place before the presentation
- Speak clearly during presentation more slowly than usual and not too loud or too soft
- Maintain eye contact with the larger part of the audience
- While delivering e presentation use proper information for emphasis, questions an statements
- While using audio-visual aids , always try to address the whole audience
- The presenter should put their head up to help voice projection and control of audience

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The follow up stage

- Allow the audience time to make comments and ask questions
- Reflect on the strengths and weakness of th e oral presentation to enable improve next performance (watch video to help)
- Seek evaluation from any colleagues or interested party to point on areas you did and those to be improved

The principals of effective use of visual aids in presentations

- ✓ Visual aids helps people understand the message of a presentation more clearly leaving a lasting image and impression than what is only heard
- ✓ The presenter can use slides, photos, power point presentation handouts or simple while board to add visual cues to a presentation

i. Simplicity

Visual aids should be simple and should contain only one message

ii. Cost

It should be economical and present explainable material

iii. Participants be given wiring materials and copies of graphic presentations for reference

iv. Use local photographs and examples when discussing general problems and issues

v. Determine the difference between what you will present and what the visual aid will show (do not read straight from your visual aid)

vi. Use charts and graphs to support numerical presentations

vii. Develop sketches and drawing s to convey various designs and plans

viii. Graphics should not be too crowded in details and not too much colour

ix. Do not use visual aids for persuasive statements, qualifying remarks emotional appeals etc

x. When using handout, be careful not to distract your presentation and should only reinforce your presentation

xi. Practice the use of presentation so that you avoid any shame
xii. Seek feedback on the clarity of the visual aid in order to make any adjustments

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When planning presentations

- In creating the presentation, one should think like a reporter and answer the following
  i. Who
  ii. What
  iii. Why
  iv. How and
  v. Where questions

The who question

- Addresses the audience attending and the number attending
- Their age, education level, and relationship
- This will help establish the scope and types of visual aid required

The what question

- Will address the purpose of the presentation
- Help find out any supporting materials
- Search for any solutions that may required
- Gain consensus or advice
- Create a detailed understanding of the matter

The why question

- Will address the expectations of each person attending

- Establishing what is there for each
- In order to generate satisfaction

The how questions

- Addresses how the information being presented should look like
- Short points that are concise
- Requirements of visuals to reinforce the presentation
- The necessary questions to posse to allow interactions

The where questions

- Addresses the location or place the presentation will take place
- The sitting arrangement sand rom set up impact a lot on the audience
- Will a projector flip chart, power points be needed
- Microphone, is there a podium etc

The format of a presentation

1. A presentation will have an opening that will capture the audiences attentions. This section should take 10 to 20 % of the total time allocated
2. The body has a series of points with each point begging with a statement of fact followed by supporting materials. This should take between 65-75% of the time allocated
3. The closing is the ending which contains a review or summary and a call to action. It will take between 10-20% of the timeallocated

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Tips for successful presentation

- ✓ It is encouraged that each point the presenter makes be clearly stated illustrated and supported.
- ✓ The presenter should act as though the audience is not at all familiar with the topic an should not assume anything
- ✓ Avoid any jargon and devote a similar time to each point so that the audience is not miss-led on choosing what is important
- ✓ Points should be arranged in a logical order
- ✓ Plan the time for presentation properly, opportunity time proper on the opening body and closing
- ✓ Points should be made clear and concise
- ✓ Speak clearly using simple language
- ✓ Use visual aids that can be seen by all the audience
- ✓ End the presentation on time

Building confidence

- ✓ Nervousness is healthy- it shows that the presentation is important and calls for one to know as much as he/she can ahead of time in order to gain confidence
- ✓ One should rehearse till he/she is comfortable with the material

Tips on how to control nervous, jitters

1. The presenter should realize that people want him to succeed
2. Relax by taking a deep breath when getting nerves
3. The presenter should use good posture to gain more power and energy
4. The presenter should concentrate on the message not on how he is coming to cross
5. The presenter should use eye contact convening the entire audience
6. The presenter should turn nervousness to positive energy
7. Forget being perfect and no apologies

Listening

- ✓ Listening is an important aid to communication and bad listeners. Make up bad communicators. A sent researcher should know that 63% of the Americans time is spent listening, while 4% on reading and 22% speaking

- ✓ The main purpose of listening included:-
  - To obtain information
  - To solve problems
  - To share experience
  - To persuade or dissuade

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Advantages of listening to an organization

i. Listening helps to know the organization
ii. Listening helps to make better policies
iii. Listening mollifies complaining employees
iv. Listening is important for the success of the open-door policy
v. Listening helps sport sensitive areas before they become explosive

Effects of poor listening to an organization

i. Passing or inaccurate and incomplete information
ii. Problems would not be clearly understood and therefore would remain unsolved
iii. Difficulty of sharing, information and experience
iv. Difficulty of persuading or dissuading
v. Lack of co-operation and constant mis-understandings

How to become a good listener

i. Concentrate on what the speaker is saying rather than how he looks
ii. Repeat the key ideas yourself while listening
iii. Relate to the speakers remarks to your personal background and experience
iv. Do not let your mind wonder away from what the speaker is saying
v. Listen with a positive altitude rather than setting a disagreeing mind

Examination questions

1.
   a) Discuss the characteristics of a good speech
   b) Explain the points a speaker should bear in mind while drafting a speech

2.
   a) Briefly discuss the steps in planning a talk
   b) You have been asked to address a seminar – on the role of a small and medium enterprises in the economic development – draft an appropriate speech for the occasion

3
   a) You have been asked to address a seminar on price rise and consumer problems. Draft an appropriate speech for the occasion
   b) A supervisor in your company has retired after serving the company forty years. He is being given a farewell by your staff association. Draft a suitable speech for the occasion

4.
   a) Draft a vote of thanks to mark the end of a two- day seminar on the problems of book publishing

5.
   a) Briefly discuss the importance of listening in communication
   b) Explain ways a person may learn the art of listening

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6. Discuss how to make formal presentation

Stages of listening process

- ✓ Listening is actually a complex of processes and skills and so it's convenient to divide the listening process into stages or steps. This is a five-stage mode and seems to get at most, if not all of the essential listening processes and. more important, enables us to identify the relevant skills at each stage. Here five stages are identified: Receiving, understanding, remembering, evaluating, and responding.

i)Listening at the Receiving Stage

- ✓ The first stage in the process of listening is receiving the message, At this .stage you listen not only to what is said (verbally and nonverbally) but also to what is omitted. You receive, for example, your boss's summary of your accomplishments as well as the omission of your ' shortcomings or, perhaps, vice versa. Effective reception, then, consists of receiving what is as well as what is not said. Here are just three suggestions for

Improving your listening reception:

1. Focus your attention on the speaker's verbal and nonverbal messages or what is said and on what isn't said. Avoid focusing your attention on what you'!! say next; if you begin to rehearse your responses,' you'regoing to miss what the speaker says next
.
2. Avoid distractions in the environment; if necessary, shut off the stereo or and turn off your cell, phone. Put down the newspaper or magazine, close your laptop.

3. Maintain your role as listener and avoid interrupting. Avoid interrupting as much as possible, it will *only* prevent you from hearing what the speaker is saying. This is not to , imply that you should give feedback cues- -minimal verbal or nonverbal responses ("1 see," "you're right," head nodding, widening ofyour eyes)—that say, [4]Tm listening."

iii) Listening at the Understanding Stage

- ✓ The second stage of listening is understanding the message. That is, after receiving the message, you process it; you extract the meaning from the message. You can improve your listening understanding in a variety of ways.

- ✓ Avoid assuming you understand what the speaker is going to say before he or she actually says it. If you do make assumptions, these will likely prevent you from accurately listening to what the speaker wants to say.

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- ✓ See the speaker's messages from the speaker's point of view. Avoid judging the message until you fully understand it as the speaker intended it.

1. Ask questions for clarification, if necessary; ask for additional details or examples if they're needed. This shows not only that you're listening—which the speaker will appreciate—but also that you want to learn more. Material that is not clearly understood is likely to be easily forgotten.

2. Rephrase (paraphrase) the speaker's ideas into your own words. This can be done silently or aloud. If done silently, it will help you rehearse and learn the material; if done aloud, it also helps you confirm your understanding of what the speaker is saying and gives the speaker an opportunity to clarify any misunderstandings.

Listening at the Remembering Stage

- ✓ The third stage of listening is remembering the message. It would help little if you received and understood the message but didn't remember it
- ✓ If you want to remember what someone says or the names of various people, this information needs to pass from your short-term memory (the memory you use, say, to remember a phone number just long enough to write it down) into long-term memory (or relatively permanent memory).

- ✓ Short-term memory is limited in capacity—you can hold only a small amount of information there. Long-term memory is unlimited. To facilitate the passage of information from short- to long-term memory, here are FOUR suggestions:

Improving listening remembering

1 Focus your attention on the central ideas, Even in the most casual of conversations, there are central ideas. Fix these in your mind. Repeat these ideas to yourself as you continue to listen. Avoid focusing on minor details that often lead to detours in listening and in conversation.

2 Organize what you hear; summarize the message in a more easily retained form, but take care not to ignore crucial details or qualifications. If you chunk the material into categories, you'll be able to remember more information. For example, if you want to remember 15 or 20 items to buy in the supermarket, you'll remember more of them if you group them into chunks—say, produce, canned goods, and meats,

3 Unite the new with the old; relate new information to what you already know. Avoid treating new information as totally apart from all else you know. There's probably some relationship and if you identify it, you're more like to remember the new material.

4 Repeat names and key concepts to yourself or, if appropriate, aloud. By repeating the names or key concepts, you in effect rehearse these names and concepts, and as a result you'll find them easier to learn and remember, If you're introduced to Alice, you'll stand a better chance of remembering her name if you say, "Hi, Alice" than if you say just "Hi.''

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Listening at the Evaluating Stage.

- ✓ Once you've received, understood, and have the message in memory, you need to evaluate it. After all, not all messages are eo.ua!—some are lies, some are truths; some are significant, some are trivial; some are constructive, some are destructive. In evaluating messages consider these suggestions.

- ✓ Resist evaluation until you fully understand the speaker's point of view. This is not always easy, but it's always essential. If you put a label on what the speaker is saying (ultraconservative, bleeding-heart liberal), you'll hear the remainder of the messages through these labels.

- ✓ Distinguish facts from opinions and persona! Interpretations by the speaker. And, most important, fix these labels in mind with the information; for example, try to remember that Jesse thinks Pat did XYZ, not just that Pat did XYZ.

- ✓ Identify any biases, self-interests, or prejudices that may lead the speaker to slant unfairly what is said. It's often wise to ask if the material is being presented fairly or if this person is slanting it in some way.

- ✓ Recognize fallacious forms of "reasoning" speakers may use. Some of the more popular ones are:
    - Name-calling: applying a favorable or unfavorable label to color your perception "democracy" and "soft on terrorism'' are two currently popular examples.
    - Testimonial: using positively or negatively viewed spokespersons to encourage your acceptance or rejection of something—such as a white-coated actor to sell toothpaste or a disgraced political figure associated with an idea the speaker wants rejected.
    - Bandwagon: arguing that you should believe or do something because "everyone else does

Listening at the Responding Stage

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- ✓ After you evaluate the message, you're likely to respond in some way. And, of course, a speaker expects a response. Here are just a few suggestions for improving you're responding to another's messages.

    - Support the speaker throughout the speaker's conversation by using (and varying) listening cues, such as head nods and minimal responses such as "I see" or "mm-hmmm." Using the 'like'' icon, poking back, reposting, and commenting on another's photos or posts will also prove supportive.

    - Own your responses. Take responsibility for what you say. Instead of saying, "Nobody-will want to do that" say something like 'i don't want to do that." Use the anonymity that most social networks allow with discretion.

    - Resist "responding to another's feelings" with "solving the person's problems" (as men are often accused of doing) unless, of course, you're asked for advice. Oftentimes, people simply want to vent and just want you to hear what they have to say.

    - Focus on the other person. Avoid multitasking when you're listening. Show the speaker that he or she is your primary focus. You can't be a supportive listener if you're also listening to a CD, so take off the headphones; shut down the iPhone and the television; turn away from the computer screen. And, instead of looking around the room,, look at the speaker; the speaker's eyes should be your main focus.

- Avoid being a thought-completing listener who listens a little and then finishes the speaker's thought. This is especially inappropriate when listening to someone who might stutter or have word-finding difficulties. Instead, express respect (and a real willingness to listen) by giving the speaker time to complete his or her thoughts. Completing someone's thoughts often communicate* the message that nothing Important is going to be said ("I already know it").

The types of listening skills

Appreciative listening

- ✓ In appreciative listening, we seek certain information which we appreciate. The information sort helps meet our needs, expectations and goals .We use appreciative listening when we are listening to good poetry leaders etc

Selective listening

- ✓ Selective listening involves listening for particular things and ignoring others
- ✓ In this listening people choose to hear what they want to hear and pay little attention to extraneous detail

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Critical listening

- ✓ In evaluative listening or critical listening we make judgments about what the other person is saying
- ✓ We seek to assess the truth of what is being said. We also judge what they say against our values assessing them as good or as bad worthy or unworthy

Full listening

- ✓ Full listening happens where the listener pays close and careful attention to what is being said, seeking carefully to understand the full content that the speaker is seeking to put across.
- ✓ This may be very active form of listening, with pauses for summaries and testing that understanding is complete. By the end of the conversation, the listener and the speaker will probably agree that the listener has fully understood what was said
- ✓ . Full listening takes much more effort than partial listening, as it requires close concentration, possibly for a protracted period. It also requires skills of understanding and summary.

Relationship Listening

- ✓ The purpose of relationship listening is either to help an individual or to improve the relationship between people. Therapeutic listening is a special type of relationship listening. Therapeutic listening brings to mind situations where counselors, medical personnel, or other professionals allow a troubled person to talk through a problem

- ✓ . But it can also be used when you listen to friends or acquaintances and allow them to "get things off their chests:' Although relationship listening requires you to listen for information, the emphasis is on understanding the other person

Deep listening

- ✓ Beyond the intensity of full listening, you can also reach into a form of listening that not only hears what is said but also seeks to understand the whole person behind the words.

- ✓ In deep listening, you listen between the lines of what is said, hearing the emotion, watching the body language, detecting needs and goals, identifying preferences and biases, perceiving beliefs and values, and so on.

Measures to 'improve your listening skills

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- Minimize both internal and external distractions
- Adjust your listening skills to the situation
- When you are listening to a friend with a problem, demonstrate empathy.
- Don't interrupt. Let the person finish what he is saying before you explain your point.
- Show your listening by your non-verbal communication. You might nod, shake your head, or even at times raise you eyebrows.
- Stay focused on the subject matter. Train yourself to always concentrate.
- Don't prejudge a person message by the way he looks.

Barriers of effective listening

i) Interrupting the speaker

- ✓ Ways such as not allowing speakers to complete his/her thought
- ✓ Impatience to wait for the other party to complete
- ✓ A feeling that the other party is talking too much

ii)Jumping into conclusions

- ✓ Caused by filling in the mind what you think the other person is saying and assuming that you have understood
- ✓ Taking things more personal generating mis-understanding

iii)Strong emotions

- ✓ Strong feeling on the subject may prevent good listening and have a prejudiced judgment

iv)Physical barriers

- ✓ occasioned by tiredness or discomfort, hunger, very cold weather or hot weather

v)Desire to talk

- ✓ with the aim of being at the center of attention, or simply believe in your opening alone.

vi)Mind wandering

- ✓ thinking ahead of all things etc

vii)Distractions

- ✓ because of noise etc

viii)Dislike of the speaker

ix)Closed mind

- ✓ thinking of knowledge of subject matter or your position being the correct position

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Unethical practices in communication

1. **Plagiarism**
   - ✓ Occurs whenever a person uses another person's ideas instead of giving credit to the source person decides to own the idea and get credit
2. **Bias**
   - ✓ Occurs whenever a person or group intentionally presents information that unevenly favor's or discredits one side
3. **Propaganda**
   - ✓ Occurs where individuals or groups may wish to persuade their audience to think or act in a certain way, but using terms or language that have a negative connotation on the other party.
4. **Fallacies**
   - ✓ Occurs when reasoning is flawed or contains logical errors
5. **Red hearing**
   - ✓ Diverting the listeners attention to another unrelated issues
6. **Hasty generalization**
   - ✓ From selection of a few

Circumstances oral communication is preferred to written communication

1. Where human relationships should be established which requires team spirit and a sense of mutual responsibility
2. Where the sender needs an immediate response
3. Where the sender needs to assess the reactions of the recipient upon receipt of the information
4. Where communication should be fast
5. Where information is confidential and secret
6. Where broad explanation are required

Distinction between an order and instructions

- ✓ Orders are directives without options or personal inputs or contributions while instructions are guidelines which give room for personal judgment and input

- ✓ Instructions allow
  - o Elaboration and open up ideas
  - o Thinking through
  - o Decision making

Ways of improving orders

1. Be upfront with the orders allowing for flexibility for their input
2. Be direct with right words and language so that you are on the same wavelength with receiver
3. Check for clarity of understanding and that he order can be re-stated
4. Be consistent and allow task be finished before assigning new instructions

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Factors that contribute to communication breakdown across cultures

1. **Cognitive constraints**
   - o These are the frames of reference or world views that provide a back drop that all new information is compared to inserted into
2. **Behavior constraints**
   - o Each culture has its own rules about proper behavior which affect verbal and non-verbal communication e.g.
   - o A look straight to the eyes, proximity when communication expression of fear
3. **Emotional constraints**
   - o Different cultures regulate display of emotions differently some are very emotional, high tone slow in talks etc than others
   - o Others cultures hide emotions, exhibits and share rational factual aspects than others

Features of a good feed back

1. Feedback should be specific and should relate to behavior
2. Timing of appropriate time to give feedback ie if negative give as advice and if positive give immediately
3. Check to make sure that clear communication has occurred ie proof understanding by receiver before expected feedback
4. Focus on behavior for any change that may occur
5. Be honest and ensure that any criticism is contractive and not confrontational
6. Share the good and bad
7. Look to the future and establish common goals and vision

OTHER CHANNELS OF COMMUNICATION

The other channels of communication include:-

Visual communication

- ✓ Visual communication refers to the presentation of information by use of diagrams and pictures without the use of words. The following are the main channels of visual communication

1. **Organization charts**
   - ✓ These are diagrams which show the whole organization structure of the firm
   - ✓ They may indicate functions, departments and their sections or posts
   - ✓ Organization charts may be presented in a vertical or horizontal format

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2. **Photographs**

   - ✓ Photographs may be half – tone or continuous tone, in colour. They are reprographic processes including copying machines by which photographs can be produced

3. **Films**
   - ✓ These are normally 16mm and can be hired, borrowed from certain organizations or purchased. They are recorded events presented motional

4. **Graphs signals and wall charts etc.**
   - ✓ These are used to illustrate an explanation and present statics information

5. **Posters**

✓ Posters fall under visual communication and posters are important in the following ways:-

- In places or businesses where workers are illiterate e.g. factories posters are used to educate the workers in efficient performance, machine operation and safety measures.

- On roads posters are used to give road signs and traffic signals as well as suggest the hazards of irregular and rash driving
- Posters have become a very effective means of advertising in banks, airports waiting halls.

- **How to make poster more effective**
  i. Since most posters whether displayed outdoors or indoors are seen only for a short time – they must tell the story simply and quickly and therefore ;-
     - The burden of communication should be put mainly on the photos
     - Copy be reduced to a headline or subheading with a few words

  ii. In postures advertising, the sales message should be repeated many times at different locations so that the disadvantage of having just a moment glance at it is set off
  iii. The posters should be displayed in such a way that their layout is artistic appealing and visibility is adequate
  iv. Proper attentions should be paid to the color-scheme of the posters – the use of soothing colors such as blue and green may be appropriate – grey and brown project a natural rhythm.

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The techniques of speaking
- Try to sound authoritative, sincere and enthusiastic i.e. interest on the speech
- Use cues to give you clue of the main points rather than reading the entire presentation
- Address your audience directly – do not look down on the floor
- Your stance, posture and gestures are important in delivering well your presentation

The importance of rehearsals in presentations
- To indicate approximated time of delivering
- Opportunity to make alterations of point not very good
- Give change of practice
- Assess ones delivery techniques
- Facilitate learning the use and effectiveness of any visual aids that may be used
- In order to learn overhead the basic content and structure of one's presentation
- Verify the speech delivery and tone to be used

8. Audio-visual means of communication
- Audio –visual communication combines the auditory and the visual, that is while people are observing something on TV they are also hearing the narrative or descriptive aspects.

How to make audio-visual communication effective
i. The pictures, slides and films should be
   - Imaginatively produced
   - Blend colors with discretion

- The lay-out should be effective

ii. The description and narrative should be:-
   - Brief but adequate
   - Supplementary to the visual effect

iii. The films and slides be shown to the people at a suitable time

iv. Keep in view education, economic levels, social and cultural background of the audience

Visual means of communication that could use in an enterprise

1. **Block diagrams**
   - To explain complex concepts and show relationship among their components in an enterprise
2. **Flow charts/organization charts**
   - To show sequences and branch login within a process or procedure in an organization
3. **Use of diagram**
   - To show employees tasks and relationship of tasks
4. **Mind maps**
   - Categories concepts and show relationships
5. **Comics**
   - Can communicate process and explain complex concepts
6. **Swim lanes**
   - Show complex flows and logic that cross over functional boundaries

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The advantages of using visual aids in presentations

i. Strengthens clarity of the speakers messages
ii. Increases interest on the speakers information
iii. Makes explanations a lot easier
iv. Enhances the speakers credibility
v. Can improve the speakers ability to persuade
vi. Helps reduce fear or fights

Principals of effective use of visual aid

i. Simplicity – visual aids should be simple with the messages only
ii. Economical – in terms of cost and should present the audience with a read or listen but not both
iii. Provide paper copies of the material being presented for any references by audience
iv. Determine the differences between what is visual and what is said
v. Do not crown out graphics or numerical items for clarity to be achieved
vi. Do not use visual aids for persuasive statements, qualifying remarks emotional appeals etc.
vii. When using handouts, be careful not to cause visual destructions
viii. Develop sketches and drawings to convey various designs or messages

Improving note taking

- Have a clear purpose
- Recognize the main ideas
- Identify the information relevant to your tasks
- Develop a system of note taking comfortable
- Reducing the information to note in a diagram format
- Information should be put in your own words where possible
- Record the source of information
- Use symbols and abbreviations when speed is required
- Develop a system of symbols and abbreviations best known to you
- Be consistent when using symbols

Mechanical communication

- Refers to the process of transmitting or sending messages or information by the use of mechanical instruments such as radio, television, hearing devices, speech impairments devices, computer, telephone etc.

Mechanical communication barriers

- ✓ The mechanical communication barriers are technical sources of interference in the communication process

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- ✓ A mechanical barrier stems from a problem in the machinery or the instruments used to transmit the message. They include:

  - Noisy communication machines or instruments
  - Absence of means of communication instruments
  - Transmission interruption
  - Power failure
  - Technical barriers

Noise in communication

- ✓ Noise refers to anything that interferes with a message being transmitted from a sender to a receiver
- ✓ Noise may result from internal sources or external sources

Types of noise

- ✓ There are four types of noise i.e.

1. **Physical noise or environmental**
   - Is external to the speaker and listener includes construction noise, people making noise, tracks and other motor vehicles

2. **Physiological noise**
   - Refers to physiological issues that may interfere with communication e.g.

migraines, outside expectations or pain, blindness, memory loss

3. **Semantic noise**
   - Occurs when there is no shared meaning in communication e.g. medical professional or scientist who may use terminologies that lay people may not understand

4. **Psychological**
   - Refers to mental noise that may interfere or prevent one from listening e.g. stress , love, irritation (emotions – wondering thoughts or daydreaming)

Types of external noise

✓ External noise refers to that noise which emanates from outside the listeners body in contrast to physiological and psychological noise

✓ Eternal noise is also called environmental or physical noise and tends to affect neighborhood they include:-

- Barking dogs or other noisy animals
- Security alarms
- Celebrations and music
- Motor vehicles noise etc.

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Other noise factors that affect communication

1. Literal noise occur in locations which are congested, bus terminals, manufacturing companies
2. Linguistic interferences caused by language differences, cultures dialect etc.
3. Culture interferences which creates a clash in sensitivity, points of view, value
4. Media confusion – i.e. the quality of media tools infiltrations, networks congestion etc.
5. Internal noise such as :-
   - Questions reputations and creditability of the sender
   - Prejudice e.g. racism, sexism, etc.
   - Assumptions of all kinds
   - Stereotypes i.e. believed thoughts about gender races positions etc.

How to improve internal communication

- Establish a common culture so that both the company and the employees have common goals and missions
- Use right communication tools e.g. emails, internet etc.
- Establish a communication policy to help define direction time and channels of communications

Common sources of noise in a wireless communication channel

- Power disruption
- Device malfunction i.e. unexpected faults

- Temperature that may affect terminals
- Frequency interferences especially through overloads
- Climate conditions e.g. rains

How to overcome noise barriers

- Eliminate or reduce the noise
- Raise speech volume to allow ease of listening
- Listen actively i.e. pay close attention to the speakers works
- Use clear and straight forward language

Technical barriers

✓ Arise from the negative impact of technology in communication they include

1. Language technicalities especially when communicating through internet
2. Organizational tech. barriers such as the use of computers, telephones, cell phones secrecy of information etc.
3. Physical technical barriers – i.e. reduce contact, physical interactions and mutual nurturing

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TOPIC 5

NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Non-verbal communication Refers to the process of communicating through the sending and receiving wordless messages

Non-verbal communication can be communicated through;

- haptic communication i.e. gestures and touch
- by body language or posture
- by facial expression and eye contacts
- object communication such as clothing hairstyles, architecture, symbols and infrographics
- paralanguage such voice quality emotion and speaking style
- prosodic features such as rhythm, intonation and stress
- dance is also regarded as a non-verbal communication
- Written texts have non-verbal elements such and handwriting style, spatial arrangement of words or the use of emotions.

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The functions of non-verbal communication

- ✓ There are five primary functions of non-verbal communication. i.e.

  a. express emotions e.g.. care, love, anger, sadness
  b. express interpersonal attitudes e.g.. in situations of avoiding embarrassments
  c. to accompany speech or verbal communication in managing the cues of interaction between speakers and listeners
  d. it is used to self- presentation of one's personality
  e. rituals such greetings
  f. May be used to conceal deception – non-verbal communication makes it easier to lie.

Verbal Vs oral communication

- ✓ Scholars in this field usually use strict sense of the term " verbal" – meaning of or concerned with words and do not use " verbal communication as a synonym for oral or spoken communication.
- ✓ Thus vocal sounds that are not considered to be words such as singing a wordless, note are non-verbal
- ✓ Sign languages and writing are generally understood as forms of verbal communication as both make use of words, although like speech both may contain paralinguistic elements and often occur alongside non-verbal messages
- ✓ Non-verbal communication can occur though any sensory channels as

a) Sight
b) Sound
c) Smell
d) Touch
e) Taste

- ✓ When we speak or listen our attention is focused on words rather than body language. But our judgment includes both.
- ✓ An audience is simultaneously processing both verbal and non-verbal cues
- ✓ Body movements are not usually positive or negative by themselves rather the situation and the message will determine the appraisal
- ✓ Non-verbal communication was called " the expression of the emotions in man and animals " by charles Darwin"

The characteristics of non-verbal communication

1. the non-verbal messages primarily communicate emotion attitudes e.t.c.
2. the non-verbal cues substitute for contradictions, emphasize or regulate verbal messages
3. non-verbal cues are often ambiguous
4. non-verbal cues are more reliable
5. Non-verbal cues are culture bound.

The main channels of non-verbal communication

1) Arbitrariness

- ✓ While much non-verbal communication is based on arbitrary symbols which differ from culture to culture, a large proportion is also to some extent iconic and may be universally understood.
- ✓ Examples are facial expressions of anger disgust, fear, joy, sadness and surprise are universal.

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2) Clothing and bodily characteristic

- ✓ Elements such as physique, height, weight, hair, skin colour, gender, and clothing send non-verbal messages during interactions.
- ✓ Studies carried out in the UK found that taller people were prone to promotions than shorter people.

3. Physical environment

- ✓ Environmental factors such as furniture architectural style, interior decorations, lighting, conditions, colour, temperature, noise and music affect the behaviour of communicators during interactions.
- ✓ Some of the channels of physical environment non-verbal communication include;

i) **Proxemics – (the physical space in communication**

- ✓ Proxemics is the study of how people use and pursue the physical space around them.
- ✓ The space between the sender and the receiver of a message influences the waythe message is relayed and interpreted

- ✓ The perception and use of space varies significantly across cultures and different settings within culture
- ✓ Space in non-verbal communication may be divided into four main categories i.e.
    - Intimate
    - Social
    - Personal
    - Public space.

✓ The term territoriality is used in the study of proxemics to explain human behavior regarding personal space – which identifies

- Primarily territory – which refers to an area that is associated with someone who has exclusive use of it. E.g..a house that people can only enter with the owner's permission.
- Secondary territory- here there is no right of occupancy, but people may still feel some degree of ownership of a particular space e.g..seat or position of sitting.
- Public territory- refers to an area available to all but only for a set period e.g. parking space or a seat in a library.
- Interaction territory –is space created by others when interacting e.g..when people are interacting on a walk path people tend to go round them rather than distribute them.

a)

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ii) chronemics – (time in communication)

- ✓ chronemics is the study of the use of time in non-verbal communications. The way people perceive time, structure time and react to time is a powerful communication tool, and helps set the stage for communication.
- ✓ Time perceptions include punctuality and willingness to wait, the speed of speech and how long people are willing to listen.
- ✓ The timing and frequency of an action as well as the Tempo and rhythm of communication within an interaction contributes to the interpretation of non-verbal messages.
- ✓ Others include;

a) Monochronic times

- ✓ A monochronic time means that things are done at a time, and time is segmented into precise small units
- ✓ Under this system time is scheduled, arranged and managed. Example the U.S is considered a monochronic society- " time is money"

b) Polychromic time- a polychromic time system is a system where several things can be done at once, and more fluid approach is taken to time consuming.

✓ The system is less focused on the preciseness of accounting for each and every moment.

- ✓ The system is more deeply steeped in tradition rather time tasks
- ✓ They have all the time in the world.

4) Movement and body position (kinesics)

✓ Is another form of non-verbal communication. The term kinesics is used to refer to the study of how people communicate through postures, gestures, stance and movements.

a)**Postures** – can be used to determine a participant's
- degree of attention or involvement
- the different in status between communicates
- The level of fondness a person has for the other.

b)Gestures -express meaning and may be articulated with hands, arms, or body. They also include movements of the head, face, eyes such as winking, nodding or rolling one's eyes.

b) **haptics** – is the study of touching as non-verbal communication

i. Touches that can be defined as communication include handshakes, holding of hands, kissing, back stabbing, pats and brushing an arm.

c)**Oculesics(Eye role/ Gaze)**
- Is the study of the role of eyes in non-verbal communication
- Eye contact can indicate interest, attention and involvement
- Gaze comprises the actions of looking while lacking, looking while listening amount of gaze, and frequency of glances patterns blinks e.t.c. send enough information.

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5. Paralanguage (non-verbal cues of the voice) prosodic feature

✓ paralanguage is the study of non-verbal cues of the voice

✓ Various acoustic properties of speech such as tone , pitch and accent, collectively known as (prosodic features) all give off non-verbal cues.

✓ Paralanguage may change the meaning of words I.e. the

i) Voice set- is the context in which the speaker is speaking – this can include the situation gender, mood, age and person's culture.

ii) Voice qualities – are volume, pitch, tempo , rhythm, articulation, accent

1. They give each individual a unique voice print.

iii) Vocalization – consists of three subjections characterizers, qualifiers and segregates.

1. characteristics are emotions expressed while speaking such as laughing, crying, yawninge.t.c
2. a voice qualifier is the style of delivery a message e.g.. yelling
3. Vocal segregates such as uh-huh notify the speaker that the listener is listening.

iv) Dances

✓ Also included are dances – as a non- verbal communication channel – it requires conceptualization creativity and is a means of self-expression or explains situations.

6) Written texts (Communication)

- ✓ Written communication includes letters, circulars, memos, telegrams, reports, minutes, forms and questioners, manuals.
- ✓ Everything that has been written and transmitted in writing form full I, the area of written communication.
- ✓ The non-verbal aspects or elements of written communication include;
    - i) The style of presentations
    - ii) Special arrangements of words
    - iii) The use of emotions
    - iv) The use of positions or ranks
    - v) The handwriting e.tc.

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TOPIC 6

PUBLIC SPEAKING

INTRODUCTION

Public Speaking is defined as the process of communicating with a large group of audience.

Let us understand the meaning of public speaking with the help of a very simple example:

Tim was the managing director of XYZ industries. Tim wanted to circulate the company policies to all his employees and everyone directly or indirectly associated with his firm. Neither he wanted to send an email nor he had the time to call all his employees and explain the rules and regulations individually. He finally decided to call all his employees on a common platform and address them. The impact was definitely much more as Tim could personally meet all his employees and yes even the staff members were really happy as the message came straight from their top Boss. Queries were addressed and nobody could blame each other later on. This act of speaking to a large group of people with an intention of informing them about something is called as public speaking. Public speaking helps you communicate directly with your target audience at a single time.

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The most important thing in public speaking is selecting the right topic. The agenda needs to be very clear. Do not just call people for the sake of it unless and until you are absolutely clear as to what you intend to communicate. Personal issues need not to be discussed on a public forum. If John has a personal problem with any of his team members, then does he need to call all the employees for a public meeting? Absolutely NOT. Remember, public speaking plays an important role only when the topic is related to all and everybody needs to be informed of the same. Make sure you choose the right words while addressing people. One wrong word and you are gone. No one would believe you in future.

Be very confident while addressing people. Do not forget to make an eye contact with your audience. It helps you establish a relationship with them. There are people who look here and there while speaking. Such a practice needs to be avoided at all cost. Be precise and crisp. It is foolish to play with words on an open forum. Do not unnecessarily cook stories but come to the point immediately. No one really has the time to listen to your stories. A public speaker needs to be smart and intelligent enough to understand the reactions as well as moods of his audience. Dragging the session unnecessarily is of no use.

Maintain a smile on your face. There is no need to be nervous if you know what you have to speak. Remember, public speaking is an art. Not everyone is born with public speaking skills. It comes with time. Be extremely careful of your pitch. Be neither too loud nor too soft. There are people who speak only for the people sitting in the first row. Speak clearly and make sure you are audible even to the people sitting on the last bench.

Dress appropriately. You just can't afford to wear a tattered jeans and a T shirt while addressing your office people. They will never take you seriously.

Make the session interesting and interactive. Ask questions in between and do give time to your audience to ask questions and clear their doubts.

The venue, sound system, dais, lights also are important aspects of public speaking. Make sure you have a proper auditorium or a conference hall for addressing people where they can sit comfortably. Stand on an elevated platform where everyone can see you clearly.It helps.The microphone and other sound system must be in proper working condition.

Role of Communication in Effective Public Speaking

Communication plays an essential role in public speaking. There is a difference between speaking to someone in private and connecting to a large audience. Believe me; you fail as a speaker even if one individual in the audience goes back with the slightest doubt in his/her mind. Your job as a speaker is incomplete unless and until individuals return with a smile on their face. Effective communication in fact is the backbone of public speaking.

Effective communication ensures the message reaches the audience in its correct and desired form. Communication is incomplete if the recipients are not aware as to what the sender intends to speak. Speak clearly and make sure your content is relevant and makes sense. You may speak in any language but your audience needs to understand your thoughts and ideas. Choose the correct words in your speech. Avoid using jargons and slangs in official communication.

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Speak with confidence. Your communication needs to motivate your audience to follow what has been discussed in the seminar or conference. Support your content with practical examples so that people can relate it with their daily lives.

Two way communication is of utmost importance. A scenario where only the speaker speaks and others either sleep or fiddle with their cell phones is not the ideal one. People sitting in first two rows are generally attentive but what about those who are on the last benches? Trust me, in most of the cases they are lost somewhere else. An individual is considered to be a good and effective speaker only when questions and queries come from even the last benchers. Motivate your audience to ask questions in between. It is always better to revert later if you are not clear on something rather than lying.

Style of communication also plays an important role in public speaking. There are very few individuals who really bother about their pitch and tone. What is the use of an excellent presentation if it is not communicated well? Speak loudly but clearly. You do not have to shout but make sure you are audible to everyone. Check with your audience whether they can hear you clearly or not? Do not forget that you are not speaking for yourself but for everyone sitting in the room.

Do not try to copy others. Inspiration is alright but problem arises when people try to blindly follow their colleagues or bosses. Every individual has his/her own style and it is always better to stick to it. Speaking with a fake accent is a strict no no in public speaking.

Allow people to express their ideas and opinions. Do not expect a yes in everything you say. A session is effective only when every individual sitting in the forum agrees to the terms, conditions, policies and so on discussed in the session. Forcing your ideas on your audience does not make sense in today's business scenario.

One needs to prepare well before a session but you just can't predict everything your audience might ask. It is practically impossible to jot down everything you intend to speak. Fluency is of utmost importance and it comes with thorough practice. No one is born with effective communication skills but trust me, it comes with hard work, time, dedication and of course practice.

Use the right tenses. Take extreme care of your grammar. Take care of punctuation marks. Give pauses in between. For effective communication it is important to develop eye contact with your audience. Enrich your vocabulary. It helps in public speaking. Take care of your body language as well.

Preparing for Public Speaking

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The art of connecting to a large audience refers to public speaking. In today's fast paced world where everybody is so busy chasing targets, it is really not feasible for the employers to discuss each and every issue with their employees in private. Public speaking helps people touch base with a large number of individuals at a single time.

Public speaking is not that easy as it sounds. One needs to practice really well for the same.

The first and the foremost step towards preparing for public speaking is to be very clear about the agenda. Ask yourself as to why do you need to address people? Do not call people just for the sake of it. Once you are clear with the topic, do as much research as you can. Remember, your audience can ask you anything under the sky. You can't skip every question.

Thorough knowledge about the topic to be discussed is in fact the key to an effective session. There are speakers who prefer taking notes/bullet points to the session. I do not say that it is a wrong practice but reading only from the notes is certainly not acceptable and expected out of a good and professional speaker. Why are you the chosen one to represent your company in front of all the employees in case you just have to read out notes? In fact anyone can do the same. Understand that eye contact is a crucial aspect in public speaking. It helps you connect with your audience instantly and more over people also take you seriously. Remember, one needs to be spontaneous and it comes only when you yourself are clear as to what you intend to speak. You can take few points just in case you have a bad memory but always try to make your session an interactive one for better results. Be prepared for the worst questions. Surf various informative websites, read related books, articles, notes and gather as much relevant information as you can. Support your content with live case studies, practical

examples and authentic data. You can also make a nice presentation to share with your audience but make sure your presentation highlights only the key points. Presentation is always in bullets and you just do not have to include paragraphs and stories in it.

Practicing well is another step towards preparing for public speaking. Never be over confident. Give your presentation in front of either a friend or colleague whom you trust and who is capable of giving you honest and correct feedback. Incorporate the changes as suggested .If you cannot find someone, stand in front of the mirror and speak. It works! It helps you realize your mistakes and shortcomings.

Dressing appropriately helps you carve a niche of your own and leave an everlasting impression. You really do not have to wear your bridal outfit but yes wear something you yourself are sure of. Wear comfortable clothes and no casual clothing to formal presentations. A white shirt with a black fitted trouser is the ideal combination. Wearing a tie or not is entirely your choice. Do not wear belts with a broad and flashy buckle. Girls should not wear dresses with a deep neck revealing their cleavage. Dress decently and most importantly neatly. You do not have to put layers of make up just because you have to address people on a public forum.

Divide your speech in parts and be very careful about your time limit. There is no point in unnecessarily dragging a presentation. If your time limit is two hours, make sure you assign some time for your own and company's introduction, the actual content and also for question answer round in the end. Be very confident and believe in yourself.

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Role of Effective Public Speaking in Career Growth

Public Speaking refers to the art of communicating with a large audience. Public speaking definitely plays an important role in one's career.

Let us go through the role of public speaking in career growth:

Being a public speaker indeed makes you a popular face in your organization.

Let us go through two situations:

Tom worked really hard and never believed in bunking office. He was an introvert who remained glued to his computer most of the times and hardly interacted with his fellow workers or participated in extracurricular activities. He did meet his targets but never really bothered to attend office parties or address his juniors. Very few people knew Tom and his Bosses hardly spoke to him.

Jack, on the other hand, did not work as hard as Tom but always stayed in the limelight. He willingly participated in seminars, conferences and was an excellent speaker. He had excellent communication skills and made best possible use of the same. In no time, he became extremely popular in the office and everyone knew him by his name. Though he did miss his targets sometime, but he was always in his superior's good books.

Who do you think was more successful?

Obviously Jack. Jack in a very short span of time became the team leader and got excellent perks and benefits. Tom suffered as nobody not even his Bosses knew that he was indeed a diligent worker.

When you address, say hundred people together on a common platform, people start recognizing you and acknowledging your talent. When you do something apart from your routine work not only your colleagues but also superiors notice you immediately. You climb the success ladder quickly if you are a familiar face among the management. Public speaking helps you acquire confidence – a must for every professional. It helps you get rid of fear, nervousness and you start believing in yourself.

Public speaking inculcates the habit of reading in individuals which goes a long way in acquainting them with the latest developments in their respective fields. One has to meticulously prepare notes/bullet points for the presentations and thus knows what is happening around. Professionals develop the habit of surfing informative websites and as a result come across several useful things which is not the case when people stick to the nine to five routine job.

For an individual to do well professionally, he/she needs to communicate effectively. Not everyone is born with effective communication skills but one can certainly master the same with time and practice. Public speaking plays a crucial role in improving your communication skills. No one can explain the importance of two way communication better than a public speaker. Your communication with your Boss will not yield results unless and until he/she understands what you intend to communicate. Public speaking in true sense makes you an effective communicator- one of most important keys to success.

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Public speaking helps you respect deadlines . Trust me, if you learn how to deliver within the stipulated time frame, nothing can stop you from being successful. You are generally allotted a time frame and you have to finish your presentation within that time frame. Dragging a presentation unnecessarily is useless. If you are allotted say two hours for your presentation, not only you have to finish with the actual content but also assign some time for question answers.

Public speaking inculcates managerial as well as leadership skills- again two very important skills in the professional world. It is no joke standing in front of a large number of people and making them listen to you. You learn how to become a role model for others and how to motivate people to act according to you.

Role of Confidence and Attitude in Public Speaking

Confidence and attitude play an essential role in public speaking. One needs to be confident in front of his/her audience to create an everlasting impression. Remember, your audience would not take you seriously unless and until you believe in yourself. Nervousness only indicates either you are lying or not sure of what you intend to communicate.

What is confidence? What is the difference between being confident and over confident? You really do not have to overreact or use a fake accent just to show that you are confident. Trust me; by doing so, you would spoil the show. What is the need of copying others? Aren't we capable enough to handle our audience? You really do not need to worry if you know you are correct. Self confidence is crucial in public speaking. Confidence reflects in the way you carry yourself. Some people are good communicators but when it comes to addressing a large number of people, they lose confidence.

Problems such as stage fear, nervousness disappear when you have confidence in yourself. There must be something in you and that is the reason why your superiors have asked you to address a large audience. Self confidence comes only when you know the agenda well and the purpose of the presentation is clear. Why do you think the people would believe you if you yourself are not sure of your content? Remember, convincing people is definitely not a cake walk. But yes, the situation becomes easier when you are confident enough to not only convince others but also make them listen to you with rapt attention and also act accordingly.

Public speaking is not everyone's cup of tea. Not every individual is comfortable standing in front of a large audience, making eye contact with them and delivering his content. Positive attitude plays an important role. Some people have the habit of cribbing on everything. If your Boss walks up to you and asks you to address a group of say 50 employees, what would be your immediate reaction? Some people would definitely not like the idea and come up with several excuses to avoid the same. Where is the problem? Trust me, the problem is nowhere but in our attitude, the way we see things. Professionally it always helps to look at the brighter sides of things. Remember, cribbing leads to no solution.

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An individual who accepts challenges with a smile is the one who climbs the success ladder within the shortest possible time frame. Do not make an issue of every small thing. One needs to stay positive. It not only reduces stress but also helps you deliver your hundred percent. The job of a public speaker is to ensure that his/her audience has understood what was discussed at the session. **Positive attitude helps you concentrate and also stay calm**. Keep a smile on your face. Positive attitude plays an essential role in helping you connect with your audience. Even if someone asks you a silly question, why do you have to be rude with him? Never find faults in others. You need to understand that if an individual has invested his time or probably money in attending your session, he /she has full rights to clear all doubts and go back home happy and satisfied. People with a negative attitude generally find it difficult to adjust with fellow workers. Learn to accept your mistakes. Do not feel bad if someone points out your mistake. Instead make sure you do not repeat them in future. Positive attitude helps you deal with criticism and face critics.

Role of Dressing in Public Speaking

Dressing plays an essential role in public speaking. It is the way you dress which speaks volumes about your personality and confidence. A public speaker needs to dress as per the occasion, time and season. If you are addressing your office colleagues during the office hours, it is essential to stick to formal dressing.

You may be an excellent speaker, may have excellent content but, if you are shabbily dressed, no one would at the first place like to listen to you and if at all they do, they would forget you as well as your speech the moment you leave the place.

Dress smartly. Casual dressing is a strict no no in office presentations. Do not wear something which will make you feel uncomfortable. Some people do wear tattered jeans and T shirt for office sessions and presentations. Such dressing works only when you are addressing a group of friends or probably your relatives or anyone you do not share a very formal relationship. Trust me, wearing the right clothes makes you confident and you generally feel good from inside. Dressing casually also means that you generally are not serious towards the whole idea of addressing people and eventually your audience also find it extremely difficult to concentrate on the event. In such a case, they would attend the seminar and listen to you just for the sake of it.

Dressing correctly helps you create the first impression among your audience. As they say "First impression is the last impression" and it definitely matters a lot. Tom had excellent public speaking skills. He somehow became over confident and once went shabbily dressed to address his team members. Neither did he bother to iron his clothes nor polish his shoes. Not only his team members who once used to take TOM very seriously made fun of him but also never bothered to pay attention to what he was saying. They also avoided his sessions in the future. Such is the importance of dressing in public speaking. Since Tom was not neatly dressed, the audience perceived him to be a lazy and careless person who did not bother to take care of his own clothes. How would such a person take care of the team or for that matter entire organization?

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One needs to dress correctly for a pleasing personality. **Dressing as per the occasion definitely gives you an edge over others**. Do not overdress. Females need not to look like a makeup box while addressing people. Remember, no one has asked you to look like a bride or for that matter a film actress. In this way, you would attract the attention of people but for all the wrong reasons. The overall idea is to look neat, tidy and presentable. Do not wear revealing clothes to presentations. If you believe, exposing would guarantee a huge crowd, you are sadly mistaken. Such cheap tactics do not work in professional scenario. Men should avoid wearing gaudy shirts or ill fitted trousers for presentations. Do not forget that dressing sensibly plays an essential role in earning respect for you. Dressing plays an important role in public speaking as it certainly reflects your seriousness towards job and life in general as well as your upbringing, thought process and overall attitude.

Make sure your shoes are polished and hair neatly combed. This is also an important aspect of right dressing. The best way to avoid blunders in dressing is to see yourself in the mirror before stepping out for sessions. Remember, dressing correctly will not only make you an excellent speaker but also a favourite among audience.

PRESENTATION SKILLS

Presenting information clearly and effectively is a key skill to get your message or opinion across and, today, presentation skills are required in almost every field.

Whether you are a student, administrator or executive, if you wish to start up your own business, apply for a grant or stand for an elected position, you may very well be asked to make a presentation. This can be a very daunting prospect. Our guide is designed to help.

If, in this position, the first thing you do is open up PowerPoint, then you should probably first spend some time developing your presentation skills. Delivering an inspirational or captivating presentation requires a lot of preparation and work, and you may not even need PowerPoint at all!

Many people feel terrified when asked to make their first public talk, but these initial fears can be reduced by good preparation which will also lay the groundwork for making an effective presentation.

What is a Presentation?

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A presentation is a means of communication which can be adapted to various speaking situations, such as talking to a group, addressing a meeting or briefing a team. To be effective, step-by-step preparation and the method and means of presenting the information should be carefully considered.

Preparing a Presentation

Preparation is the single most important part of making a successful presentation. This is the crucial foundation and you should dedicate as much time to it as possible avoiding short-cuts.

Not only will good preparation ensure that you have thought carefully about the messages that you want (or need) to communicate in you presentation but it will also help boost your confidence. Our pages: Boosting Confidence and Time Management may be useful additional resources as you prepare your talk.

The Objective

You have been asked to speak to a group of people. First, ask yourself 'why?' What is the purpose of the presentation, what is the objective, what outcome(s) do you and the audience expect?

It is useful to write down the reason you have been asked to present so you can use this as a constant reminder while you prepare the presentation. There are many reasons for giving a

presentation or talk, but never lose sight of your objective as determined when you were asked and accepted the invitation.

The Subject

The subject of what you are going to talk about comes from the objective but they are not necessarily one and the same thing.

For example:

- The subject may be given to you by an inviting organisation.
- You may be knowledgeable in particular field.
- The subject may be entirely your choice within certain limitations.

The Audience

Before preparing material for a presentation, it is worth considering your prospective audience.

Tailoring your talk to the audience is important and the following points should be considered:

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- The size of the group or audience expected.
- The age range - a talk aimed at retired people will be quite different from one aimed at teenagers.
- Gender - will the audience be predominantly male or female?
- Is it a captive audience or will they be there out interest?
- Will you be speaking in their work or leisure time?
- Do they know something about your subject already or will it be totally new to them? Is the subject part of their work?
- Are you there to inform, teach, stimulate, or provoke?
- Can you use humour and if so what would be considered appropriate?

The Place

It is important to have as much advance information as possible about the place where you are going to speak.

Ideally, try to arrange to see the venue before the speaking event, as it can be of great benefit to be familiar with the surroundings. It does much to quell fear if you can visualise the place while you are preparing your talk. Additionally, it would also give you the opportunity to try out your voice. If at all possible, you need to know:

- The size of the room.
- The seating arrangements and if they can be altered.

- The availability of equipment, e.g., microphone, overhead projector, flip chart, computer equipment.
- The availability of power points and if an extension lead is required for any equipment you intend to use.
- If the room has curtains or blinds. This is relevant if you intend to use visual aids, and so that you can ensure the correct ambiance for your presentation.
- The position of the light switches. Check if you need someone to help if you are using audio/visual equipment and need to turn off the lights.
- The likelihood of outside distractions, e.g., noise from another room.
- The availability of parking facilities so you do not have a long walk carrying any equipment you might need to take.

The Time

Often there will be no flexibility in the time of day that a presentation is made.

Length of Talk

Always find out how long you have to talk and check if this includes or excludes time for questions.

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Find out if there are other speakers and, if so, where you are placed in the running order. Never elect to go last. Beware of over-running, as this could be disastrous if there are other speakers following you.

It is important to remember that people find it difficult to maintain concentration for long periods of time, and this is a good reason for making a presentation succinct, well-structured and interesting. Aim for 45 minutes as a maximum single-session presentation.

TOPIC 7

GROUP AND TEAM COMMUNICATION

Working in Groups and Teams

Being in groups is part of everyday life and many of us will belong to a wide range of groups, for example: family groups, social groups, sports groups, committees, etc.

This page concentrates on groups that have been specially formed to fulfil some purpose, or groups that are a drawing together of people with shared experience. This type of group is often also referred to as a team.

What are Groups and Teams?

There is some confusion about the difference between a group and a team; traditionally academics, communication and management theorists use the terms: group, group-working, group-interaction, group-structure etc. to refer to the dynamics of people working together towards a common cause.

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The word group however has a broader meaning – a group of passengers on a flight have a common characteristic – to travel, but they are not necessarily working towards a common cause. Groups do not even need to refer to people, for example, a group of products in a supermarket, in this case the group is arbitrary and could be defined by any number of variables.

A team is generally more specific. We would not refer to our airline passengers as a team, unless they crashed on a desert island and needed to work together to survive. The distinction is that a team is working together for a common cause. A group of schoolchildren may be in the same class, whereas a team of schoolchildren may be working together on a specific project within the class.

When we talk about groups and teams we use the terms interchangeably – it is possible to have a group without a team but not a team without a group. Although we use the word team throughout our pages we use the following definition of group:

A group is a collection of people with some common characteristics or purpose.

- A group can consist of any number of people.
- People in groups interact, engage and identify with each other, often at regular or pre-determined times and places.
- The group members share beliefs, principles, and standards about areas of common interest and they come together to work on common tasks for agreed purposes and outcomes.

- People in groups are defined by themselves and by others as group members, in other words individuals are aware that they are part of a group.

Types of Groups

Groups may be formal, brought together for a particular purpose, or they may be informal such as family groups, groups of friends or colleagues. You may come into contact or work with a range of different groups.

These types of group may include:

Work Groups: Either formal, such as teams, committees or training groups, or informal maybe setup to tackle an ad-hoc problem.

Neighbourhood Groups: An example of a neighbourhood group would be one established to develop local amenities.

Social Groups | Special Interest groups: These are groups established to meet the needs of a particular sector (e.g. age group, gender) or interests (e.g. music or sports). Examples include Women's Institute and Scouts.

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Self-Help Groups: Such groups are often established to work through particular emotions or to provide support for people with a certain illness, e.g. helping to overcome an addiction such as Alcoholics Anonymous.

Inter-Agency Groups: These are developed between agencies/organisations that work in related fields to improve product and/or client services. In addition, they aid communication and establish joint ventures to prevent duplication and confusion.

Pressure Groups: The function of pressure groups is to challenge the status quo, often by using high profile tactics to gain media attention to achieve their aims.

Task-Based and Experience-Based Groups

Groups can also be sub-divided in two ways:

Groups established to carry out specific tasks are known as task-based groups, such as a pressure groups.

Groups which are based on the experiences of their members are known as experience-based groups, such as a self-help group.

The distinction between task-based groups and experience-based groups is important because it affects how the group is formed, organised, led and what roles the individual group members play.

Task-Based or Content Groups

These types of group focus on the achievement of specific goals and the individual members of the group work towards completing these goals. These types of group are common in organisations and include groups set up to work on specific projects – perhaps the design of a new product.

Experience-Based or Process Groups

These types of group focus on the individual group members and how they interact, support and grow together, an example would be a group established to support people suffering from stress.

Group Communication

When people are part of a group they interact and communicate in different ways to how they would on a one-to-one basis.

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These differences include:

The Individual Member within a Group

Through networking within a group people come to a greater understanding about other group members and the wider environment – seeing things from other people's point of view. Also, within a group situation, people often learn about who they are and their strengths and weaknesses through comparison with other group members.

Groups are important to personal development as they can provide support and encouragement to help individuals to make changes in behaviour and attitude. Some groups also provide a setting to explore and discuss personal issues. A group setting can allow people to become more confident and learn new interpersonal, social and practical skills through observation as well as practice. These skills can be developed within a group setting and then effectively used in individual situations. As group membership can improve self-esteem and confidence so it can also improve self-motivation and the desire to learn and develop.

The Group as a Whole

From the experience of belonging to different groups, it quickly becomes obvious that groups are often made up of individuals with very different personalities, attitudes and ideas. For a group to function well a bond needs to be developed so that individual differences can be used for the wider interests of the group. 'Cohesiveness' is the term used to describe this mutual bonding between members, with each having a strong sense of belonging to the group.

Cohesiveness is, in part, the measure of the success of the group. A group with more cohesiveness is more likely to keep its members than that of a group with little cohesiveness. Members of a high-cohesive group are likely to talk in group terms, using 'we' instead of 'I' when talking about group activities. The more cohesive a group the greater the sense of team spirit and the more individual members will cooperate with each other. A low-cohesive group may find that members frequently miss meetings; sub-groups or cliques may form within the original group and there is likely to be an underlying sense of frustration as the goals of the group are less likely to be attained.

Communication Networks

Network Functions

- Organizations have their origins in communication networks. The functions of communication networks include:
  - Providing the means for coordinating the activities of individuals, relationships, groups and other subunits within the organization.
  - Providing mechanisms for directing the activities of the organization as a whole.
  - Facilitating the exchange of information within the organization, and
  - Ensuring the flow of information between the organization and the external environment in which it exists

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Network size

- One important differentiating characteristic of organization **is the size.** An increase in the number of individuals in a social unit dramatically increases the number of reciprocal communication linkages that are possible and necessary to connect the persons involved. This is a problem of major proportion within large organizations.
- In small groups, people can generally talk to whom they wish, about what they wish.

Internal Networks: Message flows within organizations

- **Downward Message Flows** formalized the lines of information that flow within organizations correspond closely with the lines of authority. The most familiar pattern of formalized information flow is from management to employees. Messages flow downward from persons in positions of relatively greater authority to others in the organization who report to them directly or through others. Messages transmitted downward generally serve one or more of the **following functions:**
  - 1) Specifying a task to be performed
  - 2) Providing instructions about how to perform a task
  - 3) Providing information about the reason for a particular task that needs to be performed
  - 4) Providing information about organizational policies or practices
  - 5) Providing information about an employee's performance and /or
  - 6) Providing information about the organization and its mission.

Upward Message Flows

It is channeled from subordinates to superiors. Upward communication has several functions, including :

1) Providing input for decision making

- 2) Advising about subordinates' information needs
- 3) Providing information regarding subordinates
- 4) Providing a potentially constructive outlet
- 5) Allowing superiors to assess the effects of previous downward communication and,
- 6) Helping subordinates cope with problems and facilitating their involvement

Horizontal Networks

- Horizontal communication networks refers to the connection between individuals at the same level of authority within an organizational group, department, or division. Functions of horizontal information include:

1) Coordinating planning and execution of tasks

- 2) Providing for collective problem solving
- 3) Facilitating common understanding
- 4) Resolving differences and
- 5) Developing supportive and productive work relationships

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Informal Networks

- Other informal or emergent networks inevitably develop among individuals and subunits in any group or organization. These informal networks serve to link individuals to one another in much the same way as do formal networks. Informal link- ages come into being primarily because of the personal and social needs of the members.
- Informal communication networks correspond closely in structure to the formal systems. For instance, a supervisor and his or her subordinate may regularly have lunch together and discuss personal and professional matters.
- Informal networks:
- 1) Are generally face-to-face
- 2) Are less constrained by organizational and political restraints
- 3) Move messages rapidly
- 4) tend to be more the result of the situation than the people or their roles
- 5) Tend to develop more often within organizational workgroups, departments , or divisions than between them and
- 6) Generally transmit information that is accurate, though often somewhat incomplete, leading to misinterpretation.

External Networks: Relating to other organizations and publics

- **Inflow: Research and surveillance.** All groups depend on various constituencies, stakeholders, or publics in the larger environment for their survival. External networks connect and respond appropriately to environmental change, threat opportunity or challenge. Organizations receive information necessary to identify and respond appropriately to environmental change, threat, opportunity or challenge.
- **Outflow:** Advertising, Marketing, and Public Relations refer to activities that involve the transmission of messages into the environment with the aim of informing and systematically influencing these publics.

Mediated Communication Networks

Therefore, in most enterprises, mediated communication is essential. The traditions of the mail and telephone are now supplemented by fax, teleconferences, on-line computer systems, electronic mail e.t.c.

Group Presentation Formats

Group presentations can be structured around a set format or can borrow components from different formats.

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Group pesentations can take place in different formats. These formats give a group an idea of how to structure their presentation, though different components can be taken from several formats and combined according to a group's particular needs and goals.

1. Panel Presentation

A panel is a format in which the presenters talk to each other in addition to the audience. Typically the panel will consist of several group members to whom a moderator poses questions. The panel members then present their views on the question and discuss their different answers. The audience has the benefit of viewing this dynamic discussion play out before them. Often questions will also be taken from the audience, so audience members can become involved in the discussion as well. However, with such loose organization, the moderator must maintain control over the presentation and keep the group on topic .

2. Symposium

A symposium presentation is a group presentation that is essentially a collection of individual presentations covering a broad topic. The topic is broken up into subtopics, and each group member, one after another, makes a presentation on his or her subtopic. All together, the group covers the topic in its entirety. This format is very easy to organize and coordinate as long as each group member remains cognizant of not addressing a different member's subtopic. Since this method can make for a long presentation, the group members must concentrate on engaging the audience and keeping their attention.

3. Public Forum

Public forum debate can be compared to a nationally-televised debate, such as 'Crossfire' in which the debaters argue a topic. The debate in a public forum is conducted by teams of two people alternating speeches for their side, either affirming or negating their topic. Successful public forum debaters must make persuasive and logical arguments in a manner that is accessible to a wide variety of audiences. Public forum debate also focuses on not only logical, but research based arguments.

4. Oral Report by Group Leader

In this format, the designated leader of a group makes an individual presentation of the group's thoughts and findings on a topic. The leader may summarize views from several different group members and present points of agreement and disagreement.

Importance of Team Communication Skills

Team communication skills are critical for ensuring the success of the team effort, whether the team is charged with creating a new product, making a process improvement, or planning the summer picnic. Strong team communication skills can help build relationships, ensure the sharing of new ideas and best practices, and benefit team members through coaching and counseling.

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Cohesiveness

Effective teams need to work well together and that team cohesiveness depends on building strong relationships among team members. Communication is critical and is driven by the team leader who will work with the team to establish ground rules and work to bring the team together so that it can accomplish its goals. All teams will go through expected stages of development, from forming to storming to "norming," and eventually, performing, according to business consultant Bruce Tuckman. Navigating through these stages effectively will help teams build relationships.

Sharing

When team communication skills are strong, it raises the chance that good ideas and best practices will be shared openly says Lin Grensing-Pophal, author of "Employee Management for Small Business." Team members can be hesitant to provide input for fear of being criticized or having their ideas dismissed, says Grensing-Pophal. Teams that can establish an open, positive and supportive environment among team members are in a better position to hear those good ideas and learn from the best practices of the group.

Professional Development

Effective team communication can lead to both personal and professional development. Team leaders will be influenced by the coaching and counseling skills of the team leader and, when the team leader is a positive role model, these insights can help employees improve their own communication skills. Strong team communication skills can also help team members learn how to manage conflict in positive ways, an important professional development skill, says Grensing-Pophal. "Too often, we can have a tendency to avoid conflict," she says. "By learning to respond to conflict in positive ways, both employees and companies can benefit."

MEETING

"We must all hang together or, most assuredly, we shall hang separately.″
—Benjamin Franklin

Attention to meeting preparation, facilitation, participation, and evaluation processes is the recommended approach for ensuring productive outcomes. The following meeting practices are well known to support productive team processes:

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1. Organize meeting logistics
2. Distribute an agenda before the meeting
3. Start and end on time
4. Open with member check-in
5. Establish and review ground rules
6. Assign administrative roles
7. Summarize decisions and assign action items
8. Debrief: evaluate and plan for improvement
9. Distribute meeting minutes promptly

Prior to the meeting, the details of logistics—meeting location, date and time, space set-up, and technology support—need to be organized.

Advance notice: Has adequate notice been given to all those asked to attend, with coordinates of the meeting space included? If the meeting is being held over a meal, let folks know if food and beverages are being served.

Meeting space:

- Does the meeting space encourage the meeting chair/facilitator and the participants to effectively see, hear, and communicate with everyone present?
- Is the space comfortable? (consider temperature, refreshments, seating, and so on)

Technical issues: Have technical issues been tested and, when necessary, resolved? This includes testing remote connections, teleconference equipment, and computer setup.

- It is highly recommended to replicate the team environment by dialing in the remote locations and running the computer-based applications in a rehearsal format prior to the actual meeting.
- Do you have contact numbers or a team member (including yourself) on hand who can handle technological glitches as they arise?
- If teleconferencing, make sure the teleconferenced member is not "left in the dark" by providing them with clear directions on when to contribute. This may seem awkward at first, but from the perspective of a caller on the line and the members sitting at the meeting, it can be a challenge to contribute fully without clear cues. Videoconferencing allows participants to follow non-verbal cues.

Providing an agenda helps prevent confusion over who is addressing topics, provides reasons to attend the meeting (either in topics of interest on the list, or if members see they are assigned to present) and gives structure to the meeting so that time is used well.

- The agenda should include a one-sentence description of the meeting goal/objectives with a list of the topics to be covered. Each topic should include a brief description of the issue, who will address it, and the amount of time estimated for discussion.
- Send the agenda to participants before the meeting so they may offer feedback or add agenda items, prepare for the meeting, and be ready to work together.
- Follow the agenda closely during the meeting.

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Most teams will have ground rules that respect members' time.

- If someone comes in late, refrain from recapping what the team has covered—doing so sends the message that it is okay to be late for meetings and wastes valuable time. What should you do if an important member comes in late? Offer to discuss the work of the team "offline" (i.e. after the meeting is over). For habitual latecomers, request their notes/reports ahead of time so you may review their work without their presence at the meeting, and move ahead with the collective work of the team.
- State a finish time for the meeting and do not run over. To help finish at the stated time, arrange your agenda in order of importance so that if you have to omit or rush through items, you will have discussed the important topics. Unfinished business can be placed on the next meeting agenda or assigned to sub-committees to report at the next meeting.

4. Open with member "check-in"

Take 5-10 minutes at the beginning for members to check-in with the teams. "Checking-in" opens with an invitation to contribute to the opening of the meeting. As an invitation, members should be offered the option of a pass. The check-in step has been described as an investment in relationship-building with the potential to pay large dividends in efficiency and

The opening check-in brings busy people into the purpose of the meeting and allows them to share distractions so that they can receive support or put issues aside for the meeting. It allows them to be more fully present in the discussions of the team. Depending on the dynamics of the team, this can include appropriate elements of personal as well as professional life. They can

be a simple "Tell us how you are doing or how you are thinking about the team's activities" or can be more purposeful.

- Check-in questions that bring members to the professional focus of the meeting include: "What do you hope gets accomplished today? What has been your experience with [the issues on the agenda]?"
- Check-in questions that support the development of team performance: "Compliment a team member for his or her contributions at the last meeting." "Tell us something you are comfortable sharing about yourself that most of us probably do not know about you." "What did you find most helpful from our last meeting that you would like to see repeated today?"

5. Establish or review ground rules

A team sets ground rules for what it expects in terms of general courtesy and responsibility for behavior. These form the basis for future team meeting interactions, and should be reviewed periodically (preferably at each meeting). Consider the following ground rule categories while collectively determining rules for your team:

- Attendance: Who gets notified if a member is unable to attend?
- Promptness: Start and end on time.
- Participation: Everyone's viewpoint is valuable; build upon each other's ideas.
- Interruptions: How will members handle phone calls and pages? (Agree to turn devices to mute? Step outside the room for calls that must be answered immediately?)
- Conversational Courtesy: Listen attentively and respectfully to one another; don't interrupt; hold one conversation at a time.
- Accountability: Team members should be empowered to discuss the application (or lack) of the ground rules during the meeting.
- Confidentiality: The "Vegas Rule"—What happens here, stays here, unless published in a public record.

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6. Assign administrative roles

Clarity in team member roles leads to increased team effectiveness and cohesion. It provides a needed structure, and allows meetings to start and finish on time with productive time spent together. On a rotating basis, pre-assign or seek volunteers for each of the following important roles:

Timekeeper: Assists the team leader or facilitator in managing time. Give verbal reminders of the current time or time left available. The timekeeper can make "5 minute warning" cards and hold them up at the appropriate times during each topic discussed.

Recorder: Captures and transcribes (in real-time or later) key decisions, action plans, and a meeting summary. The style of the minutes issued depends on the circumstances—in situations of critical importance, detailed minutes may be required. Where this is not the case, then minutes are simple lists of decisions made and action items identified for follow-up with the person responsible named by each action item. Generally, minutes should be as short as

possible with all key information recorded. This makes notes quick and easy to prepare and review. A template for team meeting records can help organize and make reading the minutes easier.

Facilitator: Focuses on asking instead of telling, listening attentively, and building consensus among meeting participants. It is a collaborative style of leadership and a core skill for leaders as well as team members to exhibit. The facilitator should ensure effective participation, avoid too much or too little contribution from individual members, and keep the conversation flowing in the direction of the team's goals. When the timekeeper warns that the time for an agenda topic is almost over, the facilitator summarizes the discussions and the recommendations on that agenda topic and moves on to the next item on the agenda. Do not finish any discussion without deciding how to act on it. Ingrid Bens (2000) has developed a very useful tool to facilitate core practices for open conversation.

7. Summarize decisions and assign action items

When an agenda item is resolved or a mutually agreeable action plan is established, make it clear who at the meeting will be responsible for the action task. To reduce confusion and misunderstandings, summarize and document these actions in the meeting minutes.

8. Debrief: Evaluate and plan for improvement

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Time is well spent wrapping up your meeting with an assessment of process and progress, and then using the information shared to plan to improve the next meeting. Task-level monitoring can lead to immediate and significant improvements in how the task is run. Team-level evaluation is more involved, but it can surface issues felt by individuals; open up productive lines of discussions; and lead to improvements in team processes. Note that the template for team meeting records includes wrap-up questions to facilitate this final step.

Task Progress: Compare the team's progress against specific goals and set task goals for the next session:

- What has the team accomplished?
- Has it met its task goals?
- What aspects of the project or task are presenting unusual challenges?
- Are action plans achievable?

Team Process: Assess team's ability to work together and set goals and roles for the next session.

- What went well today? What needs to be improved? (consider communication, decision making, resources, accountability, guidance, etc.)

9. Distribute meeting minutes promptly

Minutes record the decisions of the meeting and the actions for follow-up. Minutes are a visible means of measuring and monitoring whether individuals assigned to tasks have

completed those tasks. They serve as a reminder for all to track whether tasks have been finished by those with designated responsibilities.

Effective Team Meetings Require Effective Team Members

"Knowing is not enough; we must apply. Willing is not enough; we must do."
—*Goethe*

On a team, leadership is shared. Members rotate roles and everyone takes responsibility for accomplishing shared goals. Members lead one another and improve the meeting's quality when they:

- Establish and ensure each other's commitment to clear **mutual goals.**
- **Communicate** ideas and feelings accurately and clearly (be willing to listen, question, and speak).
- Encourage other members to **actively participate**, acknowledge others' contributions.
- **Influence each other** based on expertise, access to information, and ability, not on authority - power is distributed equally throughout the team.
- Match **decision-making** procedures with needs of the situation.
- Engage in **constructive controversy** by disagreeing and challenging ideas or proposals through discussion, thus promoting creative decision-making and problem solving.
- Act on behalf of the team rather than on your own behalf. **Adopt a "we instead of me" approach.**
- Stay aware of the team's **task goals and time**. Maintain high standards and recognize achievement, large and small.
- Establish and maintain harmonious **interpersonal relations**, based on understanding and respect for differences.

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Effective team work can be challenging. Table 1 identifies typical challenges associated with, and give suggestions about, ways to intervene to help them become more functional team members. Note: these interventions work best when all team members are aware and engaged in effective process.

Challenges in Running an Effective Team Meeting

Challenges	Intervention Options
Confusion over who is responsible for what	• See section on assigning roles, and creating minutes; have the recorder clarify what was said if applicable • Regroup, clarify, assign, and document responsibilities in the minutes
People getting stuck in handling or too comfortable in (volunteering for) the same roles	Team members should be aware of this and may even use humor to "call out" a member who keeps volunteering for the same task
"Social Loafing": The team becomes too large and members do less or	This can lead to decreased productivity overall since the more productive members may also scale back their efforts in response. More importantly, however, it undermines the dynamic of the team by affecting individual responsibility.
"Free Rider Effect": A member reduces his or her contributions because he or she feels able to reap the benefits of the group	• Pay attention to the composition of the team • Create an atmosphere of mutual accountability where everyone feels valued and encouraged to contribute equally

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TOPIC 8

REPORT WRITING

- **Definition**: - A business report is an orderly presentation of facts about specific business activities or programmers
- Many reports maybe long or short, formal or informal, crucial or ordinary, special or routine.

Comparison of written and oral reports

- ✓ A report may be either oral or written
  - **An oral report** – is simple and easy to present. It may consist communication of an impression or an observation
  - **Written reports** are always preferred though ,simply because
    i. An oral report can be denied at any time, while written reports are evidential by nature.
    ii. An oral report tends to be vague i.e. with irrelevant facts while overlooking significant ones while written reports tend to be accurate and precise.
    iii. A written report can change hands without any danger or distortion during transmission
    iv. A written report can be referred to again and again

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Informative and interpretative reports

- **Informative reports.**If a report merely presents facts pertinent to an issue or situation, the report is referred to an informative
- **Interpretative reports.** Are reports that analyses the facts, draws conclusions and makes recommendations

The importance of Reports

- A report is a basic management tool used in decision making
- Reports facilitate implementation of the organization objectives
- Reports facilitate diversification goals
- Reports facilitate exploration of new market potentials
- Reports facilitate setting up of new business agencies
- Reports facilitate entering into collaborations

Reports format (Presentation)

- ✓ The formats of reports vary depending upon the purpose. Some are more formal than others but there are common features of any report.
- ✓ The report information may be presented in distinct numbered sections in a logical sequence with certain sections giving overviews and conclusions .A content page helps the reader to find sections of interest much quicker
- ✓ When presenting a report, the report should be written in the third person i.e. not using me or us and should be in sections which have subheadings and are numbered. which included

Presentation of Report

- ✓ A report should be written in the third person. i.e. not using I or we. Often more formal, lengthy reports are written in sections, which have subheadings and are numbered.
- ✓ Reports are broken into the following elements: - Note that note all these elements are needed in all reports

1. **Title page**
    - This will include the title of the report, who has written it and the date it was written or submitted.
2. **Acknowledgement**
    - Thanking the people or organizations who have helped
3. **Content page**
    - Listing the headings in the report, together with the page numbers showing where the particular section, illustration etc can be located
4. **Executive summary**
    - It is the most important part of any report and may well be the only section that a reader reads in detail.
    - It should be carefully written and should contain a complete overview of the message in the report, with a clear summary of your recommendations
5. **Terms of reference**
    - This section sets the scene of your report
    - It should define the scope and limitations of the investigations and the purpose of the report
    - It should say who the report is for, any constraints (like deadline, permitted length)
    - In whom your aims, objectives and the overall purpose of the report are directed to and more specifically what you want to achieve.
6. **Methodology or procedures**
    - This outlines how you investigated the area. How information was gathered, where from and how much
    - It a survey was used, how was it carried out, how did you decide on the target group and how many were surveyed by say, interviews etc
7. **Introduction/background**
    - This helps to tune your readers into the background of your report
    - It is not another name for a summary and should not be confused with this
    - They can be two separate sections or combined
    - Background details could include details of the topic you are writing about
    - You could take the opportunity to expand on your terms of reference within the introduction, give more details as to the background of the report but remember to keep it relevant factual and brief.

8. **Findings and analysis**
    - This is the main body of the report, where you develop your ideals. You must make sure that its well structured with clear headings and that your readers can find information easily

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- Use paragraphs within each section to cover one aspect of the subject at a time.
- Include any graphs or other visual materials in this section if this will help your readers
- The nature of this section will depend on the brief and scope of the report
- The section should deal with the main topics being discussed; there should be logical sequence moving from the descriptive to the analytical
- It should contain sufficient information to justify the conclusions and recommendations, which follow.
- Selection of appropriate information is crucial here, if the information is important to help understand then it should be included
- Irrelevant information should be omitted

9. Conclusion

- These are drawn from the analysis in the previous section and should be clear and concise
- They should also link back to the terms of references
- At this stage in the report, no new information can be included
- The conclusions should cover what you have deduced about the situation – bullet points will be satisfactory

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10. Recommendation

- Make sure that you highlight any actions that need to follow on from your work
- Your readers will want to know what they should do as a result of reading your report and will not want to dig for information
- Make them specific recommendations such as "it is recommended that some changes should be make" are not helpful, merely irritating
- As with the conclusions, recommendations should be clearly derived from the main body of the report and again no new information should be included

11. References/bibliography

- References are items referred to in the report.
- The bibliography contains additional materials not specifically referred to, but which readers may want to follow up.

12. Appendices

- Use these to provide any more detailed information which your readers may need for your references
- But do not include key data which your readers really need in the main body of the report
- Appendix must be relevant and should be numbered so that they can be referred to in the main body.

13. Glossary of terms and abbreviations

- Provide a glossary if you think it will help your readers but do not use one as an excuse to include jargon in the report that your readers may not understand.

Preparation of Summaries

- It has become increasingly common to summarize findings and recommendations and to present them in the form of a synopsis.
- This may be inserted immediately after the statement of the terms of reference.
- This may not be the most logical practice, but it has the following advantages for the reader.
    - It gives him a grasp of the report and makes it easier for him to follow the detailed report itself.
    - Being familiar with the main points and recommendations he can read the report with a critical frame, of mind and assess the relevance and importance of each section as bearing on the recommendations made.
    - It saves time for the busy reader who is interested to know only the gist of the report and its main conclusions.
- A synopsis is not intended as a substitute for the report but it does provide an overall picture, not only for those who read the detailed report, but also those who may be concerned with only certain aspects of the report.

False assumptions commonly made regarding an audience

- That the person who will first read or edit the report is the audience
- That the audience is a group of specialists in their field
- That the audience is familiar with the subject of the report
- That the audience has time to read the entire report
- That the audience has a strong interest in the subject of the report
- That the author will always be available to discuss the report

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- To avoid making such false assumptions, writers should identify everyone who might read the report
- Characterize those readers according to their professional training, position in the organization and personal traits
- Determine how and when the reader might use the report

Factors to consider when writing a report

1. **Kinds of audience**

   Audiences are basically of three kinds
    - **Primary people**
        - Who have to act or make decisions on the basis of the report
    - **Secondary people**
        - Affected by actions of the primary audience would take in response to the report
    - **Immediate people**
        - Responsible for evaluating the report and getting it to the right people

2. **Gathering information**
    - After getting a clear understanding of the purpose and scope of your report and who you are witting to, you are now ready to gather your information
    - The information gathered can be of two types: -

- Secondary information is information gathered and recorded by others. The secondary sources include books reports news papers magazines journals etc
- Primary information gathered and recorded by writer
- The primary sources include questionnaires, surveys observations, experiments, historical information and raw data
- Secondary information may e inaccurate, out of date or biased. While on primary sources one must be careful to ensure that the information is accurate and not biased
- At this point one is doing a research on where to find the right information
- Where the report may require purchasing of information, one may have to check with vendors and distributors for features, and pricing information
- Certain types of information may require visits to libraries, for books, magazines journals or news papers
- Another source of information is the Internet.
- Information management is equally important especially where one is handling massive information
- Separate pieces of information on note cards
- Rearrange and sort when determining your presentation plan

3. Analyze your information

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- Gather information need to be analyzed. The purpose of the analysis is to make sense objectively of the information
- There should not be any personal bias of any kind to enter the analysis
- Compare and contrast the information in order, to try and find out the best or new idea from it
- Separate facts and figures needed to be interpreted, explaining their meaning and significance

For example if a Manager wanted a report or determining which computer to buy for his office: -

- One would collect information on the type of work currently being done in the office
- And the kinds of work you would want to do
- Then gather information on computers

- **This many include:**
  - Types
  - Their costs
  - Compatibility
  - Speed of operation
  - Capacity of the computer
  - Dependability of the PC
  - Maintenance and spares availability
  - Potential of upgrading

- And other factors

- The compared and contrast (analyze) the different computers to determine how well they can do
- The tasks they are required for
  - Their potential
  - Dependability and so on
  - Once all the information is gathered determine the solution

4. **Determine the solution**
   - Based on your analysis, you will then be ready to offer a solution (or solutions) to the problem your have been studying
   - For example which computer would be best for the word processing
   - The gathered information should be the basis of making this decision
   - Avoid the tendency of "slanting" information in the report to lead the reader to your decision or want
   - Make sure that in your report all pertinent information good or bad is given. Bearing in mind that your creditability and that of your report are at stake.
   - Don't give solutions where requests are not made, your purpose would then to present the objective facts? So that someone else may use them to determine the best solution
5. **Organize your report**
   - You have got your topic, your information, and your decision. Now you're ready to determine how to present your information, the structure it would take.
   - Before actually writing, organize your information into an outline form, by choosing the major and supporting ideas, developing the details and eliminating the unnecessary ideas you've gathered
   - This will form the basis structure of your report.
   - A report could be presented as a memo report a standardized report or a formal report

.

6. **The time available and presentation of the report.**

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The characteristics of a good report

i. **Precision**
   - In a good report, the writer, is very clear about the exact purpose of writing the report

ii. **Accuracy of facts**
   - The scientific accuracy of facts so as to facilitate decision - making

iii. **Relevance**
   - To the purpose and includes all relevant aspects in order to avoid confusion and incompleteness

iv. **Reader oriented**

- i.e. it keeps in mind the audience it is addressing

v. **Objectivity of recommendations i.e.**
- Not impartial but logical

vi. **Simplicity and unambiguous language**

vii. **Clarity**
- Depends on the arrangement of facts. A good report must proceed systematically and should have a clear purpose, define source and state clearly the findings

viii. **Brevity** – a good report should be brief

ix. **Grammatically accurate** in order to bring out clear meaning

Types of reports

✓ We can classify business reports in to three different ways
- On the basis of legal formalities
  - Formal reports
  - Informal reports

On the basis of the number of persons entrusted with the drafting of the report it
a. Reports by individuals
b. Reports by committees and sub-committees

On the basis of the nature of the report
a. Period or routine reports
b. Progress reports
c. Examination reports
d. Recommendations reports
e. Statistical report

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On the basis of legal formalities

A formal report – is one which is prepared form and is presented according to established procedures by a prescribed authority

There are two types of formal reports:-

- Statutory report
- Non-statutory report

i) Statutory report
- Is a report prepared and presented according to the form and procedures laid down by law
- The director and secretary of a company are required by the company's act to prepare and submit statutory reports. Examples include
  - Annual returns reports
  - Auditors reports

ii) Non-statutory report

- This are formal reports which are not required under any law but which are prepared to help management in framing policies or taking important decisions
- Some of the non-statutory reports are prepared regularly as part of business procedures while others are occasional
- The reports may be prepared by the directors committee, executive heads of departments etc

Types of non-statutory reports

Reports of Directors to the shareholders

- Are reports that may be on a special problem or undertaking? This distinguishes it from the one submitted during the AGM as a statutory report

Reports of Committees of Directors

- The board of directors may appoint standing committees to carry out tasks of management and administration e.g. a Finance committee

Reports of special or Ad hoc committees

- Are reports on special issues or matters or urgent importance e.g. a construction of facility report

Reports of individual officers charged with various responsibilities

Reports on meetings such as benefits or employees publications etc

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Informal Reports – An informal report is usually in the form of a person – to person communication (see back page).

On the basis of the number of persons entrusted with the drafting of the report it Reports of this nature are divided into two:-

- ✓ Reports by individuals
  - Are submitted by the executive heads of various departments eg the company secretary, the Internal Auditor, the HR head etc
- ✓ Reports by committees or sub-committees
  - Sometimes reports are needed on subjects that may not concern any particular department or are so important that associating various people would bring the best results

On the basis of the nature of the report

Periodic or Routine Reports

- These reports are prepared and presented at regular, prescribed intervals in the usual routine of business
- They may be submitted annually, semi-annually, quarterly, monthly, weekly
- They contain more statements of fact in detail or in a summary form without any recommendations

- So they are mainly information reports eg the Director AGM reports, or the Auditors Report. They may contain
  i. A brief summary of important events during the period
  ii. A brief summary of the turnover
  iii. A brief account of production
  iv. Financial statements showing profit levels and liabilities m dividends, reserves, transfers etc
  v. A reference to the conditions of the plant, machinery equipments etc
  vi. Reference to important changes in administration

- **Progress Reports**
  - The reports are meant to describe and assess progress made during a particular period
  - They present an account of the work already done, work in progress with other relevant facts and details of the work yet to be completed, the content include
    i. A brief introduction of the nature of project
    ii. A brief account of the work completed
    iii. An account of work in progress during the period
    iv. An account of any special problems faced and any solutions
    v. Important aspects of the work to be completed
    vi. Any obstructions or hindrances that might slow the work
    vii. Any other relevant information that might help

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- **Examinations Report**
  - These reports are specially commissioned to cover important aspects or events. They are prepared after thorough investigations – do files are studied, personal interviews are held, questionnaires are circulated among people , surveys are conducted etc

  - They contain recommendations and may contain the following details:-
    i. The aim and scope of the report
    ii. A brief account of the methods adopted in collecting data, site inspections, records used interviews carried out e.t.c.
    iii. An analysis of the data collected
    iv. Findings
    v. Recommendations (if required)

- **Recommendations Reports**

  - In nature, these reports are not very different from examination reports – the only difference is that when ending – they must end with recommendations
  - In such a report the data is analysed in such a manner that the analysis is inevitable leads to the recommendations being made at the end
  - Its details include

i. Aim and scope of the report
ii. Methods adopted of the data
iii. Analysis of data
iv. Findings
v. Recommendations fro a definite programme

- **Statistical Reports**
  - As the name suggests, these reports are largely made up of financial data, mathematical chars, tabular columns of figures etc e.g. a costing report.

Factors to consider before writing reports

i. The kind of report requested for or expected
   - I.e. whether it should be formal or informal, statutory or non-statutory
ii. How much time has been allowed to prepare the report – especially where research may be required or an in-depth study as to the problem
iii. The purpose of the report and the extent of involving other parties
iv. What is to be examined to facilitate establish who to include in terms of expertise
v. What facts are to be furnished i.e. the terms of reference
vi. The audience of the report i.e. who is going to read the report

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Terms of reference

Definition terms of reference

- ✓ Terms of reference are used to describe the propose roles the structures of projects, working groups, reference groups and committees. They are guidelines for the way group members will work with each other and are usually the firs task undertaken by a group.
- ✓ They are usually documented by the project manager and presented to the group for approval. This provides members of the group with a clear definition of the project's report scope.
- ✓ Terms of reference provide a written basis for making decisions. Confirming a common understating between members how they will make decisions and work together.

Terms of reference should include

- What is to achieved- vision objectives , scope and deliverables
- Who will participate – stakeholders roles and responsibilities
- How it will be achieved – resource, financial and quality plans
- When the work will be achieved – a schedule and the duration of the group
- Terms of reference set out a road map and give a clear pathway for the progression of the activity. They state what need to be achieved by whom and when.
- Terms of reference should include success factors, risks and restraints. This might include riders, such as authorization of reports and submission or the release of information about the project.

Often the following headings are sued in terms of reference documentation

- Purpose
- Membership
- Meeting frequency
- Timeframe
- Authority
- Roles and responsibilities.

The components of terms of reference

1. Mission statements is a short statement which explains the mandate given to the committee or project team
2. The problem statement defines the problem and explain the service or product or operations or issue and how it is affected or how the problem is evidenced.
3. Boundaries- describes where the process system operations or issue to be studied or delt with begins and ends – it also includes the terms of authority to recommend or implement and any delegated powers.
4. Specific issues to be addressed- represents the work to be undertaken or areas of focus or direction to the team.
5. The desired outcome or output – links t he problem to the review in place
6. The persons involved and their role
7. The project administration includes the time frame, meeting reporting guidelines, resources intervention strategies e.t.c

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Preparing the report

- Once you are clear about the purpose of writing a report the persons to whom it is meant, the facts to be examined and the facts to be included together with the time at your disposal and your know the type of the report it would be desirable to start the writing work
- When writing a report, it is recommended that the following five steps be taken
  i. Investigate the source of information
  ii. Take important notes
  iii. Analyze the dates
  iv. Make a draft or outline
  v. Write the report

Organization of a report

- There are three ways in which a report can be organized
  - ✓ Letter form
  - ✓ Memorandum form
  - ✓ Letter – text combination form

i. The letter form

- In this case, the report is brief and informal in nature

- Its main parts are – the heading, or title, date, address, salutation, the body, the complementary clause and signature
- The body of the report can be divided into the following parts:-

✓ Introduction- presents the terms of reference and the subjects
  - The writer states the problems encountered in the light of the terms of reference and the relevant circumstances

✓ Findings
  - The next few paragraphs present the findings of the investigations

✓ Recommendations – where required

ii. Memorandum form

- Adopting the memorandum form is a simple way of presenting the report, since here the formalities of the letter form are done away with
- The title of the subject is stated on the top followed by the name of the writer of the report, the date, the actual text and the conclusion
- The text of the report is divided into paragraphs with headings and subheadings

iii. Letter- Text combination form

- Long reports are usually written in a letter – text combination form and includes the following parts:-
  - Introductory materials
  - The body of the report
  - Addendum

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- **The introduction parts – include**
  - Letter of presentation
  - Title page
  - Content page
  - Summary

- **The body of the letter**
  - Definition of the problem
  - Methods of procedures
  - Findings
  - Conclusions and recommendations

- **Addendum**
  - Bibliography – a list of references and sources of information
  - Appendix – statistical data, charts, and diagrams
  - Index – content summary
  - Signature

Use of Various Types of Reports

- Each report has it own use an would serve its terms of reference
- The following are some examples of reports and their uses

1. Report of the Company Secretary

- ✓ The secretary is a principal officer of a joint stock company
- ✓ He frequently has to submit reports on a variety of subjects to the share holds e.g.
  - Selection of suitable accommodation for the main or branch office
  - Complaints from branches office
  - Suspected irregularities in some departments
  - Improvement in office organization
  - Staff grievances
  - Causes of discontent labor (unions) members and their threats to go on a strike
  - Improvements on working conditions
  - Financial positions etc

2. **Reports on Meetings**

- The secretary may also be required to prepare reports on the proceedings of meeting for;
  - Members who could not attend
  - Filing as a record
  - Publication in newspapers
- These reports may be verbation or summarized. The usual practice is to report verbation the resolution passed at the meeting and to summaries the other proceedings

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Note; reports are not to be confused with minutes which are the official record of the proceedings of a meeting.

3. Reports by Committee or Sub-Committee

- ✓ Sometimes special reports may be needed on a particular subject or issue – May often times than be a routine issue.
- ✓ The issue may be so important that a group of people is chose (often knowledgeable on the matter)
- ✓ Such reports (Ad Hoc) committee is written after a careful and cautious deliberation. They are used to find solutions of whatever issue in particular prompted the report.

4. Periodic or Routine Reports

- ✓ These reports are prepared and presented at regular, prescribed intervals in the usual routine of business

- ✓ They may be submitted annually, quarterly monthly etc
- ✓ They contain more statements of facts in detail or in a summarized form, without any opinion or recommendation
- ✓ They are mainly information reports. They present a chronological record or event
    - e.g. directors report to the AGM
    - Auditors Report etc
    - Departmental reports
- ✓ The main purpose of this type of report is to present a correct and coherent picture of the working of the firm or department concerned during the pried covered by the report. Such reports include the following (e.g. auditor report)

    - A brief summary of the important events under review period.
    - A brief summary of the turnover
    - A brief account of production
    - Financial statement showing gross and net profits assets and liabilities, dividends declared, transfers to reserve fund, provision made etc
    - A reference to the condition of the plant, machinery equipment desirable
    - Reference to important changes in administration
    - Comparative study of the current period to the previous period

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5. Progress Reports

- ✓ These report meant to describe and assess progress made during a particular period
- ✓ The present an account of the work already done, work in progress with other relevant facts and details of the work yet to be completed.
    - E.g. when a company undertakes the construction of a factory or modernization of a plant, or a research project or say a dam or water supply scheme is undertaken by a government or any independent body.

A progress report should include the following details

- A brief introduction to the nature of the project being covered by the report
- A brief account of the work completed in an earlier period
- An account of the work in progress during the period under review
- Assessment of work done during this period compared with work previously done to a ascertain progress
- An account of special problems that had to be faced and the solutions of those problems
- Important aspects of the work yet to be completed
- Any obstruction or hindrances that may slow down the work
- Any relevant information that might be of help in the completion of the project.

The importance of a project report

1. It used to summarize investigation into causes and effects of problems or trends and give recommendations on the solutions.

2. It provides statistical or financial summaries
3. Control on cost trends for decision making
4. Details efforts made on the project and any restructuring that may be required
5. Report on target levels an how they have not been met
6. Give information for legal purposes.
7. Monitor work in progress completed or new schemes that require implementation.
8. Helps look into the feasibility of introducing new procedures projects etc

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TOPIC 9

PROPOSALS WRITING

Proposal in business

A **business proposal** is a written offer from a seller to a prospective buyer. Business proposals are often a key step in the complex sales process—i.e., whenever a buyer considers more than price in a purchase.

A proposal puts the buyer's requirements in a context that favors the seller's products and services, and educates the buyer about the capabilities of the seller in satisfying their needs. A successful proposal results in a sale, where both parties get what they want, a win-win situation. The main motive is to fulfill client's requirements. It is derived from the word propose and makes a proposition to the reader – a proposition the reader can accept or reject. In a well written proposal, an enterprise includes their profile and various beneficial elements regarding their offered products and services that helps to win the client's confidence. A good business proposal has the ability to portray a company exclusive and plausible that gives an edge over its competitors. A proposal should clearly define a business problem and also provide a solution to this problem. The one of the most important point that should be included in perfectly written proposal is the information provided in a proposal must be appropriate. You should not be included any fake information regarding your company in the business proposal.

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Proposals are offers to perform a service or to do something or a submission for approval such as a credit proposal. It is derived from the word propose and makes a proposition to the reader – a proposition the reader can accept or reject.

Proposals may be:

Internal: This is within the organization such as a proposal to purchase an asset or a credit proposal (in a bank)

External: This is to outsiders. This could be a proposal offering services.

Proposals can be solicited or unsolicited.

- A solicited proposal is one which the reader (customer) has asked for. This may be a credit proposal wherein the writer seeks credit facilities from a bank and submits a report on itself with facts and figures in support of this request.
- An unsolicited proposal is one that the customer has not asked for. The writer may submit a proposal by which the customer could benefit. This may be on the basis of some study done by the proposer.

The format for:

- An internal proposal is similar to that of a memo. There will be no salutation etc.
- An external proposal is similar to that of a letter.

Text

As a proposal is to seek acceptance or approval, it should state at the beginning what the proposal is. It should then state the concerns/ issues and why the proposal is being made.

If the proposal is to evaluate more than one alternative, the advantages/ disadvantages and the critical information regarding these alternatives should be stated. Then, the writer should make an evaluation and submit a conclusion/ recommendation. Nothing is more annoying than receiving a lot of data culminating with a terse statement, "*awaiting your advice*."

While making the submission you should ensure that:

- It answers all the questions that are likely to be raised.
- Generalities are avoided.

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It is to be remembered that apart from reading proposals they are evaluated by the reader and often compared with other similar proposals received. When you are writing a proposal you need your customer to buy in. Therefore the proposal must be marketed correctly.

It must be apparent that:

1. It will benefit the reader from accepting your proposal. You should explain clearly why your proposal is superior.
2. You know your product and that you know what you are talking about. You should speak of its superiority and if there are any weaknesses why they are irrelevant or how these would make no difference.
3. You know your market. This includes how big the market is and the competition. You must know the strengths and weakness of the competition.
4. It is professional. The proposal should be well presented and appear professional in every way. There must be no misspelled words or typographical errors. It should be reviewed thoroughly. The sentences must be grammatically correct.

Types of Proposals

There are three distinct categories of business proposals:

- Formally Solicited
- Informally Solicited
- Unsolicited

Formally Solicited Proposal

Solicited proposals are written in response to published requirements, contained in a Request for Proposal (RFP), Request for Quotation (RFQ), Invitation For Bid (IFB), or an Request for Information (RFI).

Request for Proposal (RFP)

RFPs provide detailed specifications of what the customer wants to buy and sometimes include directions for preparing the proposal, as well as evaluation criteria the customer will use to evaluate offers. Customers issue RFPs when their needs cannot be met with generally available products or services. RFIs are issues to qualify the vendors who are interested in providing service/products for specific requirements. Based on the response to RFI, detailed RFP is issued to qualified vendors who the organization believes can provide desired services. Proposals in response to RFPs are seldom less than 10 pages and sometimes reach 1,000's of pages, without cost data.

Request for Quotation (RFQ)

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Customers issue RFQs when they want to buy large amounts of a commodity and price is not the only issue--for example, when availability or delivering or service is considerations. RFQs can be very detailed, so proposals written to RFQs can be lengthy but generally much shorter than an RFP-proposal. RFQ proposals consist primarily of cost data, with small narratives addressing customer issues, such as quality control.

Invitation for Bid (IFB)

Customers issue IFBs when they are buying some service, such as construction. The requirements are detailed, but the primary consideration is price. For example, a customer provides architectural blueprints for contractors to bid on. These proposals can be lengthy but most of the length comes from cost-estimating data and detailed schedules.

Request for Information (RFI)

Sometimes before a customer issues an RFP or RFQ or IFB, the customer will issue a Request for Information (RFI). The purpose of the RFI is to gain "marketing intelligence" about what products, services, and vendors are available. RFIs are used to shape final RFPs, RFQs, and IFBs, so potential vendors take great care in responding to these requests, hoping to shape the eventual formal solicitation toward their products or services.

Informally Solicited Proposal

Informally solicited proposals are typically the result of conversations held between a vendor and a prospective customer. The customer is interested enough in a product or service to ask for a proposal. Typically, the customer does not ask for competing proposals

from other vendors. This type of proposal is known as a sole-source proposal. There are no formal requirements to respond to, just the information gleaned from customer meetings. These proposals are typically less than 25-pages, with many less than 5 pages.

Unsolicited Proposal

Unsolicited proposals are marketing brochures. They are always generic, with no direct connection between customer needs or specified requirements. Vendors use them to introduce a product or service to a prospective customer. They are often used as "leave-behinds" at the end of initial meetings with customers or "give-always" at trade shows or other public meetings. They are not designed to close a sale, just introduce the possibility of a sale.

Components

Formally solicited proposal

1. Requirements Matrix, which matches customer requirements with the paragraph and page numbers of where those requirements are addressed in the proposal
2. Executive Summary, which outlines the primary benefits of the vendors' solutions to the customer's requirements
3. Technical Volume, which demonstrates how each requirement will be met
4. Management Volume, which describes how the program will be managed
5. Cost Volume, which provides all costing data, as well as implementation plans and schedules[1]

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Informally solicited business proposal

1. A description of the seller's capabilities or products
2. A discussion of key issues
3. A description of the buyer's specifications and how they will be met
4. The cost of the offering
5. A schedule for delivery of the products or services
6. Proof of prior experience i.e. Testimonials from previous customers, Descriptions of previous projects[

Managing business proposals

Managing proposals presents an enormous challenge for sales and marketing teams. Many established management methods are ill-suited to deal with the broader issues associated with the production and delivery of proposals.

The process of proposal management

Proposal management is an inherently collaborative process. It often consists of the following basic roles and responsibilities:

- **Creator** - responsible for creating and editing content.
- **Editor** - responsible for tuning the content message and the style of delivery, including translation and localization.
- **Publisher** - responsible for releasing the content for use.
- **Administrator** - responsible for managing access permissions to documents and files, usually accomplished by assigning access rights to user groups or roles.
- **Consumer** or viewer - the person who reads or otherwise takes in content after it is published or shared.

Increasingly, the term proposal management is being used to suggest that engagement with the proposal process is important to more than just the sales team, and should also affect those working in marketing, legal, and sales.

There is also an increasing trend towards using proposal management software that allows users to quickly and easily create proposals, collaborate with team members, track and analyze customer engagement.

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5 Key Elements of Winning Business Proposals

- Solutions: After you have written a lead paragraph on the company's needs and problems, follow up with a solid presentation of how your business can provide solutions. The key here is to promise solutions you can deliver.

- Benefits: All winning business proposals clearly outline for the company the benefits to be gained from doing business with you. If your small business can offer complete confidentiality and meet tight deadlines state it in your benefits section.

- Credibility: This is often the overlooked portion of a business proposal but all winning proposals glow with credibility. If you have worked with clients in the same field or have an award-winning business, then third-party endorsements will build credibility.

- Samples: A business proposal with samples and evidence of your ability to deliver is vital to gaining the winning bid. A small sample of your work can show your ability to do the job.

- Targeted: A winning business proposal is all about communication. Speak in a language spoken by your intended audience. If the proposal evaluators are from an engineering background or financial department use the appropriate jargon.

Ultimately, the best business proposal is none. When your company is well-positioned and unique in the marketplace then it is only you who can meet the needs of the company

requesting the bids. If a retail craft chain is looking for a web design firm and your company specializes in web creation for the crafts industry you might be able to circumvent the proposal process.

Tips for Writing a Business Proposal

By June Campbell

Business in the nineties means fierce competition, aggressive marketing and strategic alliances. The extent to which a business succeeds or fails often depends upon that business's ability to be awarded contracts or to attract other businesses into Joint Ventures or strategic alliances. To accomplish either one usually requires two key items: good ideas and the ability to present those good ideas in a superbly developed business proposal.

Business proposals are developed for one of two possible reasons.

(1) A business entity has called for tenders or has invited you to submit a RFP (Request for Proposal). In this case, your goal is to be "short listed," meaning that you will be one of the three or four bidders who are awarded an interview. Your proposal must stand among possibly dozens of submissions.

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(2) You have an idea, concept or project that you want to propose to someone with the goal of gaining support, funding or an alliance. In this case, there is no competitive bidding process. However, your proposal must make a favorable impression and must explain all aspects of your proposed concept clearly and quickly. A document that is vaguely written, difficult to understand or that presents more questions than answers will likely be discarded promptly.

The following eleven tips are guidelines that are required for developing a business proposal for a client.

1. Clarity.

Before you begin to write the proposal, summarize the concept in 2-3 sentences, then show it to a lay person and check for understanding. If they don't grasp the basic idea, rewrite until they do. Until you can do this, you are not ready to start writing the proposal. How many times have you received a document that you had to read over and over before you comprehended the meaning? When this happens, it may be because your comprehension skills are under- developed, but it's more likely that the writer substituted clarity of thought and good document structure with sloppy thinking, wordy, rambling explanations, vague descriptions and heavy reliance on buzzwords and jargon. It's worth saying once again: If you can't summarize it in 2-3 sentences, you are not ready to start writing.

2. Strive to communicate, not to impress.

If you have a good idea and you communicate that idea clearly and effectively, the recipients will be impressed. If you try to baffle them with your brilliance, you'll lose ground.

3. Error Free:

Your proposal will be competing with proposals prepared by professional writers, graphic designers and desktop publishers. You may not have those resources at your disposal, but you can be fastidious about checking for typing, spelling and grammatical errors. Spell checkers can only go so far; the rest is up to you. Ask someone else to check your document for errors before you submit it, or wait a few days before rereading it. If you have worked on a document intensely, you will "learn" to interpret errors as being correct. It takes a fresh eye to spot the typos.

4. Print and Bind:

Print your document on good quality, heavy- bond paper, using either a laser printer or a good-quality bubble jet. Take it to an office service for backing and binding. For less than $10, you can produce a nicely done, professionally presented package.

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5. Layout:

When laying out your document, format it so the body of the text appears in the right two-thirds of the page. The one-third of the page to the left contains titles and white space. The white space to the left allows the reader to make notes. This sounds like a trivial matter, but it elicits positive reactions from recipients.

6. Visual Elements:

Include visual elements sporadically throughout your document. Logos, clip art, graphs, charts, tables and other elements greatly enhance the visual appeal of your document and make it easier for many people to read and comprehend. Pages of pure text are tiring to the eye and a challenge to the attention span. Additionally, many people are visually oriented, meaning the preferred method of learning is through imagery and not text.

7. Title Page.

Begin with a Title Page that includes images (graphics, pictures, etc.), the name of the proposal recipient, the name of the project, your company name and address, the date, and your copyright symbol.

8. Be Politically Correct.

Whether you support political correctness or whether you don't, the issue here is to avoid

offending the people who will receive your proposal document. Avoid any language that can be construed as offensive to any group of people - including women, men, persons with disabilities, persons belonging to visible minorities, senior citizens, and so on. If you're not certain of correct terminology, consult with someone knowledgeable before submitting your proposal.

9. **Write for Global Audiences:**

Emerging technologies, immigration policies and agreements like NAFTA have produced a global marketplace. Documents nowadays should be written with the understanding that they may be evaluated by persons living in other countries or by persons for whom English is a second language. Even if you are submitting your proposal to a local business, they may well have joint ventures with international companies, and these companies may be asked to peruse your document. Unless your proposal is local to a specific geographic area, avoid references that would not be understood by persons living in other areas (or explain these references if you must use them). Also, avoid the use of slang or expressions from pop culture. When persons from other cultures study the English language, they are taught to speak formal, correct English. They are often unfamiliar with the use of slang terms.

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10. Jargon Free:

Every industry has its own particular "language" - words, terms and expressions that are common to that industry but foreign to people from other industries. Avoid the use of jargon, or if you must use it, explain it. For example, expressions like "branding," "turnkey solution," "E-commerce" are not necessarily understood by everyone who is doing business. Also remember that your proposal may go to a committee that is comprised of people from various walks of life. Make sure they understand what you are talking about.

11. Technology.

What was just said about jargon goes double for technology. If your proposed project involves the use of technologies, be very careful with your explanation. The persons reading the document may have little or no technological background. Therefore, in the body of the proposal, it's usually recommended that you explain your technology in terms of what it will do - i.e. "A data base that members can use to search for information about your products." There is a place for detailed information about the technology that you are proposing - and that spot is the appendix. In many cases, a non-technically oriented business will engage a technology consultant to review your proposed technology. This person can use the detailed explanations that you include in the appendix while other readers will be able understand the proposal itself.

Guidelines for business proposal.

Whether it is for getting a loan, financial help, or developing business with a potential client; using the correct business proposal format with the appropriate content is recommended. A business proposal is done for many purposes, and the matter to be included should be presented according to the purpose of why are you are drafting the proposal. You need to be really careful in writing a business proposal, as this is what will make or break the deal. The following is an explanation on how to use the correct proposal format.

Tips on How to Write a Business Proposal

If you are thinking how to write a business proposal, you most significantly need to cite on the benefits that the client will receive if he gets into contract with your company. You first need to study and research the client's needs and requirements, and compare it with the services you are offering. With focusing on the advantages of your services, you also need to mention the way your organization works and how the project is to be done. You need to include all your marketing strategies and plans which would impress the client. It is a good idea to include all reputed clients whom you have worked with and the awards you have received in the past. You should make it a point to include appropriate set of words. For example, if the proposal includes details of all financial records, you need to use appropriate words which relate to finances. You also need to mention your financial goals and objectives. Provide a clear understanding to the client as to how their finances and funds will be used. Below is an example of a business proposal.

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Business Proposal Format
ABC, Inc.
Chicago, IL
Contact No.
Date: 4th January, 2010

(Receiver's Details)
XYZ Inc.
Kingston, NY
Contact No.

Description
This section will consist of a brief description of your company and the purpose you are writing this business proposal for.

Executive Summary
The executive summary section consists of a detailed explanation of what your company is all about and the field it has an expertise in. You also need to mention the objective of your company in brief, followed by corporate goals.

Main Body

This is the most important section of the business proposal. It contains a comparison of what the client expects and what services you are ready to offer. Jot down all the customer's needs and how your company can meet his expectations. Also mention additional services and benefits your company offers. Give details of who are the well-known clients you have worked with and on which projects. Provide details on if you have received any awards for business deliverables. If required, give details of financial records and profits and losses of your company. This will certainly assure the prospective client about your business' credibility. Note down your company's marketing process and how the project will be promoted and be made known to the public. Mention other essential information that would make your company increase the chances of getting the project.

At last, include a paragraph that will include the assurance of you certainly providing the services according to the client's expectations.

Sincerely,
ABC, Inc.

The proposal pattern may vary in length, matter, and other specifications, according to what the proposal is being made for. Be clear and use simple language which will make the reader better understand about what you actually want to say. If you are not sure about writing a proposal yourself, it is suggested to take help from a business writing professional.

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The parts/contents of a business proposal.

1.Title Page

Most organizations specify the information to include in the title page. Some even providing special farms that summarize basic administration and fiscal data. As a minimum, the title page should include the title, the name of person or company to whom the proposal is submitted, the person submitting the proposal and the date.

2.Executive Summary, Abs Tact, Synopsis

Brief proposal should have an executive summary. Because you will be competing with other for the same opportunity, some evaluator will initially read only the executive summary seeking to gain a quick overview. So should give it careful attention and time and effort. Budget figures are frequently omitted because proposal abstract may receive wide distribution.

3.Draft Contract

A draft contact allows the receiver to offer a counter offer.

4.Table Of Contents

Brief proposal usually do not require a table of content. Long proposal do require one as well as a list of table, figure and illustration.

5.Introduction

The proposal introduction section includes, a)Purpose in which u mission the main purpose of the proposal writing. b)Problem in here a business proposal, show clearly that what u understand from the problem or problems & how you overcome from that problem. c)Scope should be precise specially when dealing with a foreign country or company.

6.Background

In short proposal no need have background while long proposal includes; • Previous work completed on identical or related project. • Possibly, literature reviews on the subject, particularly your evaluation of them. • Statements showing how your proposal will build on the already completed projects and research.

7.Procedures

In procedure, you give brief state, without exaggeration, how you will meet the requirement of your reader. A good way to review your proposal they will be different in each situation.

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8.Equipment And Facilities

It shows that you have thought deeply to realize what facilities will be needed. If your proposal id for your company's bid on an enormous construction job, probably several departments will cooperate with you in presenting needed facts and figures.

9.Personnel

If you did not include brief information of individuals involved in the project in the introduction then give full information about the proposal and also the percentage of time that personal will devote to t6he project.

10.Budget

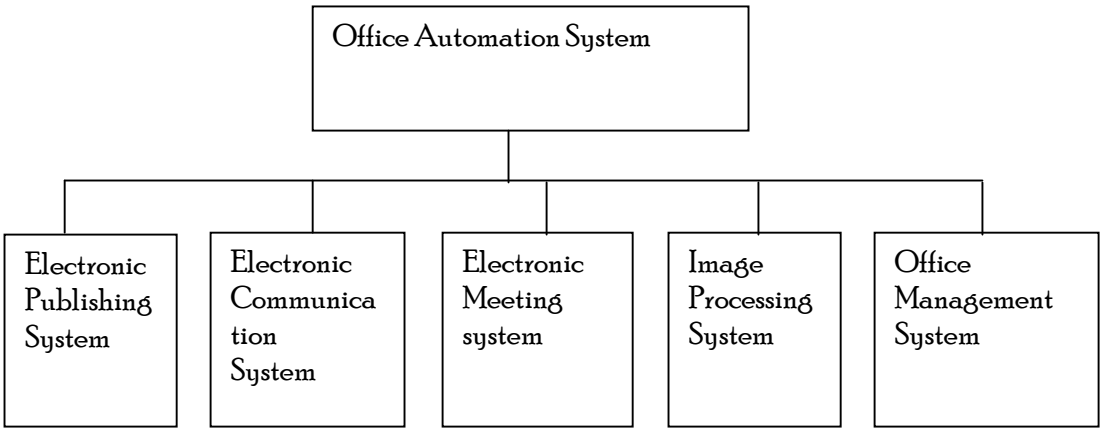
Organization requesting proposal frequently specify how the budget should be presented. Read such specifications carefully. Not all groups allow the same costs.

TOPIC 10

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMMUNICATION

Introduction

Technology and communication refers to the process of combining various technologies in order to improve the efficiency of receiving recording and transmitting information.
The system developed increase the productivity managerial users and offer professionals time and effort needed to produce access and receive business communication promptly
Office automation is synonymously referred to as "The electronic office" – it is a combination of various technologies meant to improve the efficiency of office work and also to reduce the number of office staff under employment.
Office Automation System



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Effects of Office Automation

- ✓ through office automation the following services are more effective:-

1. Electronic publishing systems
   - Are electronic systems that are used in data processing which have facilitated processing
   - Arithmetic data
   - Publication of office information such as reports, pre-release, house journals etc.
2. Electronic communication system
   - The use of the computers has led to
   - Transmission of bulk information cheaply
   - Filing of bulk information
   - Use of emails have led to immediate response
3. Electronic meeting systems
   - The use of electronic machines to facilitate communication through video and audio to allow conferences and meetings to be held with participants who may be scattered

4. Office imaging system
   - Allows users to electronically capture, store process and retrieve images of documents that may include numeric data text hand writing graphics and photographs

5. Office management systems
   - Integrates electronic calendars, tickler files, electronic mail, directories, schedulers and task management systems
   - Those provides computer-based support services to managers

The Electronic publishing systems

Def: - These are systems that aim at manipulating

i. Words
ii. Numbers and
iii. Images – to meaningful documents like newsletters books, letters etc.

✓ The main system which implement this applications are
   - Word processing system
   - Desktop publishing system (DTP)

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a) Word processing systems

✓ Word processing systems were the first and are still the most commonly used office automation application.

✓ Word processing is the use of computers based systems to
   - Create
   - Edit
   - Revise and
   - Print text materials

✓ Word processing involves manipulating text data to produce information products in the form of documents such as
   - Letters
   - Memos
   - Forms
   - Print text materials

The application of word processing

✓ The documents used in offices can be categorized into the following main groups

   - One-off text Include text such as individualized letters, memos etc.

- Replicated texts such as standard letters documents produced in large numbers (reprography)
- Updatable texts, such as reports and manufacturers manuals that may need amendments at regular intervals

Types of word processing

✓ The hardware's of word processing fall into four groups namely:-

i. Stand-alone word processors

- Comprises a keyboard, AVDU, a printer, a magnetic storage device and a microprocessors
- The keyboard is similar to that of a conventional typewriter plus a few controls keys
- The VDU displays twenty to thirty lines of eighty characters
- The printer is of letter quality such as daisy wheel printer
- The magnetic storage serves two purposes i.e.

ii. Shared logic word processors

- The shared logic system is preferred where the amount of work is extensive and cost a constraint
- If consists of a number of workstations connected to a micro-processor and sharing one or more printers
- The two work stations of shared logic word processors can be kept at a distance of up to several thousands of feet from the micro-processor – departmental utilization is therefore possible.

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iii. Mainframe word processors

- The word processors in this case is effectively a computer terminal in that, it time shares the computers processor along with other terminals
- The word processors texts are stored as records in the mainframes storage media an retrieved and transmitted to the word processors own serial printer
- The employment of a main frame facilitates transfer of database for incorporation into documents printed by the word processor e.g. accounts figures (this is known as library selection)

iv. Communication word processor (CWP)

✓ This type consists of multi-station word processors each equipped with communication controller

- It is thus possible for the cwp to communicate with the central mainframe and with other CWPs
- This means that a cwp is in effect a simple electronic mail system because letters types at the cwp are capable of being delivered quickly and automatically to another cwp some distance away

Word Processor Facilities
The CWP facilities include

b) Desktop Publishing system (DTP)

- ✓ DTP is the employment of a computer in order to create pages of mixed text an illustrations as in most technical books
- ✓ The software associated with DTP together with the high quality printer enable this to be achieved e.g. include newspapers, advertisements and catalogues
- ✓ By the use of a mouse and AVDU frames are represented on the scene into which text is inserted vice the key board and from the disk storage

The DTP facilities include:-

i. Renner – the main headline across top of the page
ii. Bullet – solid blobs before pieces of text in order to add emphasis
iii. Cast of – Calculation as to how much space text will use on a page
iv. Cross Head – A small heading used to break up text into easily readable sections
v. Footer – A line of text at the bottom of each page giving the publication title, authors name etc.
vi. Masthead – Details of a persona involved in printing the publication
vii. WYSIWYG – WHAT YOU SEE IS WHAT YOU GET) i.e. the presentation on the screen is exactly the same as the printed item
viii. Jigging – Moving text around means of desktop publishing software
ix. The common DTP packages are page makers, Ventura covel draw etc.

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Steps in using DTP System

i. Prepare your text and illustrations with a word processing program and a graphic package. Use an optical scanner to input text and graphics from other sources
ii. Use the page at composition program to develop the format of each page. This is where DTP departs from standard word processing and page
iii. Now merge the text and illustrations into the page format you designed
iv. The page composition software will automatically move excess text to another column or page and help size and place illustration and headings
v. When the page looks the way you want on the screen you can store them automatically on your hard disk then print.

Electronic communication system

- ✓ Electronic communication systems are one of the major application areas of office automation they include:-
    a. Electronic mail (e-mails)
    b. Fax messaging/telex services
    c. Voice mails
    d. Chart online
    e. Skype services

a. Electronic mail (e-mail)

✓ Electronic mail, commonly called e-mail is a method of exchanging digital messages from one (sender) to one or more recipients
✓ Emails describe arrange of electronic transmissions services but is commonly applied either to a company's mail box system operated via its own computer or to one of the services provided by internet services providers

✓ The main advantages of using email
- Quick way of transmitting information
- Allows for immediate feedback
- Can be sent to many people in the shortest moment possible

✓ The main disadvantages
✓ Interceptions by hackers
✓ Difficulty of maintaining secrecy
✓ Emails harbor viruses
✓ Email signatures are not legal

Fax mail /telex services

✓ Refers to a system of transmitting exact copies of documents quickly and accurately over telephone lines to another fax terminal
✓ The documents are transmitted through the fax simile transmission which convert digital signals to analogue for telephone transmission and back to digital via in-build fax modems

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Telex services

✓ Telex is a communication system consisting of teletypewriters connected to a telephonic network to send and receive signals
✓ Calls may be made to any telex subscriber within the county or abroad

Factors to consider when preparing fax messages

- Ensure that the recipients address is present in the directory
- Check the letter for any errors and current them
- Ensure that the paper being used is plain and of high quality
- Enlarge the mail in case it is too small for the receiver to read
- Ensure that the recipient can access the fax machine

Voice mails

✓ Refers to a computer based system which allows users and subscribers to exchange personal voice messages, to select and deliver voice information and to process transactions relating to individuals organizations, products and services using an ordinary telephone

Advantages

- Enable people leave urgent messages
- The message left is original and not distorted
- Saves on movement costs
- Same message can be sent to several people

Electronic meeting system

- ✓ Electronic meeting systems involve the use of electronic gadgets/machines, such as visual and audio equipment's to allow meetings to be held with participants who may be scattered at a cross the county or globe
- ✓ The electronic meeting systems reduce the need to travel and facilitate group decisions by the use of large display screens some of the electronic systems include

1. Teleconferencing teleseminar or audio conferencing

- Is a telephone meeting between participants in two or more locations
- The expand conversations to more than two people in twoormore locations
- Using a teleconferencing facility, in a planning process, members of a group can all participate in a conference with agency staff people
- Teleconferencing uses communication networks technology to connect participants voices
- In many cases speakers telephones are used for conference calls among participants
- A two way radio may also be used and in some remote areas satellite entrancement of connections

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2. Video conferencing

- Refers to the process of conducting a conference meeting between two or more participants at different sites by using computers networks to transmit audio and video data
- Example a point to point (two people) video conferencing system works much like a video telephone
- Each participant has a video camera microphone and speakers mounted on his or her computer
- As the two participants speak to one another, their voices are carried over the network and delivered to the others speaker and whatever images appear in front of the video camera appear in a window on the other participant monitor

Circumstances when video conferencing is most suitable

i. Where parties are at different locations (distances)
ii. Where there is need to hold regular meetings
iii. Where non-verbal communication is critical

Chat online

- Refers to any kind of communication over the internet, that offers a real – time direct transmission of text – based messages from the sender to the receiver
- Any delays in visual access shall not hamper the flow of communication in any direction
- Online chat may address point – to point communication as well as multicast communication i.e. from one sender to many receivers and voice and video chat or may be a feature of conferencing services
- Online chat may be primarily direct text based or video – based (webcams)

Main advantages

i. Facilitate direct real time communication
ii. Clarifications are obtainable
iii. Instant messaging and replies
iv. Allows viewing both the sender and receiver
v. A source of valuable information and exchange

Main disadvantages

i. Leakage of persona confidential information
ii. Exchange of dirty materials
iii. Only possible with computer and internet hence not easily accessible to all

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Skype services

- Refers to an IP telephony services provider that offers free calling between subscribers and low cost calling to people who don't use the services
- To a standard telephone call. Skype enable file transfer, texting video chat and video conferencing
- The services is available for a desktop computer notebook and tablet computers and other mobile devices

Advantages

i. Free and low cost calls
ii. Set up and good audio quality

Web based meeting

- Refers to meetings that take place over an electronic medium rather than in the traditional face to face fashion
- The most common form of web based meetings are done through web-based software that allow individuals and groups around the world the globe to facilitate meetings without physically travelling to an agreed upon location.

Office imaging system

- Allows users to electronically capture, store process and retrieve images of documents that may include numeric data text hand writing graphics and photographs

1. **Office management systems**
   - Integrates electronic calendars, tickler files, electronic mail, directories, schedulers and task management systems
   - Those provides computer-based support services to managers

   ✓ Office management system is an office automation category that integrates the following elements of management electronically.

   i. Electronic calendar
   ii. Tickler calendar
   iii. Electronic mail directories
   iv. Schedulers and
   v. Task management systems

- This provides computer based – support services to managers and other office professional to help them organize their work activities
- It computerize manual methods of
  i. Planning paper calendars
  ii. Appointment books
  iii. Directories
  iv. File Folders
  v. Memos and
  vi. Notes

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Telecommuting

- Telecommuting is the use of telecommunication by workers to replace commuting to work from their homes
- It is also used to describe telecommunications to carry on work activities from temporary locations (creation of virtual offices)
- It uses electronic mail or voice to communicate

1. **Image processing**
   - Image processing allows users to electronically capture, store, process and retrieve images of documents that may include
     i. Numeric data text
     ii. Handwriting
     iii. Graphics
     iv. Photograph etc.
   - Electronic document management (EDM) is based on image processing technology

Video Tex

- Videotext is the general term for sending and receiving information and displaying it on screen either broadcasting (telex) or telephone lines (view data)

Teletext

- This is a non-interactive i.e. one way form of videotext transmitted as Part of a TV broadcast
- The numbers of frames sent are restricted to keep down the waiting Time To receive information consumers rent or purchase teletext receivers or Adapters for television sets

- Text receivers cannot in themselves access view data
- Information such as latest news, headlines, sports results etc can be Received

View data

- This are two ways systems for transmitting text or graphics stored in

Computer databases via Telephone Networks for display on a T.V screen

- They are designed for a large number of users and are meant to be cheap easy to use and flexible
- The cost is kept down partly by the use of law cost terminals and networking
- Videotext systems are easy to use because they have a simple frame-oriented approach which means that casual users can make effectively their use immediately

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Application of view data (videotext) system

- Most businesses can make use of a videotext for information either within their organization to communicate with customers or to reach suppliers
- The most popular applications of videotext are

i.	Location system	-	Directory searching yellow pages search for Items ranging from antiques to cars
ii.	Teleshopping	-	Stock enquiry and ordering Airline, theater Reservations
iii.	Electronic Mail	-	Message switching in a company
iv.	Telebanking	-	Electronic funds transfer (EFT)
v.	Telesoftware	-	Downloading computer program
vi.	Telepublishing	-	Electronic publication of books educational Material

Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT)

- EFT is the application of computers in switching money from one account to another using telecommunication facilities
- They trend links up bank branches with each other and with the customer

Electronic Data Interchange (EDI)

- Is a direct computer exchange of standard business documents such as invoices, bills of lading and purchases orders between two separate organizations
- EDI differs from electronic mail in that it transmits an actual transaction as opposed to primary text messages and gestures standardized transactions, formats, contents related error checking and actual processing of information

Data Communication

- ✓ Def: Refers to the process of transmitting data over communication lines from one location to another using electronic systems
- ✓ End users need/ require knowledge of the essential parts of communication technology including:-
    - Connections
    - Channels
    - Transmissions
    - Network architectures and
    - Network types
- ✓ Communication allows transmission and receiving data and gaining access to electronic resources. Note that the communication process has the following :-

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i. The sources - creates the data i.e. it could be a computer or a Telephone

ii. Transmitter - Encodes the information e.g. modem, network card etc.

iii. Transmission system - Transfers the information e.g. wire or complex network

iv. Receiver - Decodes the information for the destination e.g.

Modern, network

v. Destination - Accepts and uses the incoming information e.g. Computer or telephone

Data communication channels

- ✓ A communication channel is the transmission media used in communicating. There are two ways of connecting microcomputers for the purpose of transmitting data i.e. through
  - Cable
  - Air
- ✓ There are five kinds of communication channels used for both cable and air connections namely:-
  - **i.** Telephone lines
  - **ii.** Coaxial cable
  - **iii.** Fiber-optic cable
  - **iv.** Microwave
  - **v.** Satellite

1. **Telephone lines (twisted pair)**
   - Are made up of copper wire called twisted pair culminates in a wall jack where you plug your phone. Telephone lines have the standard communication channel for both voice and data

2. **Coaxial cable**
   - Is a high frequency transmission cable which replaces the multiple of telephone lines with a single solid copper core
   - It has over 80 times the transmission capacity of twisted pair
   - It is often used to link parts of a computer system in one building

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3. **Fiber-optic cable**
   - Fiber optic cable transmits data as pulses of light through tubes of glass. It has over 26,000 times the transmission capacity of twisted pair
   - A fiber optic tube can be half the diameter of human hair
   - Fiber optic cables are immune to electronic interference and more secure and reliable
   - Fiber optic cables is rapidly replacing twisted pair , telephone lines

4. **Microwave Transmission**
   - Transmits data as a high frequency radio waves that travel in straight lines through air
   - They are good for short distance transmission but can be used for long distances by use of dishes or antennas installed on high mounted

5. **Satellite**
   - Satellites are used to amplify and relay microwave signals from one transmitter on the ground to another
   - They orbit about 22,000 miles above the earth

- They rotate at a precise point and speed and can be used to send large volumes of data

Data transmission analog versus digital

- Information is available in an analogue or in a digital form
- Computer generated data (digital data) can easily be stored in a digital format, but analogue signals such as speech must first be sampled at regular intervals and then converted into a digital form. The process is known as digitization

The main advantages of Digitization

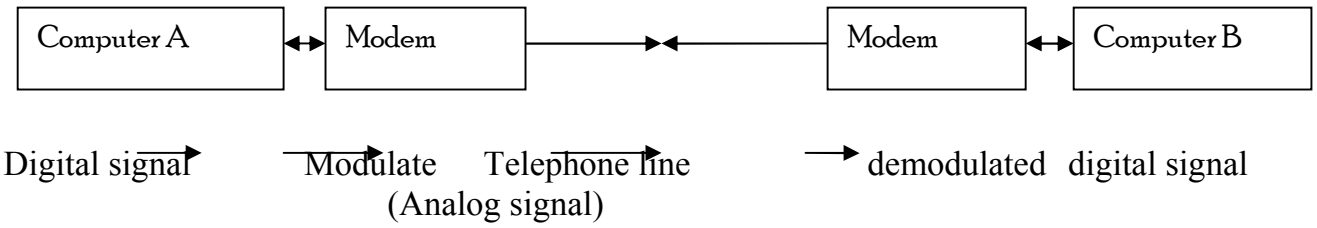
1. Digital data is less affected by noise
2. Extra information can be added to digital signals to add information or correct errors
3. Digital data tends to have a long lifespan
4. Processing of digital information is relatively easy either in real-time or non-real – time
5. A single type of media can be used to store many different types of information e.g. tapes hard-disks etc.
6. A digital system has a more dependable response than analogue system accuracy
7. Digital system are more adaptable and can be reprogrammed with software

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Modem

- A modem is a hardware device that converts computer signals (digital signals) to telephone signals (analog signals) and telephone signals (analog signals) back to computer signals i.e. (digital signals)

- The process of converting digital signals to analog is called modulation while the process of converting analog signals to digital is called demodulation



Types of modem

1. External Modem
- Another cable is use to connect the modem to the telephone wall jacks

2. Internal Modem

- An internal modem is a plug-in circuit board inside the computer system and a telephone cable connects the modem to the telephone wall jacks

3. Wireless modem
- A wireless modem is similar to an external modem. It connects to the computers serial port, but does not connect to the telephone lines
- It uses new technology that received data through the air

Data Transmission

The following are the technical matters that affect data transmission;-

- Bandwidth -Brand width is the bits – per second (bps) transmission capability of a communication channel

There are three types of band width

i. Voice band – band width of standard telephone lines
ii. Medium band- bandwidth of special leased lines
iii. Broadband – band width of microwave satellite etc.

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Types of transmission
There are two types of data transmission names:-

✓ **Serial data transmission**
- Here bits flow in a continuous stream
- It is the way most data is sent over telephone lines
- It is used by external modems typically connect to a microcomputer through a serial port

✓ **Parallel data transmission**
- In parallel transmission bits flow through separate lines simultaneously. It is limited to communications over short distances
- It is the standard method of sending data from a computers cpu to a pink

✓ **Direction of data transmission**
- There are three directions or modes of data flow in the data communication system

i. Simplex communication — data travels in one direction only e.g. point of sale terminal
ii. Half – duplex communication — data flows in both directions but not simultaneously
iii. Full - duplex communication — data is transmitted back and forth at the same time e.g. main frame communication

Mode of data transmission

- ✓ Data may be sent over communication channels in either
- ✓ **A synchronous transmission** – data is sent and received on a one byte at a time and used with micro-computers and terminals with speeds.It requires a synchronized clock to enable transmission at timed intervals

Protocols

- ✓ Protocols are sets of communication rules for the exchange of information
- ✓ Protocols define speeds and modes for connecting one computer with another computer
- ✓ Network protocols can became very complex and therefore must adhere to certain standards
- ✓ The first set of protocol standard was IBM systems Network Architecture (SNA) which only works for IBM's own equipment's
- ✓ The open systems Interconnection (OSI) of communication protocol defined by those international standards organizations
- ✓ The (OSI) is used to identify functions provided by any network and separates each networks functions into seven layers of communication

What is a computer?

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- ✓ A computer is information –processing machine. It may also be defined as a device that works under the control of stored programs automatically accepting, storing and processing data to produce information that is the result of that processing

  - ✓ **The forms of information processed include**

    - Data – e.g. invoices, sales ledger and purchase ledger payroll stock control etc.
    - Text widely available in many offices with microcomputers
    - Graphics – e.g. pictures
    - Voice – e.g. telephone
    - Processing includes creating manipulating, storing, accessing and transmitting

1. **Why use computers**
   - Use of computers has become a necessity in many fields. Computers have revolutionized the way businesses are conducted. This is due to the advantage that computer systemsoffer manual systems.

   The advantages include

   a) **Speed** – computers have higher processing speeds than other means of processing measured as a number of instructions executed per second
   b) **Accuracy** – computers are not prone to errors. So long as the programs are correct, they will always give correct output. a computer is designed in such a way that many

of the inaccuracies, which could rise due to the malfunctioning of the equipment are detected and their consequences avoided in a way, which is completely transparent to the user.

c) **Consistency** – given the same data and the same instructions computers will produce exactly the same answer every time that particular process is repeated
d) **Reliability** – computer system are built with fault tolerance features, meaning that failure of one of the components does not necessarily lead to failure of the whole system.
e) **Memory capability** – a computer has the ability to store and access large volumes of data
f) **Processing capability** – a computer has the ability to execute millions of instructions per second

2. Computer application areas

Some of the areas that computers are used include

a) **Communication** – digital communication using computers is popular and is being adopted worldwide as opposed to analogue communication using the telephone system. Computers have also enhanced communication through email communication, electronic data interchange, electronic funds transfer, internet etc. more specific examples include.
b) **Banking** – the banking sector has incorporated computer system in such areas as credit analysis fund transfers, customer relations, automated teller machines, home banking and online baking.
c) **Organizational management** – the proliferation of management information system have aided greatly the processes of managerial planning, controlling directing as well as decision –making. Computers are used in organization for specific areas where computer systems have been incorporated include sales and marketing, accounting, customer's service etc.
d) **Science, research engineering** – computers used
   i. As research tools, complex computations
   ii. For stimulatione.g. outer –space simulations, fights simulations
   iii. As diagnostic and monitoring tools
   iv. For modern mass production methods in the auto industry using computer driven technology.

e) **Management of information materials**
The internet has massive reference material on virtually every learning area. Computer systems have enabled the efficient running of libraries for information storage and retrieval.

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f) **Manufacturing and production**
Computer aided design (CAD) computer integratedmanufacturing (CIM) process control system among other technologies are computer system that have revolutionized the production industry.

g) **Entertainment** – use of computers in the entertainment industry has increased tremendously over the years. Computers enable high-quality storage of motion such as CDs, VDCs and DVDS. The internet is also a great source of entertainment resources. Computer games have also become a major source of entertainment.

h) **Retailing** - computers are used in point of sale system and credit card payment system as well as stock inventories.

i) **Home appliances** – computers (especially embedded computers or microprocessors) are included in household items for reasons of economy and efficiency of such items. Major appliances such as microwave ovens, clothes washers, refrigerators and sewing machines are making regular use of microprocessors.

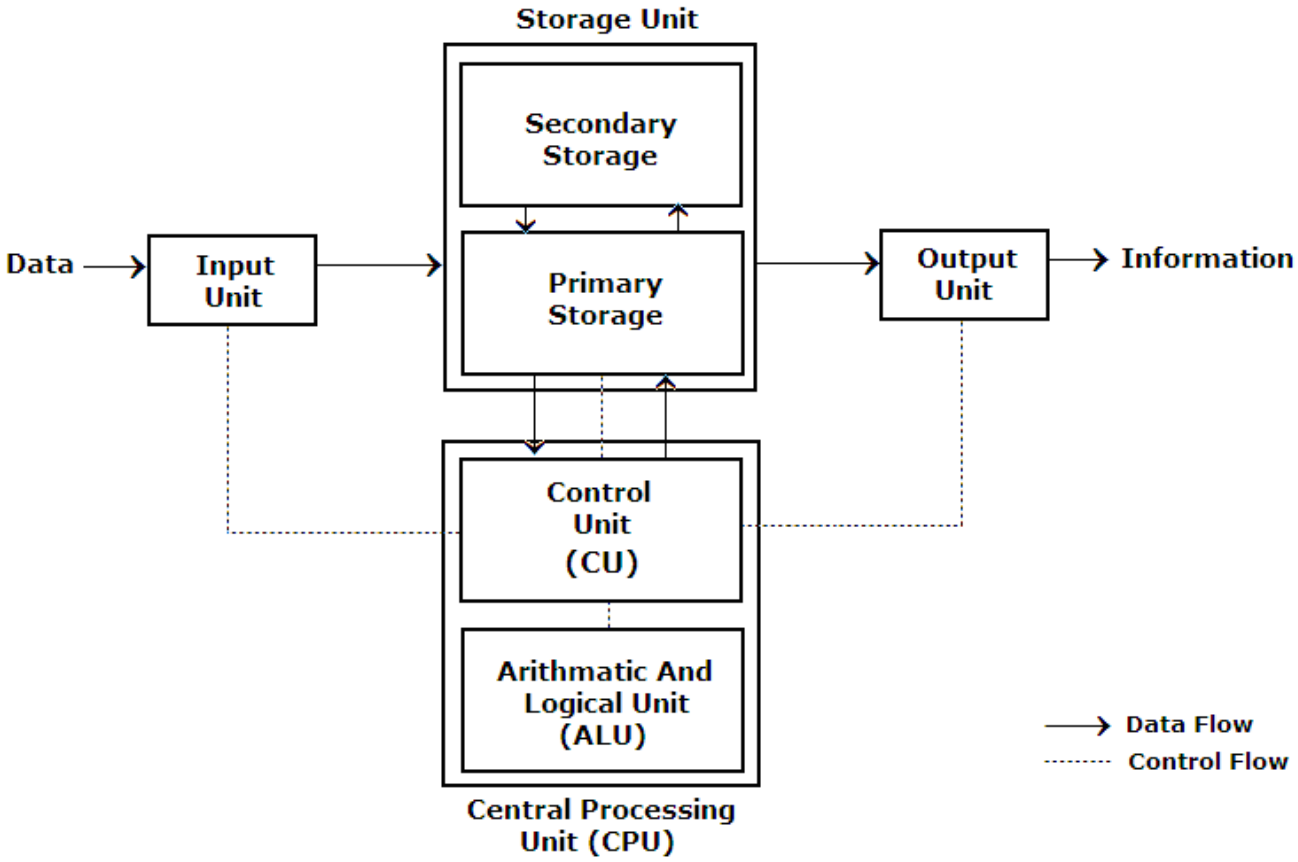
j) **Reservation system** – guest booking, accommodation and bills accounting using computers in hotels have made the process to be more efficient and faster. Airline computer reservation systems have also enhanced andalso adopted online reservation system.

k) **Health care and medicine** – computers have played an important role in the growth and improvement

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3. Functional/logical parts of digital computer

- The system unit houses the processing components of the company system. All other computer system devices are called peripherals, and are connected directly or indirectly into the system.



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- **Input devices** – enters program and data into computer system
- **Central processing unit** (CPU) – this is the part of the computers that processes data. Consists of main memory, control unit and the arithmetic and logic unit.
- **Main memory** – temporary storage to hold programs and date using program instructions
- **Output devices** – displays information processing of data using program instructions
- **Output devices** – permanent storage of data and programs before and after it is processed by the computer system
- **Communication devices** – enable communication with other computers

4. Hardware

✓ Refers to the physical, tangible computer equipment and devices, which provide support for major functions such as input, processing (internal storage, computation and control) output secondary storage (for data and programs) and communication.

Hardware categories

- A computer system is a set of integrated devices that input, output, process and store data and information. Computer systems are currently built around at least on digital

processing device. There are five main hardware components in a computer system. The central processing unit (CPU); primary storage (main memory) secondary storage and input and output devices.

Basic elements of hardware

The basic elements that make up a computer system are as follows;

a) Input

- Most computers cannot accept in forms customary to human communication such as speech or hand- written documents. It is necessary therefore to present data to the computer in a waythat provides easy conversation into its own electronic pulse-based forms. This is commonly achieved by typing data using the keyboard or using an electronic mouse or any other input device.

Keyboard

Can be connected to a computer system through a terminal. A terminal is a form of input and output device. A terminal is a form of input and output device. A terminal can be connected to a mainframe or other types of computers called host computer or server. There are four types of terminals namely dumb, intelligence, network and internet.

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Dumb terminal

- Used to input and receive data only
- It cannot process data independently
- A terminal used by an airline reservation clerk to access a mainframe computer for flight information an

Example of a dumb terminal

Intelligent terminal

- Includes a processing unit, memory and secondary storage
- It uses communications software and telephone hookup or other communication link
- A microcomputer connected to a larger computer by a modem or network link is an example of an intelligent terminal.

Network terminal

- Also known as a thin client or network computer
- It is a low cost alternative to an intelligent terminal
- Most network terminals do not have a hard drive
- This type of terminal relies on a host computer or server for application or system software

Internet terminal

- Is also known as a web terminal
- It provides access to the internet and displays web pages on a standard television set.
- It is used almost exclusively in the home.

Direct data entry devices

- Direct entry creates machine –readable data that can go directly to the CPU. It reduces human error that may occur during keyboard entry. Direct entry devices include pointing, scanning and voice –input devices.

Pen input devices e.g. light pen

- Pen input are used to select or input items by touching the screen with the pen light pens accomplish this by using a white cell at the tip of the pen. When the light pen is placed against the monitor it closes a photoelectric circuit. The photoelectric circuit identifies the spot for entering or modifying data. Engineers who design microprocessor chips or airplane parts use light pens.

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Touch sensitive screen inputs

- Touch sensitive screens or touch screens allow the user to execute programs or select menu items by touching a portion of a special screen. Behind the plastic layer of the touch screen are crisscrossed invisible beams of infrared light. Touching the screen with a figure can activate actions or commands. Touch screen often used in ATMs information centers restaurants, and or stores. They are popularly used at gas stations for customers to select the grade of gas or request a receipt at the pump (in developed countries) as well as a fast-food restaurants to allow clerks to easily enter orders.

scanning devices

- ✓ Scanning devices or scanners can be used to input images and character data directly into a computer. The scanner digitizes the data into machine in a readable form. The scanning devices used in direct – entry. the scanning devices used in direct-entry include the following

    - **Image scanner** – converts images on a page to electronic signals
    - **Fax machine** – converts light and dark areas of an image into format that can be set over telephone lines
    - **Bar-code readers** – photoelectric scanner that reads vertical stripped market printed on items
    - **Character and mark recognition devices** – scanning devices used to read marks on documents.

Character and mark recognition device features

- Can be used by mainframe computers or powerful microcomputers
- There are three kinds of character and mark recognition devices
  Magnetic-ink character recognition (MICR)

i. **Magnetic ink character recognition or MICR**- readers are used to read the numbers printed at the bottom of cheques in special magnetic ink. These numbers are an example of data that is both machine readable and human readable. The use of MICR readers increases the speed and accuracy of processing cheques.
Optical-character recognition (OCR)

- Read special preprinted characters, such as those on utility and telephone.

ii. **Optical –mark recognition (OMR)**

- Reads marks on tests – also called mark sensing. Optical mark recognition readers are often used to test scoring since they can read the location of marks on what is sometimes called a mark on what is sometimes called mark sense document. This is how for instance, standardized tests, such as the KCPE, SAT or GMAT are scored

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iii. Voice –input devices

- Voice –input devices can also be used for direct input into a computer. Speech recognition can be used for data input when it is necessary to keep your hands free. For example a doctor may use voice recognition software to dictate medical notes while examining a patient. Voice recognition can also be used for security purposes to allow only authorized people into certain areas or to use certain devices.
- Voice –input devices convert speech into a digital code
- The most widely used-input device is the microphone
- A microphone, sound card, and software from a voice recognition system.

Note:
Point –of –sale (POS) terminals (electronic cash register) use both keyboard and direct entry.

- Keyboard entry – can be used to type in information
- Direct entry – can be used to read special characters on price tags
- Point of sale terminals can use wand readers on platform scanners as direct entry devices
- Wand readers or scanners reflect light on the characters

- Reflection is changed by photoelectric cells to machine readable code
- Enclosed information on the producer's barcode e.g. price appear on terminal's digital display

Storage

- Data and instructions enter main storage and the held until needed to be worked on. The instructions dictate action to be taken on the data. Results of the action will be held until they are required for output.

Control

- Each computer has a control unit that fetches instructions from main storage, interprets them, and issues the necessary signals to the components making up the system. It directs all hardware operations necessary in obeying instructions.

Processing

- Instructions are obeyed and the necessary arithmetic and logic operations are carried out on the data. The part that does this is called the arithmetic and logic unit (ALU)
- Processing devices

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i. The CPU (central processing unit)

✓ The CPU (central Processing Unit) controls the processing of instructions. The CPU produces electronic pulses at a predetermined and constant rate. This is called the clock speed. Clock speed is generally measures in megahertz that is millions of cycles per second,

It consist

- **Control unit (CU**) the electronic circuitry of the control unit accesses program instructions, decodes them and coordinates instructions execution in the CPU
- **Arithmetic and Logic unit (ALU**) performs mathematical calculations and logical comparisons
- **Registers –** these are high speed storage circuitry that holds the instructions and the data while the processor is executing the instruction and the data while the processor is executing the instruction
- **Bus-** this is a highway connecting internal components to each other.

ii. Main memory

- Primary storage, also called main memory, although not a part of the CPU is closely related to the CPU. All instructions and data passthrough main memory locations. Memory is located physically close to the CPU to decrease access time that is the time it takes the CPU to retrieve data from memory. Although the overall trend has been increased memory access time, memory

has not advanced as quickly as processors. Memory access time is often measured in milliseconds or one thousands of a second.

iii. Output

- Results are taken from main storage and fed to an output device. This may be a printer in which case the information is automatically converted to a printed form called hard copy or to a monitor screen for a soft copy of data or information.

Output devices.

✓ Output is human-readable information. Input (data) is processed inside the computer's CPU into meaningful output (information) output devices translate the machine readable information into human-readable information. They include.

a) Printers

- Outputs printout on paper oftenreferred to as hard- copy output
- Categorized according to
  - **i)** Printing capacity.
  - **ii)** Character printers – print one character at a time
  - **iii)** Line printers – print one line at a time
  - **iv)** Page printers – print whole page at a time

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b) Plotters

Plotters are typically used for design output. They are special-purpose output devices used to produce charts,maps, architectural drawings and three – dimensional representations. They can produce high quality multi-colour documents or larger size documents. Plotters produce documents such as blueprints or schematics.

c) Monitors

Output device for soft copy output (temporal screen display of output which lasts as ling as the monitor's power is on) they are the most frequently used output devices.

Some are used on the desktops; others are portable. Two important characteristics of the monitor are size and charity.

d)Voice- output devices

iii) Voice-output devices make sounds that resemble human speech
iv) Voice –output devices use prerecorded vocalised sounds to produce output
v) The computer "speaks" synthesized words
vi) Voice output is not as difficult to create as voice input
vii) Most widely used voice –output devices are stereo speakers and headphones

viii) Devices are connected to a sound card in the system unit
ix) Sound card is used to capture sound as well as play it back.

Auxiliary / secondary storage devices

- ✓ **Secondary storage devices store** a larger amount of data or instructions that does main memory, on more permanent basis. On a per megabyte basis secondary storage is also cheaper than primary storage. Secondary storage is not volatile. Secondary storage is also more portable than primary storage- that it is possible to remove it from computer and use the device and its contents in another.

Types of secondary storage devices

i) Magnetic disks – stores bits as magnetic spots. Magnetic disks are similar to magnetic tapes in that areas are magnetized to represent bits. However the disks' read / write head can go directly to the desired record, allowing fast data retrieval.
ii)Floppy disks (diskettes)

iii)Hard disks/fixed disks –also **called hard drives**.

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Iv)Optical disks – store bits " pits" and "lands" on surface of disk that can be detected
v)CD-ROM -
vi)DVD –ROM (digital video Disks) they are similar to CDs except that it has high quality sound and high resolution video.
vii)Magnetic tapes – magnetic tape is similar in composition to the kind of tape found in video tapes and audiotapes. Plastic film is coated with iron oxide, which is magnetized to represent bits.

Computer memory

1. **RAM(random Access Memory**) /**RWM (Read Write Memory**) Also referred to as main memory, primary storage or internal memory.

- ✓ Its content can be read and can be changed and is the working area of the user. It is used to hold programs and data during processing
- ✓ . RAM chips are volatile that is they loose their contents if power is disrupted. Typical sizes of RAM include 32 MB
  - EDO (extended data out
  - DRAM (Dynamic RAM
  - SDRAM – Synchronous

2. **ROM (Read Only Memory**) its contents can only be read and cannot be changed . ROM chips is non- volatile, so the contents aren't lost if the power is disrupted.

   - ✓ ROM provides permanent storage for unchanging data & instructions such as data from the computer called the bootstrap program

   - ✓ ROM : chips, the contents or combination of electrical circuit states are set by the manufacturer and cannot be changed. State are permanently manufactured into the chip

3. **Cache memory** – cache memory is high-speed memory that a processor can access more quickly than RAM
   - ✓ . Frequently used instructions are stored in cache since they can be retrieved more quickly, imporving the overall perfomance of the computer

System software

- ✓ System software consists of programs that coordinate the activities of hardware and other programs. System software is designed for a specific CPU and hardware class.
- ✓ The combination of a particular hardware configuration and operating system is called a computer platform. These programs manage the "behind the scenes" operation of the computer.

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Examples

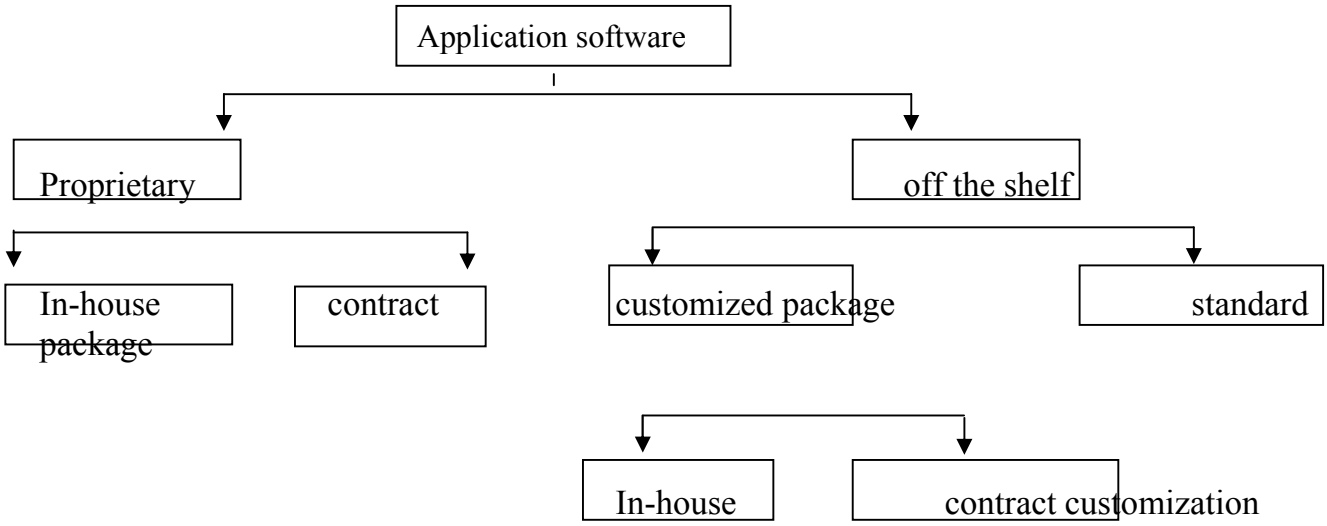
- Operating systems
- Utility programs – utility programs often come installed on computer system or packaged with operating system. Utilities can also be purchased individually. Utility programs perform useful tasks, such as virus detection, tracking computer jobs, and compressing data.
- Language processors – compilers and interpreters

Operating systems

- ✓ The functions of an operating system includes
  - o Perform common hardware functions
  - o Accept input and store data on
  - o Provide a user interface
  - o Provide hardware independence
  - o Manage system memory
  - o Manage processing
  - o Control access to system resources
- ✓ Protection against unauthorized access
- ✓ Logins and passwords
- ✓ Manage files

- Physical storage location
- File permissions
- File access

Sources of software



Advantages of proprietary software

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i. You can get exactly what you need in terms of reports, features e.tc
ii. Being involved in development offers a further level of control over results
iii. There is more flexibility in making modifications that may be required to counteract a new initiative by a competitor or to meet new supplier or customer requirements. A merger with another firm or an acquisition will also necessitate software changes to meet new business needs

Disadvantages of proprietary software

i. It can take long time and significant resources to develop required features
ii. In house system development staff may become hard pressed to provide the required level of ongoing support and maintenance because of pressure go get on to other new projects
iii. There is more risk concerning the features and performance of the software that has yet to be developed.

Advantages of off-the shelf software

i. The initial cost is lower since the software firm is able to spread the development costs over a large number of customers
ii. There is lower risk that the software will fail to meet the basic business needs
iii. You can analyze existing features and performance of the package
iv. Package is likely to be of high quality since many customer firms have tested the software and helped identify many of its bugs

Disadvantages of off-the shelf software

i. An organization may have to pay for features that are not required and never used
ii. The software may lack important features, thus requiring future modifications of customization. This can be very expensive because users must adopt future releases of the software
iii. Software may not match current work processes and data standards
v) Application software is further classified into general –purpose software and applications

Computer networks

- Refers to communication system connecting two or more computers that work to exchange information and share resources (ie hardware, software and data)
- Network architecture is a description of how a computer is set-up (configured) and the strategies used in the design

Terms used to describe computer networks

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- **Node** Refers to device connected to a network such as computer, printer or data storage device
- **Client** Refers to a node those requests and users resources available from other nodes (typically microcomputer)
- **Server** A node that shares resources with other nodes it may be a file server, printer server communication server, web server or database server.

Network operating system (NOS)

- Refers to the operating system of the network that controls and coordinates the activities between computers on a network such as electronic communication and sharing of information and resources.

Distributed processing

- Refers to the computing power located and shared at different locations (communication is decentralized)

Host computer

- Refers to a large centralized computer usually a main frame computer.

Types of computer networks

- ✓ Different communication channels allow different types of networks to be formed
- ✓ Telephone lines may connect communication equipments within the same building.
- ✓ Coaxial cables or fiber optic cable can be installed on building walls to form communication networks
- ✓ There are three important networks that can be used depending on the geographical size

i) LANS
ii) MANS
iii) WANS

LAN (Local Area Network)

- ✓ LAN is a computer network in which computers and peripheral devices are in close physical proximity.
    - It is a collection of computers within a single office or building that connects to a common electronic connection – commonly known as a network backbone.
    - This type of network typically uses microcomputer and allows users to share hardware, software and data on the network.

MAN – Metropolitan Area Network

- ✓ Refers to a computer network that may be citywide. This type of network may be usedas a link between office building in a city. (town)
    - The use of cellular phone system expand the flexibility of MAN network by linking car phones and portable phones to the network

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WAN Wide Area Networks

- ✓ Refers to a computer network that may be countrywide. It normally connects network over a larger physical area such as different towns
    - A modem connects a LAN to a WAN

Internetworking connections

- ✓ Most modern networks have a backbone which is a common link to all networks within an organization.
- ✓ The backbone allows users on different network segments to communicate and allows data into and out of the local network.
- ✓ Networks are partitioned from other networks using

i) Bridge – links two networks of the same type
ii) Gateway – connects two networks of dissimilar type
iii) Routers – operate rather like gateways and can either connect two similar or two dissimilar networks

Application of computer networks within an organization

- ✓ Connectivity is the ability and means to connect a microcomputer by telephone or other telecommunication links to other computers and information sources around the world
- ✓ The connectivity options that make communication available to end-users include.
    - Fax machines (facsimile transmission machines)
    - E- mail (electronic mail)
    - Voice messaging system
    - Video conferencing system
    - Shared resources
    - Online services

Fax machines

- ✓ Fax machines convert images to signals that can be sent over a telephone line to a receiving machine. They are extremely popular in offices. They can scan the image of a document and print the image on paper. Microcomputers use fax/ modern circuit boards to send and receive fax messages.

E-mail (electronic mail)

- ✓ E-mail is a method of sending an electronic message between individuals or computers. One can receive e-mail messages even when one is not on the computer. E- Mail messages can contain text, graphics, images as well as sound.

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Voice messaging system

- ✓ Voice messaging system is computer system linked to telephones that convert human voice into digital bits. They resemble conventional answering machines and electronic mail system. They can receive large numbers of incoming calls and route them to appropriate voice boxes which are recorded voice massagers they can forward call and deliver the same message to many people.

Video conferencing system

- ✓ Video conferencing system are computer system that allow people located at various geographical locations to have in –person meetings. They can use specially equipped videoconferencing rooms to hold meetings. Desktop videoconferencing system use microcomputers equipped with inexpensive video cameras and microphones that sit atopof a computer monitor.
- ✓

Online services

- Online services are business services offered specifically for microcomputer users. Well known online service providers are America online (AOL) AT&T World Net, CompuServe, Africa Online, Kenya web, UUNET Wyandanch Online and Microsoft Network. Typical online service offered by these providers are;

- **Teleshopping** – a database which lists prices and description of products. You place an order, charge the purchase to a credit card and merchandise is delivered by a delivery service.
- **Home banking –** banks offer this service so you can use your micro computer to pay bills make loan payments or transfer money between accounts.
- **Investing –** investment firms offer this service so you can get information on airline schedules and fare, order tickets and charge to a credit card
- **Internet access** – you can get access to the World Wide Web.

Internet

- The internet is a giant worldwide network. The internet started in 1969 when the United States Government funded a major research project on computer networking called ARPANET (Advanced research Project Agency Network) when on the internet you move through cyberspace.
- Cyberspace – is the space of electronic movement of ideas and information.
- The web provides a multimedia interface to resources available on the internet. It also known as WWW or World Wide Web. The web was first introduced in 1992 at CERN (Centre of European Nuclear Research) in Switzerland. Prior to the web, the internet was all text with no graphics animations, sound or video.
- Common internet applications
- Communicating on the internet includes e-mail, discussion groups (newspaper) charts groups
- You can use e-mail to send or receive messages to people around the world
- You can join discussion groups or chat groups on various topics

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Shopping

- Shopping on the internet is called e-commerce
- You can window shop the cyber malls called web storefronts
- You can purchase goods using checks, credit cards or electronic cash called electronic payment.

Researching

- You can research on the internet by visiting virtual libraries and browse through stacks of books
- You can read selected items at the virtual libraries and even check out books

Entertainment

- There are many entertainment sites on the internet such as live concerts, movie previews and book clubs
- You can also participate in interactive live games on the internet.

How do you get connected to the internet?

- You get connected to the internet through a computer. Connection to the internet is referred to as access to the internet. Using a provider is one of the most common ways users can access the internet. A provider is one of the most common ways connected to the internet. A provider provides a path or connection for individuals to access the internet.

There are three widely used providers.

i) Colleges and universities – colleges and universities provide free access to the internet through their Local Area Networks

ii) Internet service providers (ISP) ISPs offer access to the internet for free. They are more expensive than online service providers.

iii) Online service providers- provide access to the internet and a variety of other services for a fee. They are the most widely used source for internet access and less expensive than ISP.

Connections

There are three types of connections to the internet through a provider

a. Direct or dedicated
b. SLIP or PPP
c. Terminal connection

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Direct or dedicated

- This is the most efficient access method to all functions on the internet. However it is expensive and rarely used by individuals. It is used by many organizations such as colleges, universities, service providers and corporations.

SLIP and PPP

- This type of connection is widely used by end users to connect to the internet. It is slower and less convenient than direct connection. However it provides a high level of service at a lower cost than direct connection. It uses a high speed modem and standard telephone line to connect to provider that has a direct connection to the internet. It requires special software protocol. SLIP (serial Line Internet Protocol) or PPP (Point-to Point Protocol). With this type of connection your computer becomes part of a client/ server network. It requires special client software to communicate with server software running on the provider's computer and other internet computers.

Terminal connection

- This type of connection also uses a high speed modem and standard telephone line. Your computer becomes part of a terminal network with a terminal connection. With this communication that occurs between the provider and other computers on the internet. It is less expensive than SLIP or PPP but not as fast or convenient

TCP/IP

The standard protocol for the internet is TCP./IP. TCP/IP (transmission Control Protocol/ internet protocol) are the rules for communicating over the internet. Protocols control how the message are broken down. Set and reassembled. With TCP/IP a message is broken down into small parts called packets before it is sent over the internet.
Each packet is sent separately, possibly travelling through differnet routes to a common distination. The packets are reassembled into correct order at the receiving computer.

Internet Services

- The four commonly used services on the internet are;
    - Telnet
    - FTP
    - Gopher
    - The web

Telnet

- telnet allows you to connect to another computer (host) on the internet
- with telnet you can log on to the computer as if you were a terminal connected
- there are hundreds of computers on the internet you can connect to.
- Some computers allow free access, some charge a fee for their use.

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FTP (File Transfer protocol)

- FTP allows you to copy files on the internet
- If you copy a files from internet computer to an internet computer it is called downloading
- If you copy a file from your computer to an internet computer, it is called uploading.

Gopher

- Gopher allows you to search and retrive information at a particular computer site called a gopher site
- Gopher is a software application that provides menu-based functions for the site
- It was originally developed at the university of Minnesota in 1991
- Gopher sites are computers that provide direct links to available resources, which may be on other computers
- Gopher sites can also handle FTP and Telnet to complete their retrivalfucntions

The Web

- The web is a multimedia interface to resources available on the internet
- It connects computers and resouces throughout the world

- It should not be confused with the term internet.

The browser

- A browsers is a special software used on a computer to access the web
- The software provides an uncomplicated interface to the internet and web documents
- It can be used to connect you to remote computers using Telnet
- It can be used to open and transfer files using FTP
- It can be used to display text and images using the web
- Two well know browsers are
- Netscape communicator
- Microsoft Internet Explore

Uniform Resources Locators (URL's)

- URL's are addresses used by browsers to connect to other resources
- URL's have at least two basic parts

    - Protocal- used to connect to the resource, HTTP (Hyper Text Transfer Protocal) is the most common
    - Domain Name – the name of the server where the resource is located

- Many URL's have additional parts specifying directory paths , files names and pointers
- Connecting to a URL means that you are connecting to another location called a web site
- Moving from one web site to another is called surfing

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Web portals

- Web portals are sites that offer a variety of services typically including email, sports, updatesm financial data, news and links to selected websites. They are designed to encourage you to visit them each time you access the web. They act as your home base and as a gateway to their resources

Web pages

- A web page is a document file sent to your computer when the browser has connected to a website. The document file may be located on a local computer or halfway around the world. The document file is formatted and displayed on your screen as a web page through the interpretation of special command codes embedded in the document called HTML (Hyper Text Mark-ups Language)

- Typically the first web page on a website is reffered to as the hoe page. The home page presents information about the site and may contain reference and connections to other documents or sites called hyperlinks. Hyperlink connections may contain text files, graphic images, audio and video clips. Hyperlink connects can be accessed by clicking on the hyperlink.

Applets and Java

- Web pages contain links to special progams called applets written in a programming language called Java.
- Java applets are widely used to add interest and activity to a website
- Applets can provide animation graphics, interactive games and more
- Applets can be downloaded and run by most browsers

Search tools

- Search tools developed for the Internet help users locate precise information. To access a search tool, you must visit a web site that has a search tool available. There are two basic types of search tools available
    - Indexes
    - Search engines

Indexes

- Indexes are also known as web directories
- They are organised by major categories eg Health, entertainment, education etc
- Each category is further organised into sub categories
- Users can continue to search of subcategories until a list of relevant documents appear
- The best know search index is yahoo

Search engines

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- Search engines are also known as web crawlers or web spiders
- They are organised like a database
- Key words and phrases can be used to search through a database
- Databases are maintained by special programs called agents, spiders or bots
- Widely used search engines are google, HotBot and AltaVista

Web utilities

- Web utilities are programs that work with a browser to increase your speed productivity and capabilities. These utilities can be included in a browser. Some utilities may be free on the internet while others can be charged for a nominal charge. There are two categories of web utilities
- Plug-ins
- Helper applications

Plug-ins

- A plug-in is a program that automatically loards and operates as part of your browser
- Many websites require plug-ins for users to fully experience web page ocntents
- Some widely used plug-ins are:-
    - Shockwave from maromedia – used for web-based games, lives concerts and dynamic animations
    - Quick Time from Apple – used to display video and play audio
    - Live-3D from Netscape – used to display three-dimensional graphics and virtual reality

Helper applications

- Helper applications are also known as add-ons and helper applications. They are independent programs that can be executed or launched from your browser. The four most common types of helper applications are
- Off-line browsers – also known as web-downloading utilites and pull products. It is a program that automatically connects you to selected websites. They download HTML documents and saves them to your hard disk. The documents can be read latter without being connected to the internet
- Information pushes – also known as web broadcasters or push products. They automatically gather information on topic areas called challes. The topics are then sent to your hard disk. The information can be read later without being connected to the internet
- Metasearch utilities – offline search utilities are also known as metasearch programs. They automatically submit search request to several indices and search engines. They receive the result, sort them, eliminate duplicates and create an index
- Filters – filters are programs that allow parents or organisations to block out selected sites eg adult sites. They can monitor the usage and generate reports detailing time spend on activities.

Discussion groups
There are several types of discussion groups on the internet

- Mailing lists
- Newsgroup
- Chatgroups

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Mailing lists

- In this type of discussion groups, members communicate by sending messages to a list address. To join, you send your e-mail request to the mailing list subscription address. To cancel, send your mail request to unsubscribe to the subscription address.

Newsgroups

- News group arethe most popular type of discussion group. They use a special type of computers called UseNet. Each UseNet computer maintains the newsgroup lisitng. There are over 10,000 different newgroupsorganised into major topic areas. Newsgroup organisation hierarchy system is similar to the domain name system. Contributions to a particular newsgroup are sent to one of the UseNet computes.UseNet computers save messages and periodically share them with other UseNet computers, interested individuals can read contributions to a newgroup.

Chatgroups

- Chat groups are becoming a very popular type of discussion group. They allow direct 'live' communication (real time communication). To participate in a chat group, you need to join by selecting a channel or a topic. You communicate live with others by typing words on your computer. Other members of your channet immediately see the Words on their computers and theycan respond. The most popular chat service is called internet relay chat (IRC) which requires special chat client software.

Instant messaging

- Instant messaging is a tool to communicate and collaborate with others. It allows one or more people to communicate with direct " live' communication. It is similar to chat groups, but it provides greater control and flexibility. To use instant messanging, you specify a list of friends (buddies) and register with an instant messaging server e.g Yahoo messanger. Whenever you connect to the internet, special software will notify your messaging server that you are online. It will notify you if any of your friends are online and will also notify your buddies that you are online.

E-mail (electronic mail)

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- E- mail is the most common internet activitiy. It allows you to send messanges to anyone in the world who has an internet e-mail account. You need access to the internet and e-mail program to use this type of communication. Two widely used e-mail programs are microsoft' s outlook express and netscape's communicator.

E-mail has three basic elements

i) Header – appears first in an e-mail message and contains the following information
  - **i.** Address – the address of the person(s) that is to receive the e-mail
  - **ii.** Subject – a one line description of the message displayed when a person checks their mail
  - **iii.** Attachment – files that can be sent by the e-mail program

ii) Message – the text of the e-mail communication

iii) Signature – may include sender's name, address and telephone number (optional)

E-mail addresses

- The most important element of an e-mail message is the address of the person who is to receive the letter. The internet uses an addressing method known as the Domain Name systme(DNS) the system divides an address into three parts.

i) User name – indentifies a unique person or computer at the listed domain

ii) Domain name – refers to a particular organisation

iii) Domain code – indentifies the geographical or organisational area

- Almost all ISPs and online service provides offer- e- mail service to their customers

The main advantages of email are;

- It is normally much cheaper than using the telephone (although, at time equates to money for most companies, this relates any savings or costs to a user's typing speed)
- Many different types of data can be transmitted such images, documents speech e.t.c
- It is much faster than the postal service
- Users can filter incoming email easier than incoming telephone calls
- It normally cuts out the need for work to be typed, edited and printed by a secretary.
- It reduces the burden on the mailroom
- It is normally more secure than traditional methods
- It is relatively easy to send to groups of people (tranditionally either a circulation list was required or a copy to everyone in the group was requried
- Is is usually possible to determine whether the recipient has actually read the message (the electronic mail system sends back an acknowledgement)

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The main disadvantages are;

- It stops people using the telephone
- It cannot be used as a legal document
- Electronic mail messages can be sent on the spur of the moment and may be regretted later on (sending by tranditional methods normally allows for a rethink. In extreme cases messages can be sent to the wrong person (typically when replying to an email message, where messages is sent to the mailing list rather than the originator.
- It may be difficult to send to some remote sites. Many organisations have either no electronic mail merely an intranet. Large companies are particulary wary of internet connections and limit the amount of external traffic.
- Not everyone reads his or her electronic mail on a regular basis. (although this is changing and more organisations adopt email as the standard communication medium)

Intranets

✓ Intranets are in-house, tailor made networks for use within the organization and provide limited access if any) to outside services and also limit the external traffic (if any) into the intranet. An intranet might have access to the internet but there will be no access from the internet to the organization's intranet.

- ✓ Organizations which have a requirement for sharing and distributing electronic information normally have three choices
    - Use a proprietary groupware package such as lotus notes
    - Set up an intranet
    - Set up a connection to the internet.

- ✓ Groupware packages normally replicate data locally on a computer whereas intranets centralize their information on central servers which are then accessed by a single browser package. The stored data is normally open and can be viewed by any compatible WWW browser. Intranet browsers have the great advantage over groupware workstations and so on. A client browser also provides a single GUI interface, which offers easy integration with other applications such as electronic mail, images audio video,animation and so on.

The main elements of an intranet are;

- Intranet server hardware
- Intranet server hardware
- TCP/IP stack software on the clients and servers
- WWW browsers
- A firewall

Extranets

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- ✓ Extranets (external intranets) allow two or more companies to share parts of their intranets related to join projects. For example two companies may be working on a common project, an Extranet would allow them to share files related with the project.
- ✓ Extranets allow other organizations, such as suppliers, limited access to the organization's network.
- ✓ The purpose of the extranet is to increase efficiency within the business and to reduce costs

Firewalls

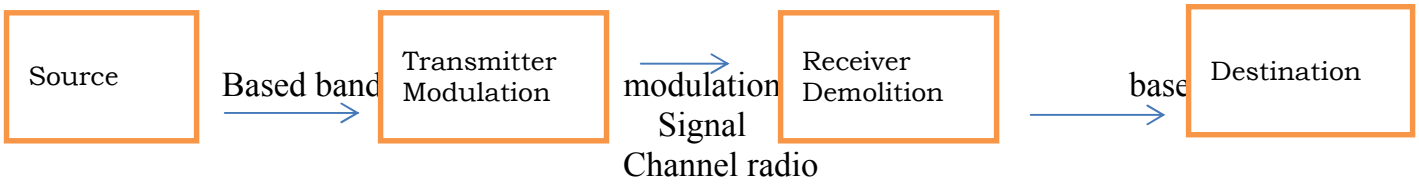
- ✓ A firewall (or security gateway) is a security system designed to protect organizational networks. It protects a network against intrusion from outside sources. They may be categorized as those that block traffic or those that permit traffic.

Wireless technologies

- Refers to those technologies that transfers information over a distance without the use of enhanced electrical cables or wires
- It is any technology that is not connected by any cables, through which homes, telecommunication networks and business enterprises transfers information or data
- Wireless telecommunication networks are generally implemented and administered using a transmission system called radio waves

Elements of a wireless communications system

- ✓ The most basic wireless system consists of a transmitter, a receiver and a channel, usually a radio link as illustrated below:-



- ✓ Since radio cannot be used directly with low frequencies, such as those of a human voice, it is necessary to superimpose the information content on to higher frequencies using a modulation process.

Types of wireless technology

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- ✓ There is a wide range of wireless technology which contains a large number of subset technologies that range from

- ATM - Protocol based
- WLAN
- WIRELESS LAN

- ✓ The process by which radio waves are propagated through the air the amount of data carried, the immunity to interference from internal and external sources varies from technology to technology
- ✓ Wireless technologies are different by the following

    - Protocoli.e. ATM or IP
    - Connection type i.e.
        - Point to point
        - Multiple point connection
    - Spectrum
        - Licensed or
        - Unlicensed
        -

Different types of wireless sections

1. **Radio**
   - ✓ Open radio communication was one of the first wireless technologies to find widespread use and still serves the purpose today
   - ✓ Portable multichannel radios allow users to communicate over short and long distance
   - ✓ People share information through radio, calls, aid emergency during disaster etc.
   - ✓ Powerful amateur broadcasting equipment communication digital data over radio spectrum

2. **Cellular**
   - ✓ Cellular networks use encrypted radio links, modulated to allow many different users to communicate across a single frequency band
   - ✓ Because individual's handsets lack significant broadcasting power, the system relies on a network of cellular towers capable of triangulating the source of any signal and handling reception duties off to the most suitable antenna.
   - ✓ Data transmission over cellular networks is also possible
   - ✓

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3. **Satellite communication**
   - ✓ Is another wireless technology that has found widespread use in specialized situation
   - ✓ These devices communicate directly with orbiting satellite via a radio signal, allowing users to stay connected virtually anywhere on earth
   - ✓ Portable satellite phone and modems features a more powerful broadcast and reception hardware than cellular devices due to increased range and are corresponding more expensive

4. **Wi-Fi**
   - ✓ Is a form of low-power wireless communication used by computers and hand-held electronic devices
   - ✓ In a Wi-Fi set up a wireless router serves as the communication hub, linking portable devices to a wireless internet connection
   - ✓ These networks are extremely limited in range due to low power of transmission allowing users to connect only within close proximity to a router or signal repeat

5. **Sigsbee technology**
   - ✓ Is a type of low cost low-power, wireless technology designed for working on excellent long batter timing good for monitory and control

6. **Wimax technology**
   - ✓ Is a type of wireless networking technology that is required to transmit information in the form of microwaves through point to point or multi point access
   - ✓
7. **Voice communication**
   - ✓ In this type all the types of technologies related to communication through the voice is included e.g. through phones
8. **Blue tooth technology**
   - ✓ Used to transmit data from one device to another device with the help of mobile
   - ✓ phone technology

Topical Questions

Question 1

a) define office automation (2mks)
b) Explain five aspects of office automation in an organisation (10mks)
c) i) Define the term electronic communication system
ii) Explain the following aspects of electronic communication system
   a. electronic mail
   b. voice mail
   c. chart online
   d. skype services (8mks)

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Question 2

a) Distinguish between telex services and fax services (5mks)
b) What are the factors you would consider when preparing fax messages (5mks)
c) Explain five advantages of voice mail (5mks)
d) Explain the importance of implementing the use of E-mail services in an organisation. (5mks)

Question 3

a) Explain the following
   a) Tele seminar (4mks)
   b) audio conferencing (3mks)
   c) video conferencing (3mks)
   d) chart online (3mks)
b) Explain the main advantages and disadvantages of charting online (8mks)

Question 4

a) Define web based meetings

b) Explain the following concepts
   a. vide tex (3mks)
   b. teletext (3mks)
   c. view data (3mks)

c) Explain five applications of view data (5mks)

d) Write explanatory notes on
   a. electronic funds transfer (EFT) (2mks)
   b. electronic Data Interchange (EDI) (2mks)
   c. Data Communication (2mks)

Question 5

i) Explain the following channels of data communication
   a. coaxial (3mks)
   b. fiber-optic (3mks)
   c. micro-wave (3mks)
   d. satellite (3mks)

j) Define the term compute and explain five advantages of using computers in an enterprise. (8mks)

Question 6

a) State and explain five examples of a computer input peripheral (5mks)
b) Define the term dumb terminal and give five examples of dumb terminals. (7mks)
c) state and explain eight areas of computer application (8mks)

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Question 7

a) Write explanatory notes on
   i) Magnetic- Ink Character Recognition (3mks)
   ii) Optical- Mark Recognition (OMR) (3mks)

b) Explain the following aspects of information storage
   a. auxiliary storage devices (3mks)
   b. Random Access Memory (ram) (3mks)
   c. Read Write Memory (RWM) (3mks)
   d. Read Only Memory (ROM) (3mks)
   e. Programmable Read Only Memory (PROM) (3mks)

Question 8

a) Define Proprietary software and state the advantages and disadvantages of proprietary software (10mks)
b) Define off self software programmes stating their advantages and disadvantages (10mks)

Question 9

a) distinguish between Local Area Networks (LAN) , Metropolitan Area Network (MAN) and Wide Area Network (WAN) (6mks)
b) Write explanatory notes on

a. telnet (3mks)
b. file transfer protocol (FTP) (3mks)
c. Gopher (3mks)

c) what are the advantages of E-mail (5mks)

Question 10

a) distinguish between
   a. intranets and extranets (6mks)
   b. Explain their importance in and organisation (6mks)

c. define wireless technologies and state and explain four types of wireless technologies (8mks)

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TOPIC 11

ETHICS AND INTEGRITY IN BUSINESS

Ethics and integrity

- ✓ Ethics refers to standards of behavior that tell us how human beings ought to act in many situations in which they find themselves – as friends citizens business people , professionals e.
- ✓ Ethics is not the same as
  - i) Feelings
  - ii) Religion
  - iii) Following the law
  - iv) Following culturally accepted norms
  - v) Science.
- ✓ Ethics in communication refers to the standards of right and wrong that apply when sending and receiving messages
- ✓ They are the principals what is right and what is wrong based on values shared in the communication process.

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Business integrity

- ✓ Business integrity is the reliability with which the business undertakes its transactions with the various parties with which it interacts.
- ✓ it is the soundness and honesty with which it conducts its business transactions and relationships
- ✓ When business ethics and integrity are present all parties dealing with the business know that they can rely on the standards with which the business conducts its business transactions and the business products.
- ✓ business ethics and integrity are important because consumers can only make ethical decisions on choosing in the right business organisation when they have access to accurate and complete information about t he practice of different business.
- ✓ Any business organisation that aims to be socially and ethically responsible must make a priority of streamlining on ethical communication both internally and externally.

Business ethics in communication

The role of ethics in business communication

- ✓ The role of ethics in business communication is enormous. it presents ways through which ethical considerations are carried on in business.
- ✓ Ethics in business relate to the following communication relationships.
  a. Management to management
  b. Management to employees
  c. Employees to employees
  d. Employees to customers or suppliers

e. The organization to outside world.

- ✓ a business organisation should structure internally it's communication policy, creating ethical consideration & standards that are clear.
- ✓ the management should then;
  a. communicate to all employees formally the expected ethical standards
  b. train all employees of the organisation on the ethical standards towards the customers, suppliers and the outside stakeholders.
  c. encourage high levels of honest and discourage any mis-representations
  d. promote harmony, fairness and personal integrity in all relationships.

Five source of ethical standards

1. The utilization approach

- ✓ States that the ethical Action is the one that provides the most good or does the least harm I.e it produces the greatest balance of good and harm.

2. The rights Approach

- ✓ States that the ethical action is one that protects and represents the moral right of those affected.
- ✓ The approach is based on the beliefs that human beings have dignity based on human nature and ability to choose freely.

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3. The fairness of justice approach

- ✓ Holds that equal should be treated equally.
- ✓ Any ethical actions should treat all human beings equally or fairly.

4. The common good approach

- ✓ Holds that life in a community is good in itself and our actions should contribute to t hat life i.e interlocking relationships in a society should be on the basis of ethical reasoning with respect and compassion.

5. The virtue approach

- ✓ ethical actions ought to be consistent with certain ideas and virtues t hat provide for full development of our humanity
- ✓ these virtues are dispositions and habits that enable use to act according to the highest potential of our character and on behalf of values like truth honesty e.t.c

Unethical practices in communication

1. Plagiarism

- ✓ As a speaker we are expected to remain honest when presenting information. when one steals concepts without giving credit to others they breach an ethical concept known as honesty- this is called plagiarism.

2. Bias

- ✓ Whenever a person or group internationally presents information that unevenly favors or discredits one side – the speaker is said to be biased.

3. Propaganda

- ✓ Is the deliberate use of messages or images to persuade or influence an audience to think or act in a certain way.

4. Fallacies

- ✓ Refers to communication that flows or contains logical errors.

6. Red hearing

- ✓ Diverts the listener's attention to another unrelated or irrelevant topic.

7. Occurs when drawing a conclusion about an entire group based selected few individuals.

The goals of ethical communication

1. Telling the truth without exaggerations, deception or retaining some truth.
2. Differentiate between facts and opinions (facts are quantifiable / verifiable)
3. be objective through recognition of biases and being honest
4. communication clearly
5. Give credit where it is due.

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The four- way test judging what we say.

a) is the view the truth
b) is the view fair
c) would you accept the same if it was said to you
d) Would the view build good will.

How to promote communication ethics in a business organisation

a. Establish a communication policy- a written ethical communication policy will detail expectations and define interactive behavior with emphasis on aspects such as;
   i. honesty
   ii. fairness
   iii. sincerity e.t.c
b. A written policy will outline the consequences of unethical behavior.

c . Train all staff on the ethical principals in order to harmonize different ideas in work interactions, customer relations e.t.c

d . Management to take a lead role in demonstrating ethical behavior both formally and informally

e . Create a strong communication control and monitoring of external communication such as;
   i. sales promotion
   ii. advertising
   iii. Press –release e,t,c.

The characteristics of communication ethics

1. conveying information without offending the audience I.e using a soft language
2. maintain a relationship with the audience
3. avoid withholding a crucial information
4. Establish a well organized communication policy with mutual respect and value.
5. accurate and honest messages be communicated
6. develop a code of communication ethics

The framework for ethical decision making

1. Recognize on ethical issue e.g choice between good and bad
2. Get the facts right
3. Evaluate alternative actions
4. Make a decision and test it
5. Act and reflect on the outcome.

Concepts of ethics and integrity

Ethics and integrity definition

- ✓ Refers to the degree of trust worthiness and ethical behavior on an individual with considerations for knowledge of the impact and consequences making a decision.
- ✓ The ethical and integrity concepts related to the following aspects.

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1. A person's ability to listen to others and communicate in an effective way i.e (communication)
2. The ability of a person to approach a problem bus using a logical systematic sequential approach i.e. (Analytical thinking)
3. Demonstrating concern on being perceived as responsible, reliable and trustworthy (personal creditability)
4. The ability to make decisions and solving problems that may be complex (decision making)
5. The ability to get a long and interact positively with others, degree of understanding e.tc interpersonal skills)
6. The ability to ensure that one's own and others works and information are complete and accurate (thoroughness)
7. The ability to effectively manage and guide group efforts (team leader)
8. The ability to prevent manages and resolve conflicts (conflict management)
9. The ability and willingness to delegate responsibility work with others and develop their abilities.
10. The ability to look at situations from multiple perspectives, creativity and innovation in order to improve.

The emerging trends in business ethics

- ✓ For many years business and ethics have always been considered as of opposite sides. the general perception and in most cases rightly so, remained that profits and purity do not go together i.e the path to wealth is not exactly a holly or sacred one.
- ✓ But today however, most developed nations together with their conscious investors now question this basic assumption.
- ✓ This has led to the development of three main trends facing business ethics- which include.

1. **Character training**
   - ✓ In fact the emergence of a concern for business ethics and ethical training itself is a major trend.
   - ✓ The work place is seen more as an environment where values are natured inculcated and promoted.
   - ✓ Character training is a big concern not only by t he government, but also institutions of all levels of learning and schools.
   - ✓ Business organisation now has started investing in the value of ethical training through trainers and consultants to shape character.
2. **Use of computer in the work place**
   - ✓ Has casted old ethical problems to the extent that privacy and confidentiality is highly threatened.
   - ✓ There is need for ethics on staff and consultancy to sort these conundrums
3. Emergence of business ethics literature in schools works places – promote desire for ethics in all fields such as;
   a. health
   b. education
   c. finance
   d. legal e,t,c

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Ethical dilemma

- ✓ Occurs when people try to withhold crucial information because of conflict with an individual or group of people or culture or age differences.
- ✓ In such situations importance should be given to the message to be communicated and not t he person or group.
- ✓ where there is ethical dilemma consider the effects of various alternatives by the use of the utilization approach i.e taking decisions which produce more good and less harm